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NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Texas Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **62 in every 100**, mark the international share of Texas's STEM master's degrees.



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The 2026 Texas Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

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A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Authors

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Texas: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

How to Cite this Profile

Emerson V. Johnston and Amy Zegart, “The 2026 Texas Talent Profile,” Technology Policy Accelerator, Hoover Institution, and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, November 2026.

Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, and from SEVIS by the Numbers, published by the Department of Homeland Security's Student and Exchange Visitor Program. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Texas Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Texas's numbers say

1. **International students earn 62% of Texas's STEM master's degrees,** 10.4 points above the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 9th of 51 on dependence. The share is 50% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 4.7% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Texas awarded 10.5K STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 9.0% of the U.S. total and 2nd of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +79%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in computer & info sciences,** where international students earned 79% of master's degrees (7.67K degrees; U.S. 65%). 4 STEM fields with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Texas ranks 3rd of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Texas 62%, New York 64%, Florida 40%, California 48%, Illinois 66%.
5. **92% of Texas's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 2.3% came from abroad. More residents left for other states (41.2K) than students arrived from them (12K), a net loss of 29.3K; the top destination for those leaving was Oklahoma.

62%

of the STEM master's degrees Texas awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

1.67M #2
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · +5.7% since 2015

10.5K #2
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · +79% since 2015

62% #9
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +3.1 pp since 2015

19% #12
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · −0.1 pp since 2015

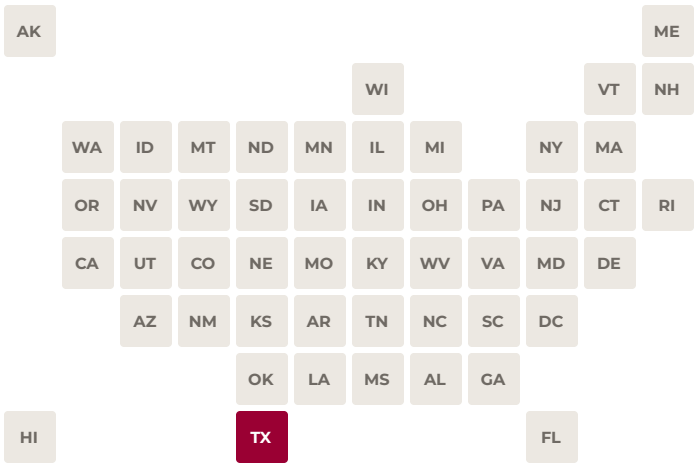
24% #18
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +5.4 pp since 2015

61% #26
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +8.7 pp since 2015

$11.8K #18
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +14% since 2015

92% #1
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −0.6 pp since 2016

$96.8K #24
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −6.8% since 2016

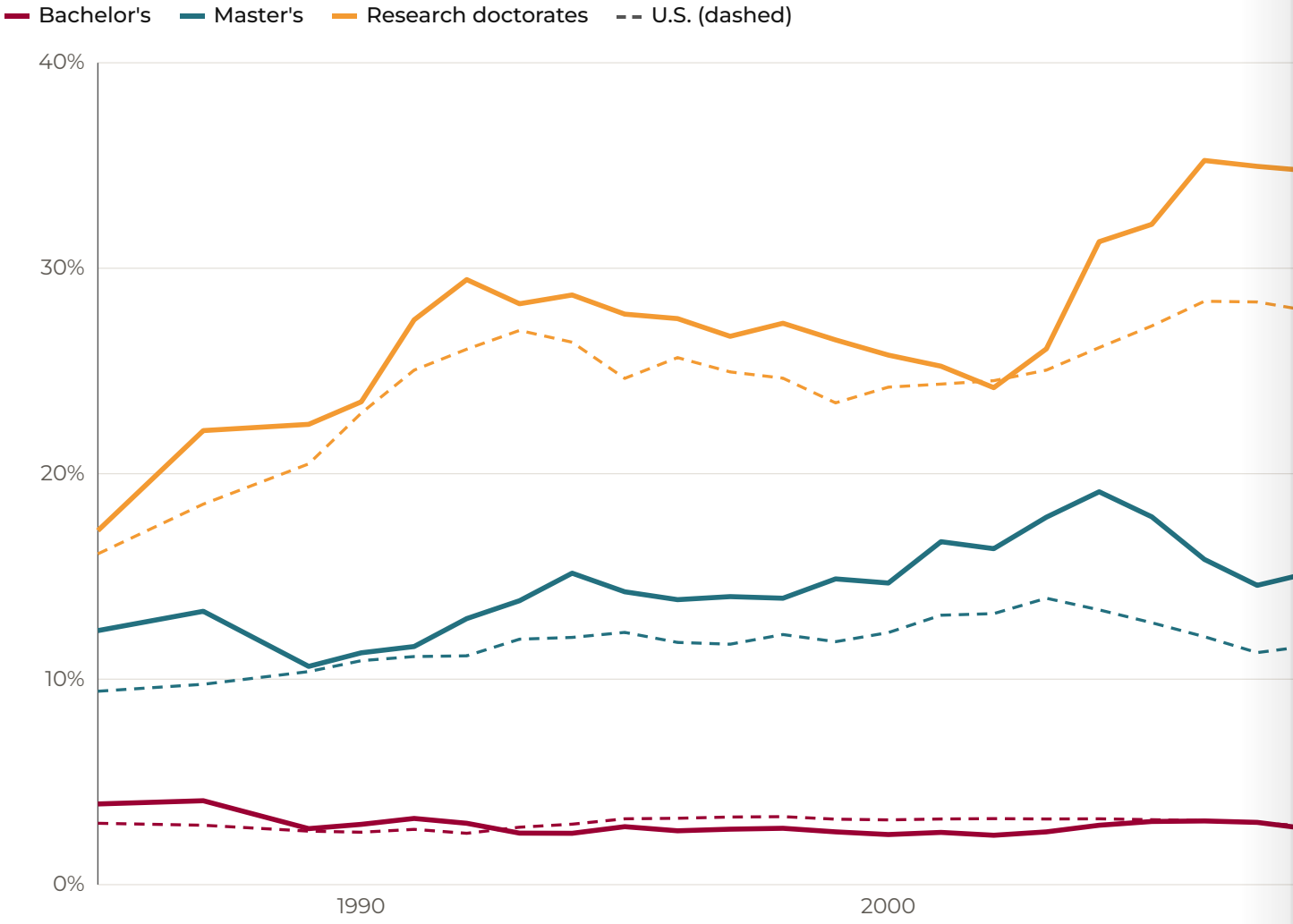


Badges give Texas's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

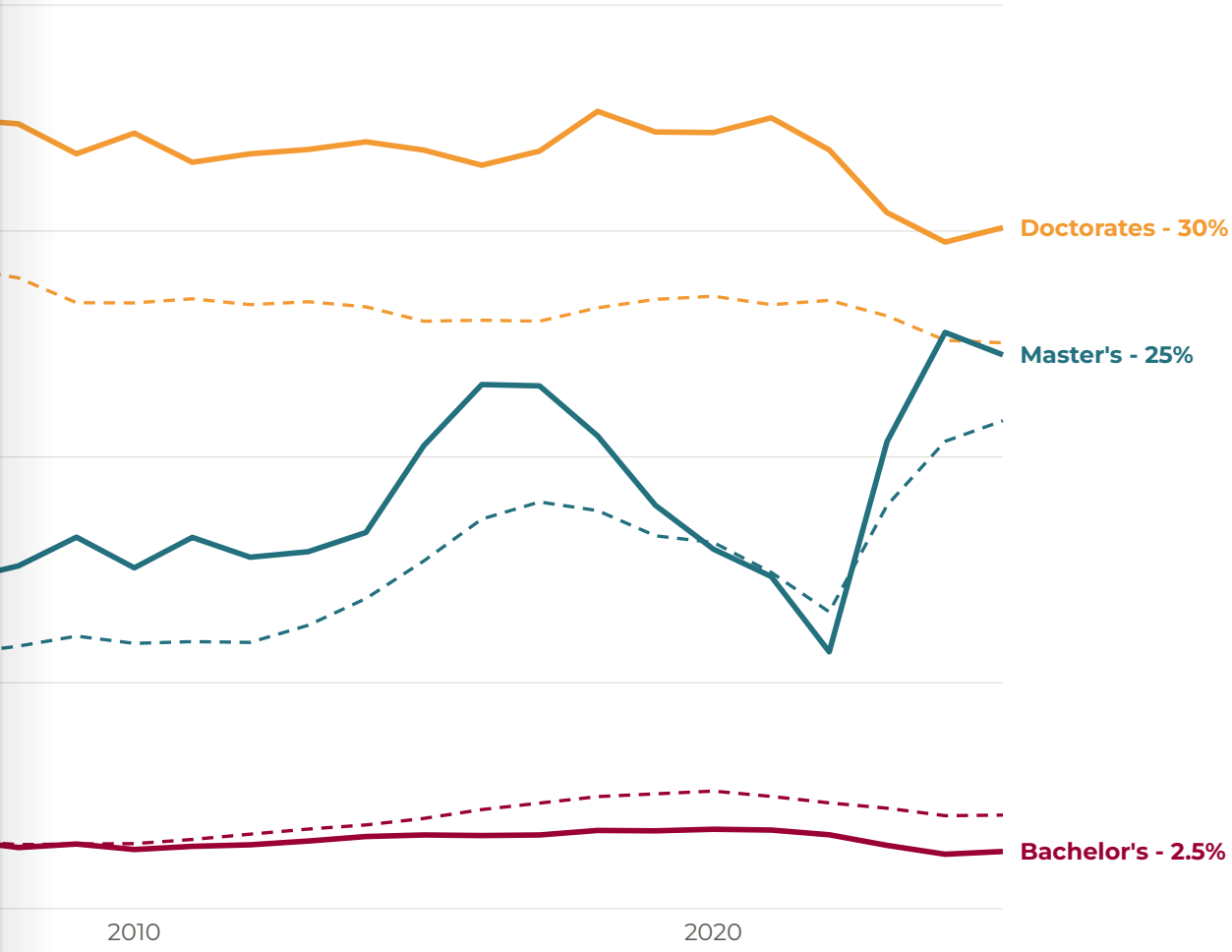
Figure 1 What Share of Texas's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025

International students make up 19% of Texas's graduate enrollment and 2.5% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 2.5% of bachelor's, 25% of master's and 30% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 4.7% of STEM bachelor's, 62% of STEM master's and 50% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 9.0% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 2nd of 51.



5.

19%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **12th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

25%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

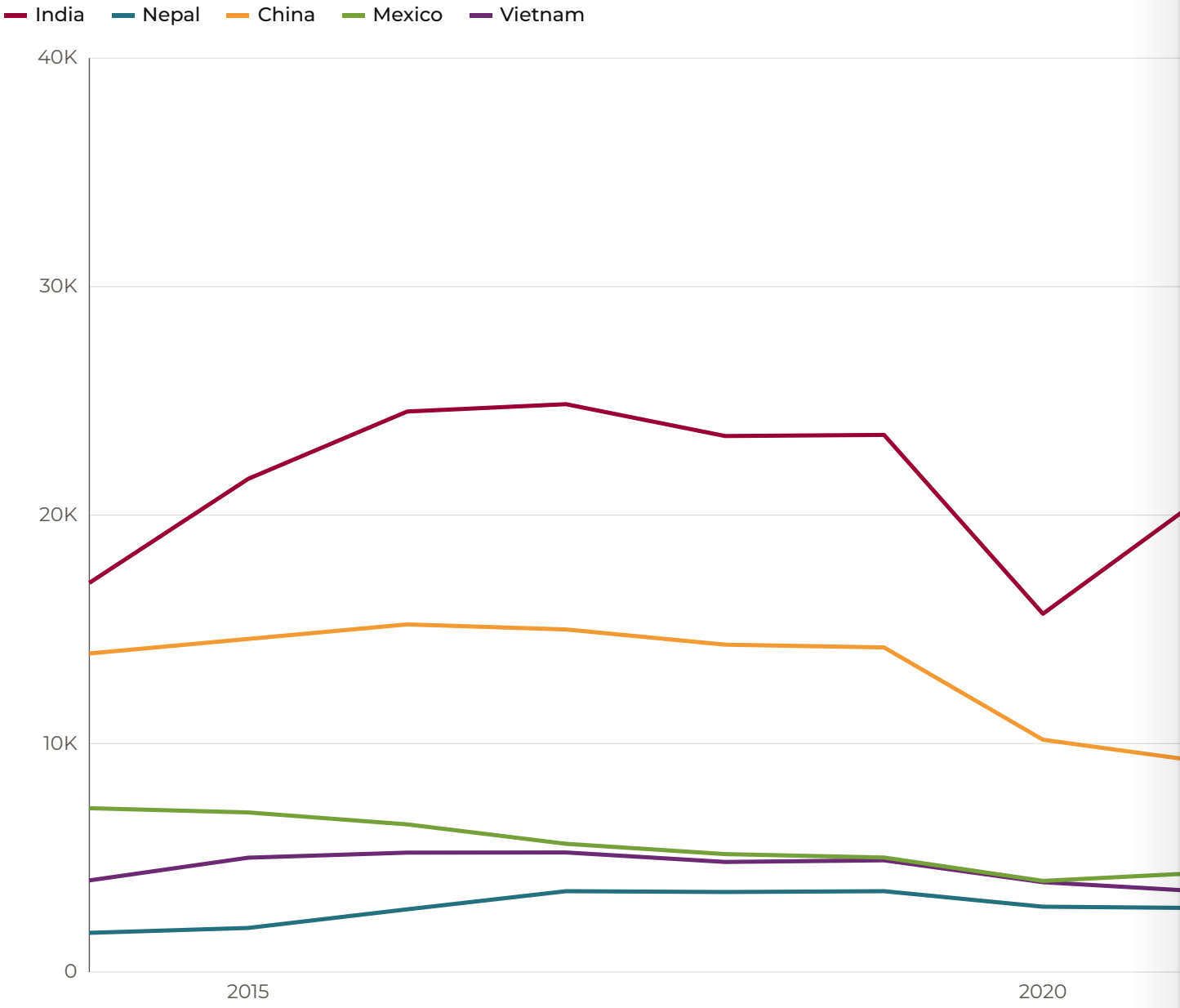
U.S. **22%** · **11th** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

62%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **9th** of 51 · +3.1 pp since 2015

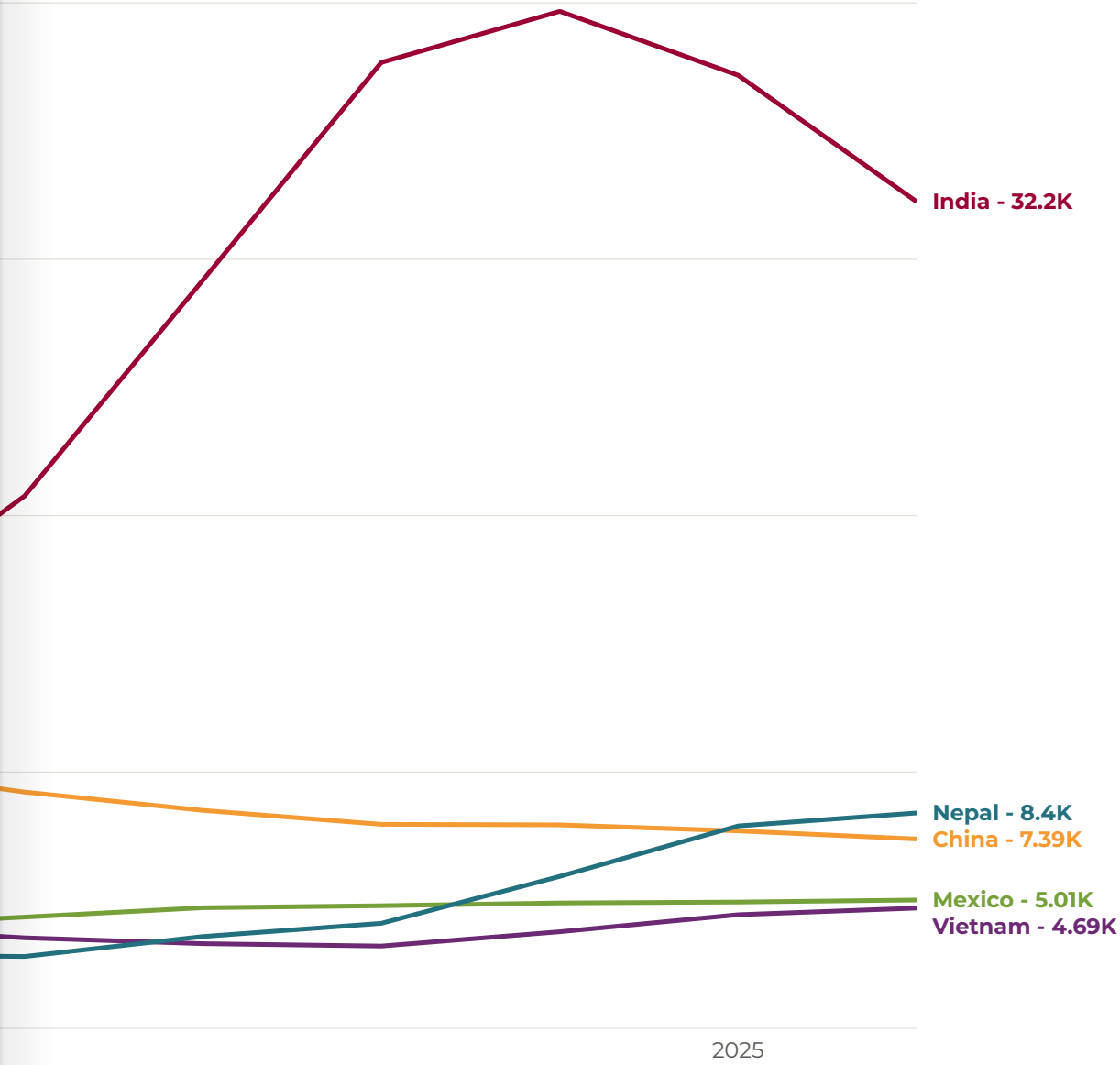
Figure 2 Where Do Texas's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one snapshot per year (the latest m

In October 2026, Texas had 91.9K active international students in SEVIS, 3rd of 51. India accounted for 35% of them and Nepal for 9.2%, against 27% and 2.9% nationally.

Students came from 188 countries, but the two largest supplied 44%. The state's total is up 18% since 2014.



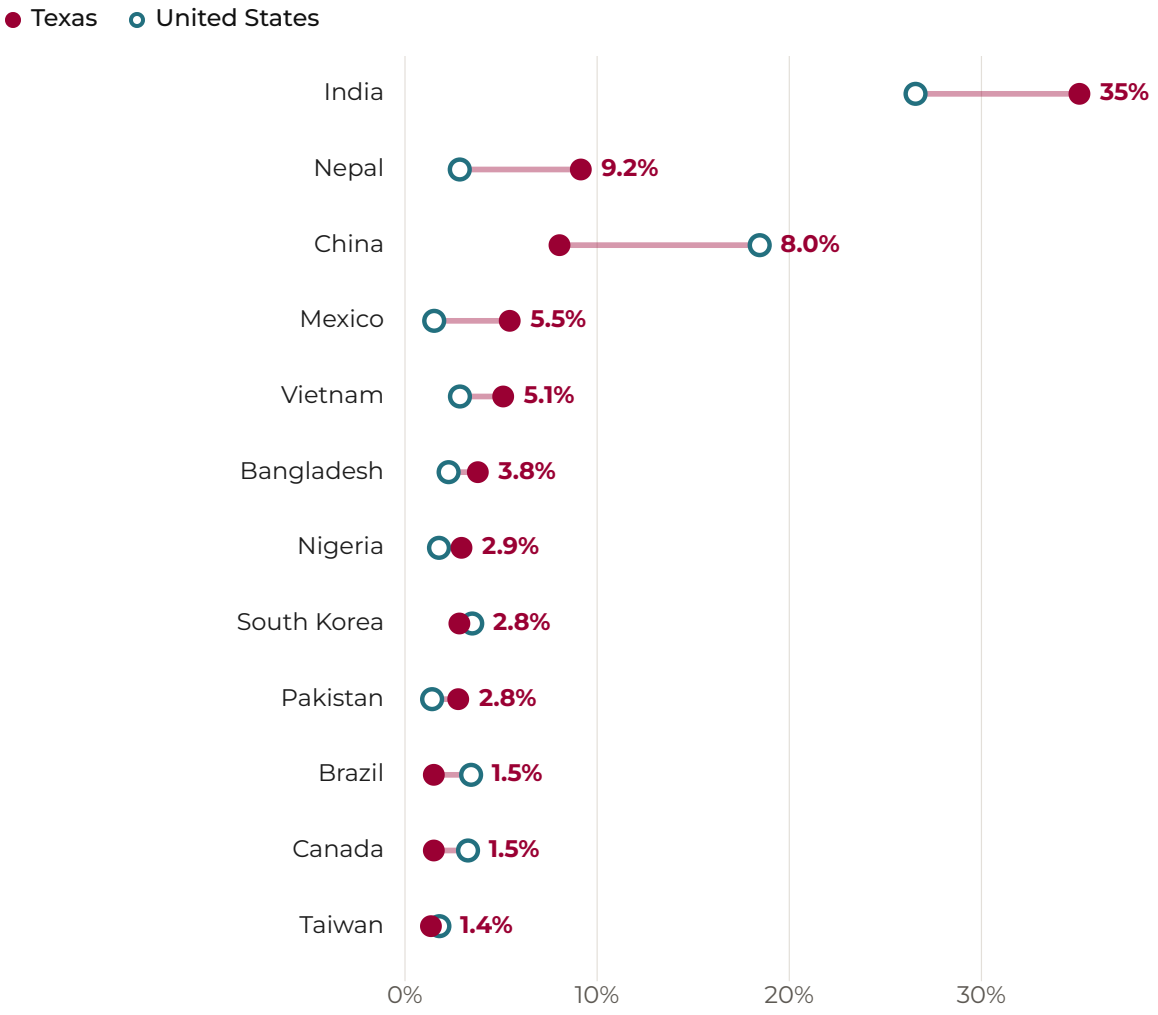
onth available), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

91.9K
Active international students, October 2026
3rd of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

35%
From India
U.S. **27%**

89%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

Figure 3 Is Texas's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

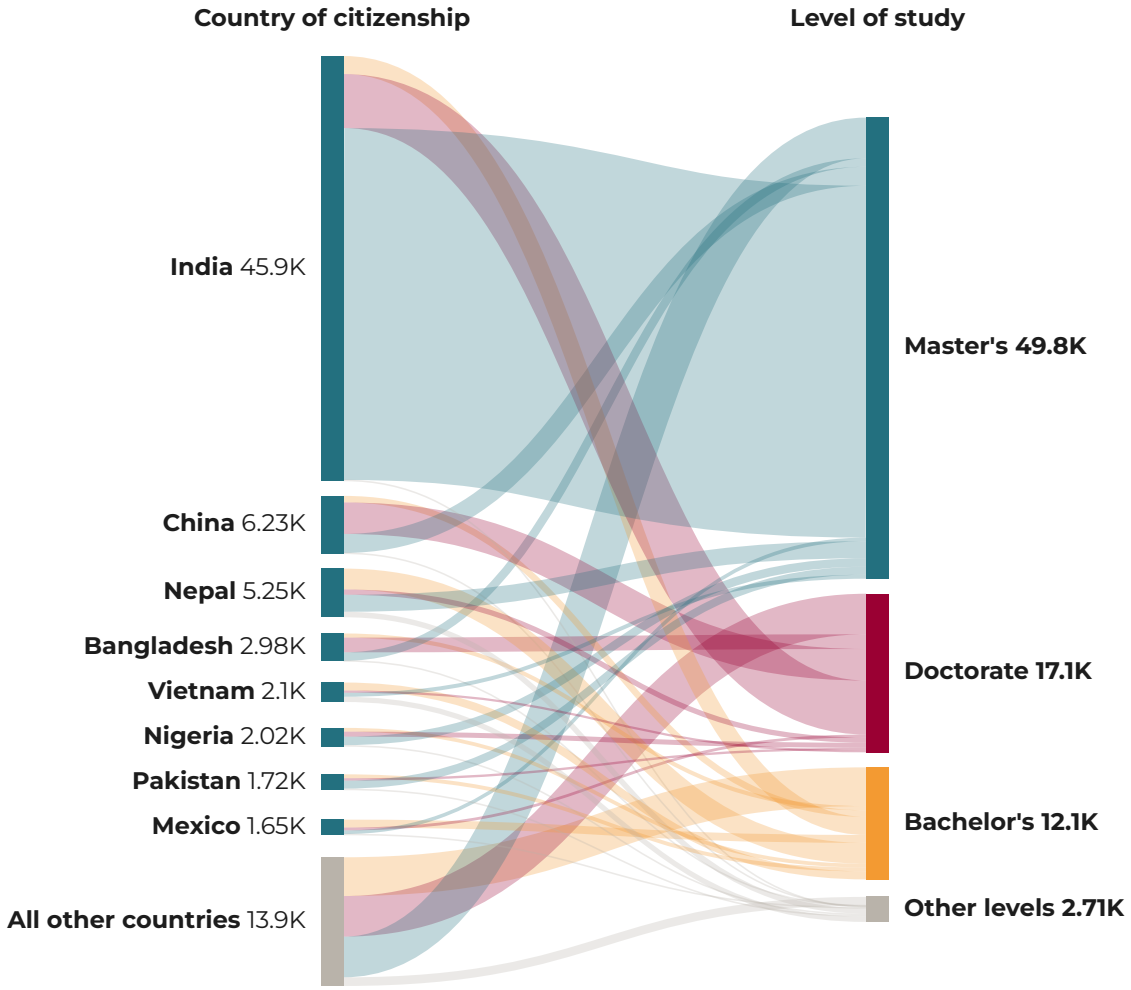
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is one of the 12 countries with the most active F-1 and M-1 student records in Texas in October 2026. The filled dot is the country's share of the state's international students; the open dot is its share of all international students in the United States. Students at every level, from secondary school to doctorate, are counted. Yearly counts are the latest month available in each year.

THE NUMBERS

- **All active international students**: 91.9K in October 2026, 3rd of 51 states (U.S. 1.19M), down 4.3% from 96K in 2025, and up 8.5% since 2015 (84.7K).
- **India**: 35% of the state's international students (U.S. 27%); 32.2K students in 2026, down 13% from 37.2K in 2025, and up 49% since 2015 (21.6K).
- **Nepal**: 9.2% of the state's international students (U.S. 2.9%); 8.4K students in 2026, up 6.4% from 7.89K in 2025, and up 336% since 2015 (1.93K).
- **China**: 8.0% of the state's international students (U.S. 18%); 7.39K students in 2026, down 4.1% from 7.7K in 2025, and down 49% since 2015 (14.6K).

Figure 4 Which Countries Supply Texas's International STEM Students?



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level, October 2026; the eight largest countries. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

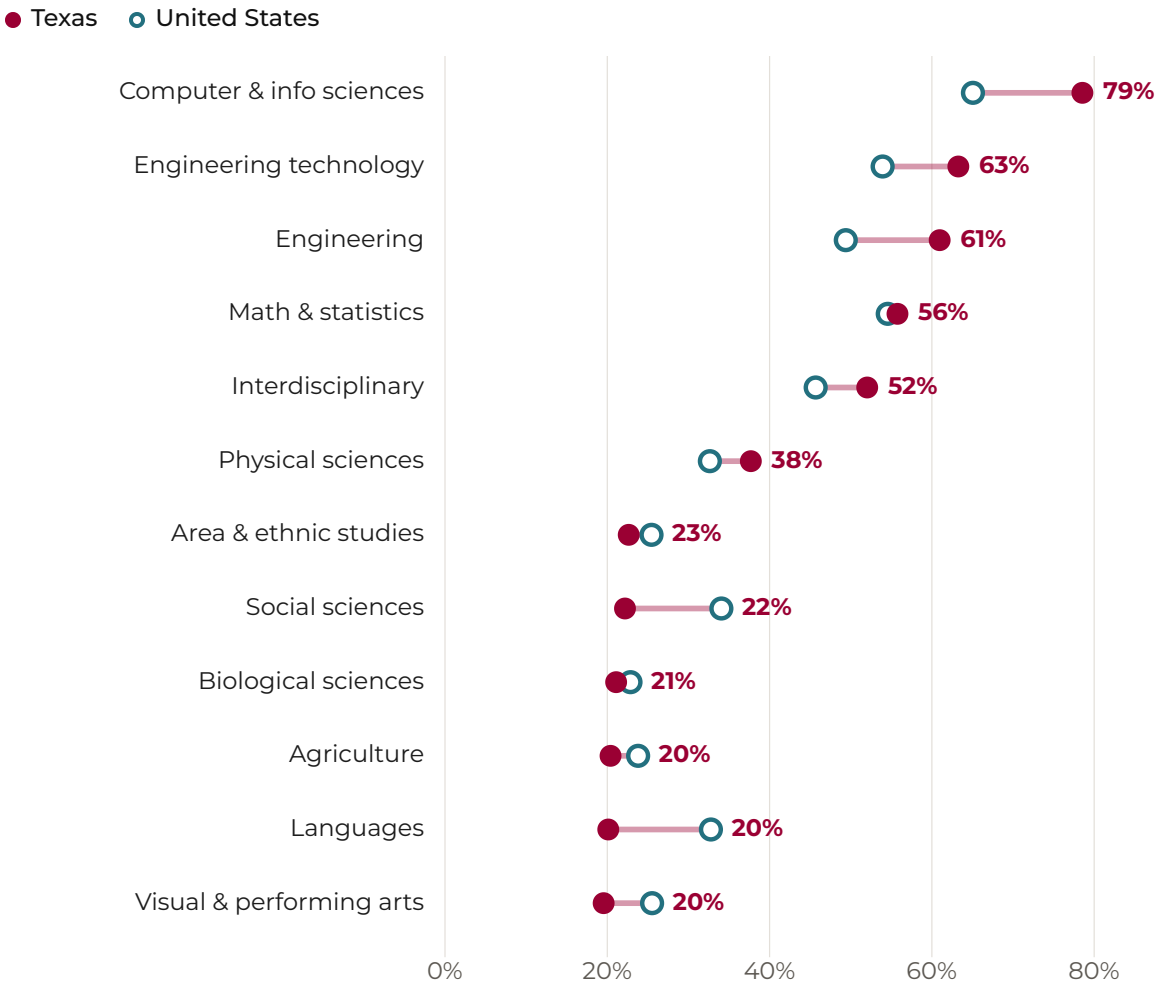
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each band runs from a country of citizenship on the left to a level of study on the right, for international students enrolled in STEM fields in October 2026. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. The eight largest countries are shown and the rest are grouped as all other countries.

THE NUMBERS

- **Share of international students in STEM fields**: 89% in October 2026 (U.S. 63%).
- **Master's level**: 49.8K students; largest countries India (38K), China (2.05K), Nepal (1.83K).
- **Doctorate level**: 17.1K students; largest countries India (5.83K), China (3.4K), Bangladesh (1.59K).
- **Bachelor's level**: 12.1K students; largest countries Nepal (2.25K), India (1.95K), Vietnam (861).
- **Active STEM students**: 81.7K in 2026 (U.S. 749K; 2nd of 51 states), down 4.8% from 85.8K in 2025, and up 91% since 2015 (42.7K).
- **Share of STEM master's students from India**: 76% in 2026 (U.S. 58%; 2nd of 51 states), down 3.8 points from 80% in 2025, and up 1.3 points since 2015 (75%).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Texas in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international shares**: computer & info sciences 79% (U.S. 65%); engineering technology 63% (U.S. 54%); engineering 61% (U.S. 49%).
- **All master's degrees**: 25% in 2025 (U.S. 22%; 11th of 51 states), down 1.0 point from 26% in 2024, and up 4.0 points since 2015 (20%).
- **STEM master's degrees**: 62% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 9th of 51 states), down 1.9 points from 64% in 2024, and up 3.1 points since 2015 (59%).
- **Computer and information sciences master's**: 79% in 2025 (U.S. 65%; 13th of 47 states), down 2.2 points from 81% in 2024, and up 2.6 points since 2015 (76%).

Table 1 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	7.4% / 8.6%	**79% / 65%**	70% / 56%
Engineering	5.8% / 7.2%	**61% / 49%**	59% / 55%
Engineering technology	2.8% / 4.5%	**63% / 54%**	65% / 42%
Math & statistics	6.7% / 17%	**56% / 55%**	52% / 53%
Physical sciences	4.3% / 6.0%	**38% / 33%**	43% / 38%
Biological sciences	2.0% / 3.4%	**21% / 23%**	31% / 23%
Natural resources	0.8% / 2.0%	**16% / 17%**	23% / 27%
Architecture	4.8% / 7.3%	**15% / 29%**	53% / 55%

International share in Texas / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

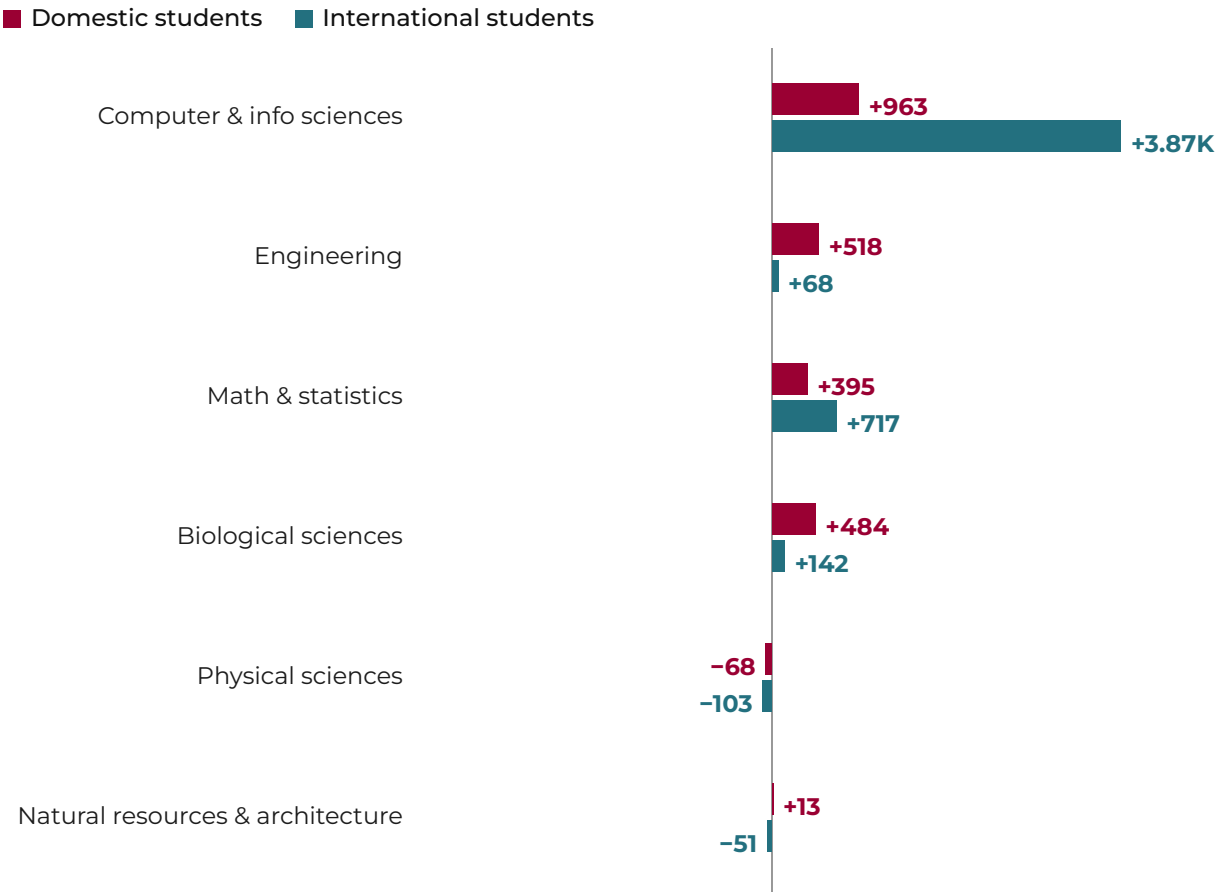
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Texas first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international share among STEM master's fields**: computer & info sciences, 79% (U.S. 65%).
- **STEM fields where international students earn a majority of master's degrees**: 4.
- **International share of STEM bachelor's**: 4.7% in 2025 (U.S. 6.6%; 30th of 51 states), up 0.4 points from 4.3% in 2024, and down 1.0 point since 2015 (5.8%).
- **International share of STEM master's**: 62% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 9th of 51 states), down 1.9 points from 64% in 2024, and up 3.1 points since 2015 (59%).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 50% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 9th of 51 states), down 4.3 points from 54% in 2024, and down 3.3 points since 2015 (53%).

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Texas between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

THE NUMBERS

- **STEM master's degrees**: 16.9K in 2025, against 9.92K in 2015: +4.64K for international students and +2.31K for domestic students.
- **Computer & info sciences**: +963 for domestic students and +3.87K for international students.
- **Engineering**: +518 for domestic students and +68 for international students.
- **Math & statistics**: +395 for domestic students and +717 for international students.
- **International students' STEM master's degrees**: 10.5K in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 2nd of 51 states), down 2.6% from 10.8K in 2024, and up 79% since 2015 (5.9K).

Table 2 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	2.84K	**7.67K**	+170%	6.03K	76%	79%
Engineering	4.36K	**4.95K**	+13%	3.03K	68%	61%
Math & statistics	432	**1.54K**	+257%	861	33%	56%
Biological sciences	939	**1.56K**	+67%	330	20%	21%
Physical sciences	691	**520**	−25%	196	43%	38%
Natural resources & architecture	660	**622**	−5.8%	94	22%	15%

STEM master's degrees awarded in Texas, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Texas in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

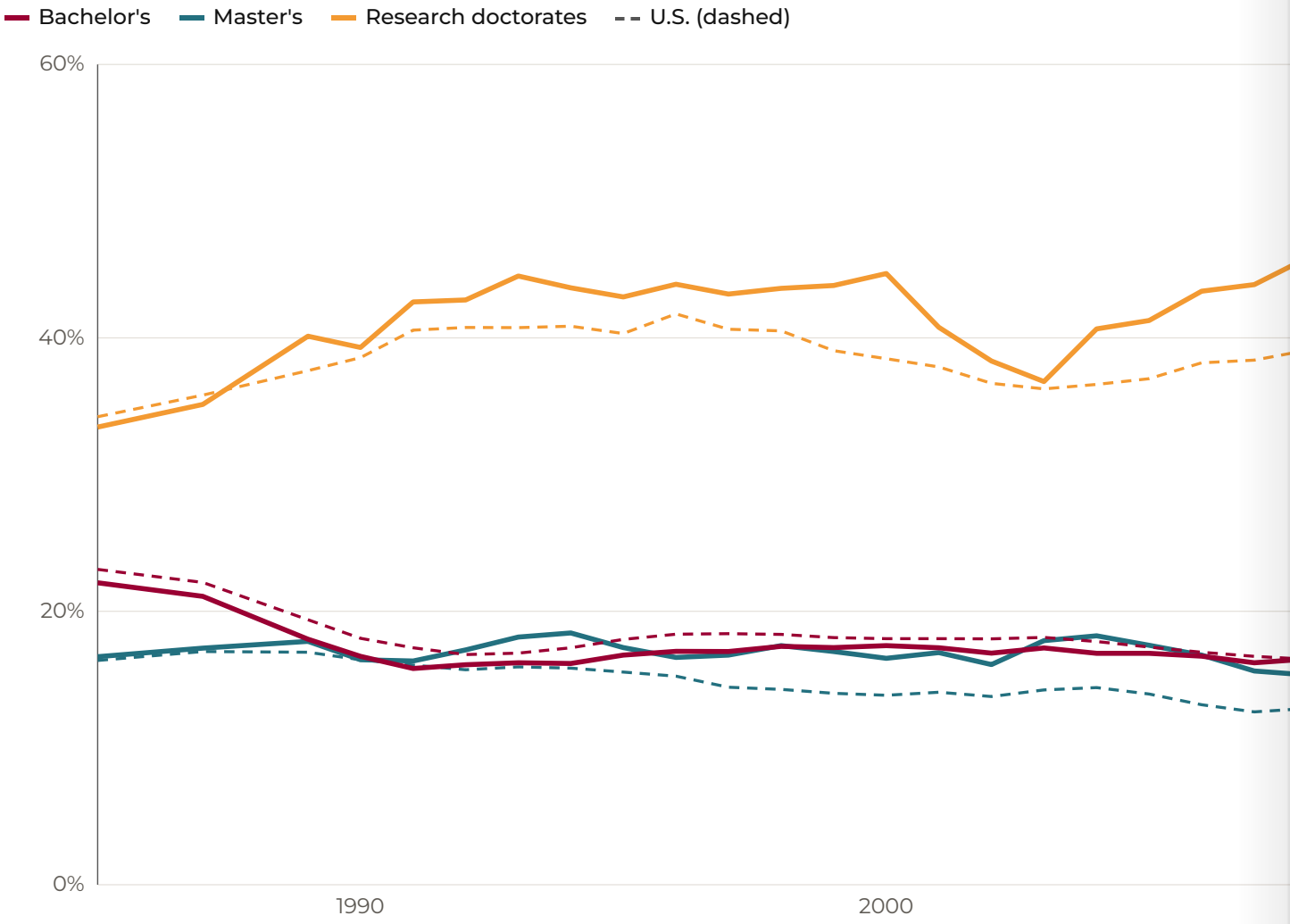
THE NUMBERS

- **STEM share of master's degrees**: 27% in 2025 (U.S. 23%; 12th of 51 states), down 0.4 points from 27% in 2024, and up 6.4 points since 2015 (20%).
- **Share of all U.S. international STEM master's**: 9.0% in 2025 (2nd of 51 states), down 0.9 points from 9.9% in 2024, and down 2.0 points since 2015 (11%).
- **STEM master's degrees per research doctorate**: 6.4 in 2025 (U.S. 6.4; 19th of 51 states), down 0.1 from 6.6 in 2024, and up 2.0 since 2015 (4.4).

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

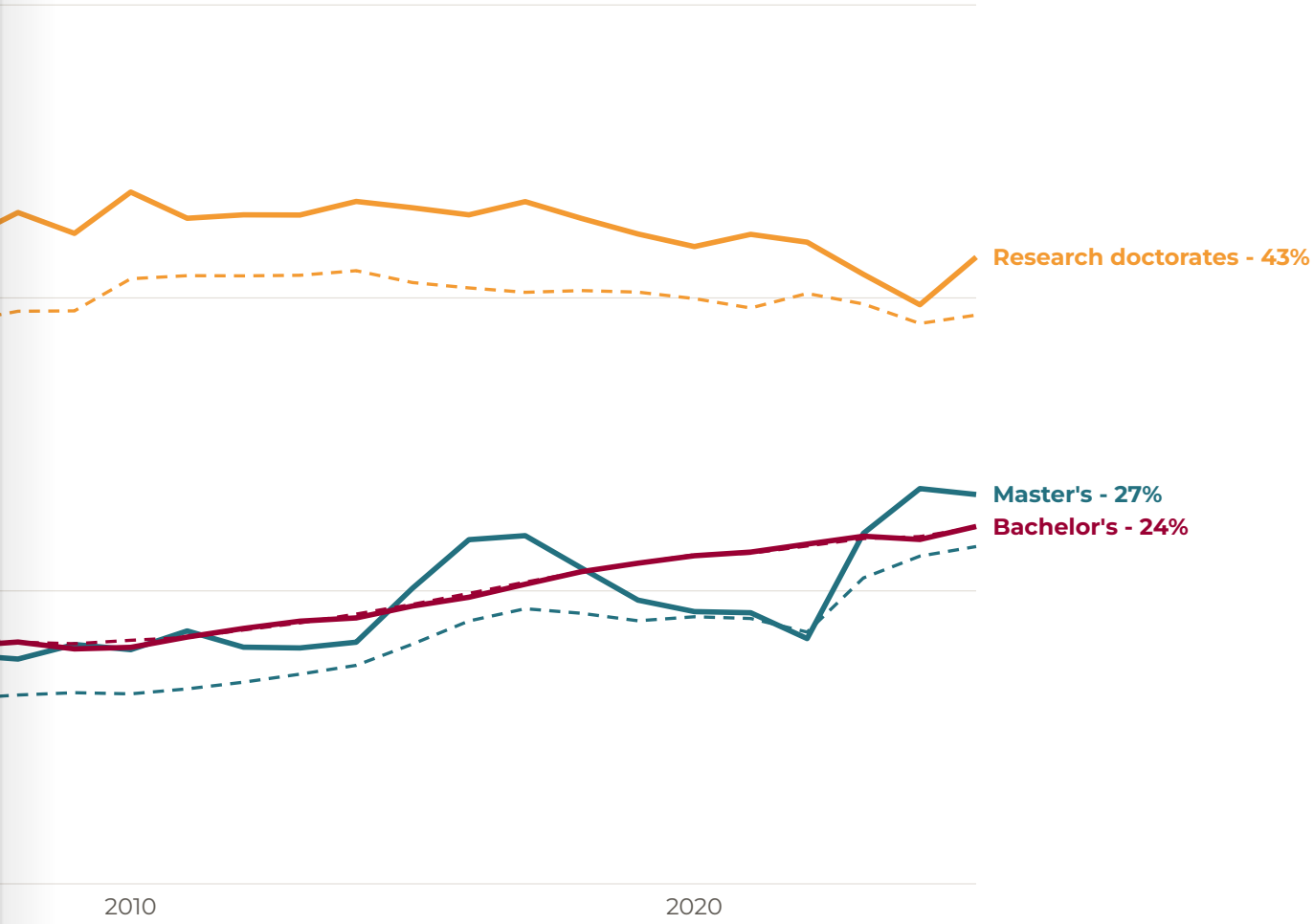
Figure 7 How Much of Texas's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 24% of Texas's bachelor's degrees, 27% of its master's and 43% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 6.4 points since 2015, and the state ranks 12th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 18th of 51.



24%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **18th** of 51 · +5.4 pp since 2015

27%

STEM share of master's, 2025

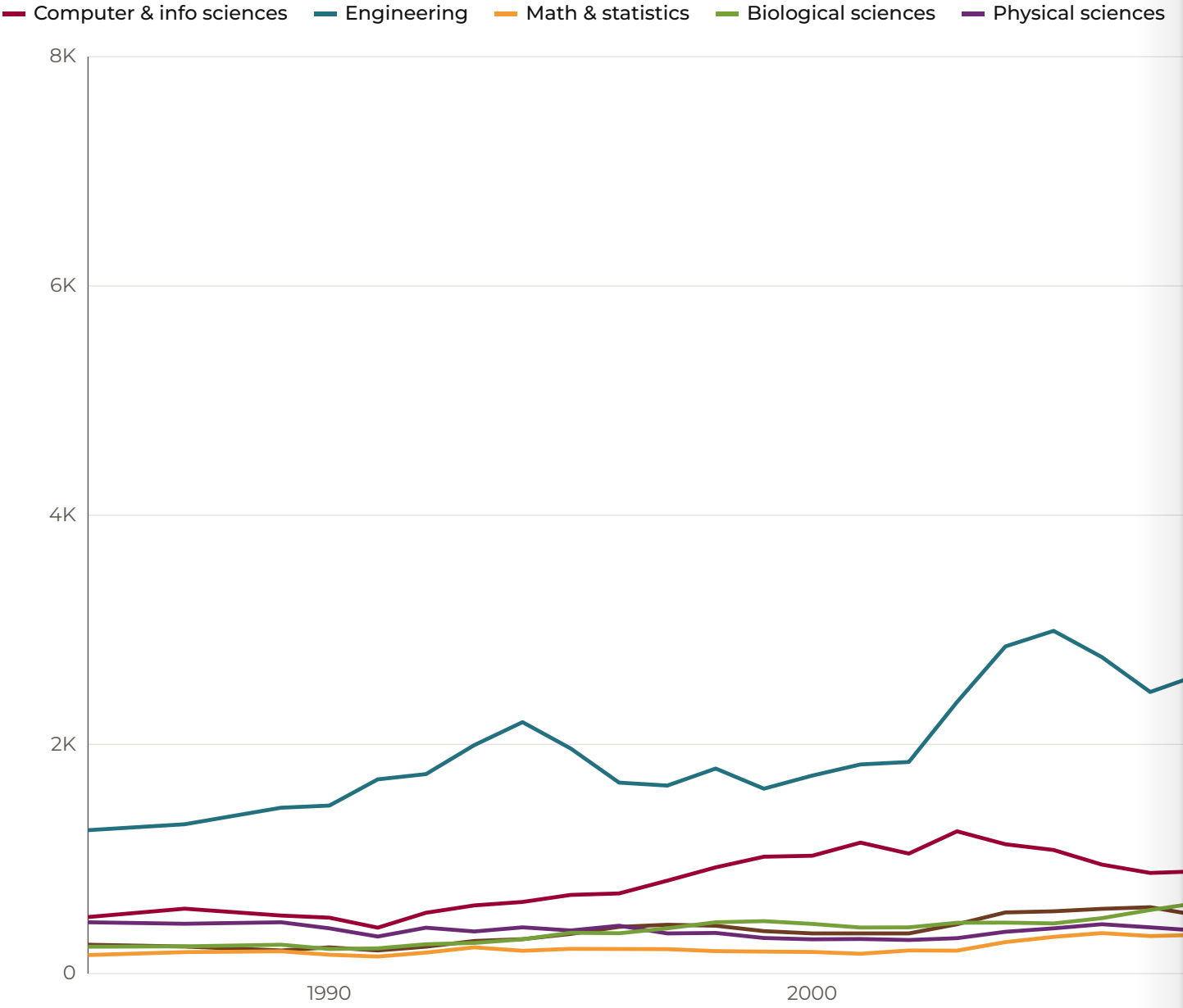
U.S. **23%** · **12th** of 51 · +6.4 pp since 2015

43%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **24th** of 51 · −3.4 pp since 2015

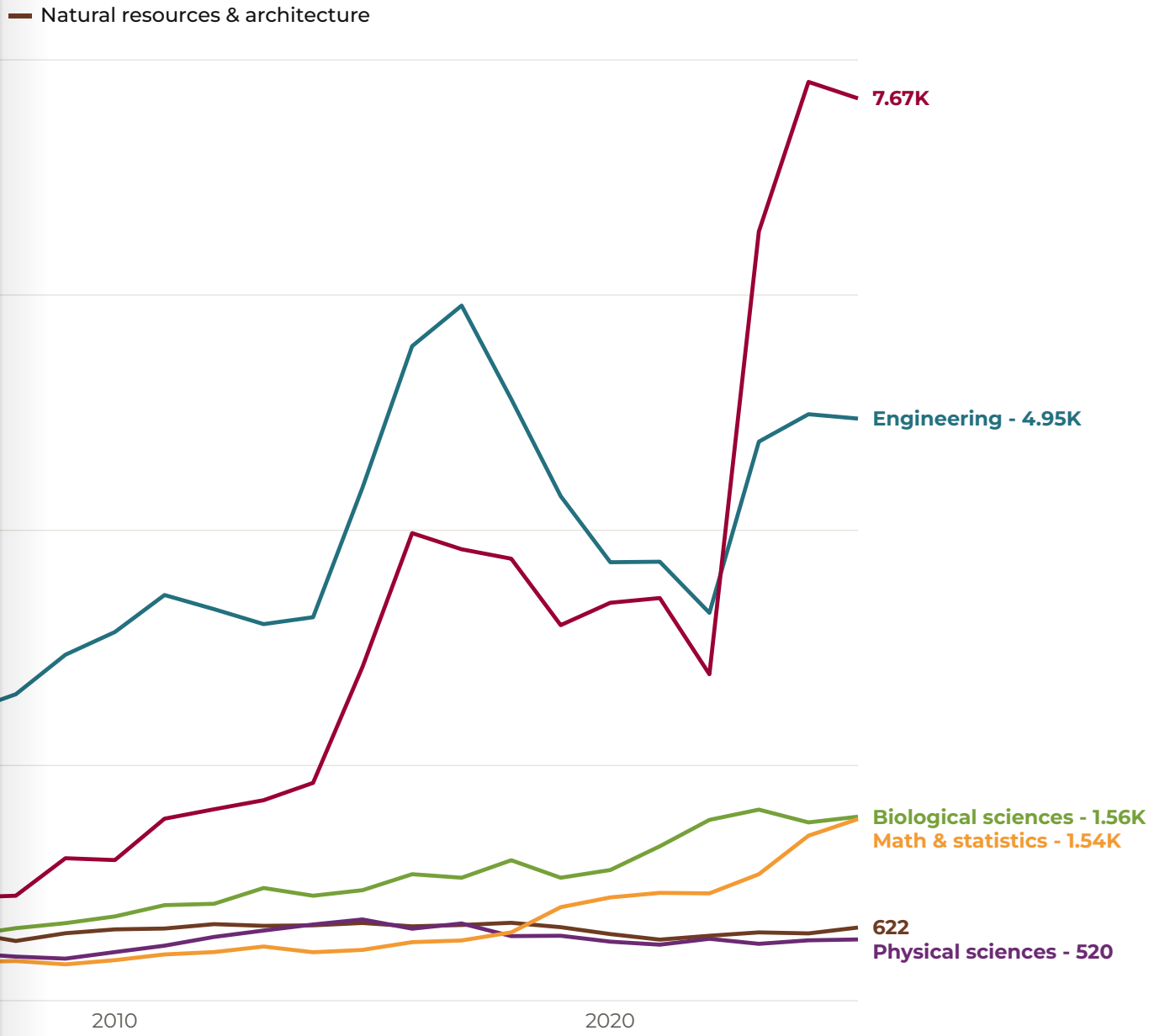
Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Texas's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 7.67K, followed by engineering (4.95K) and biological sciences (1.56K). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 170% since 2015.

International students earned 10.5K of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 9.0% of the national total (2nd of 51).



10.5K

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **2nd** of 51 · +79% since 2015

9.0%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

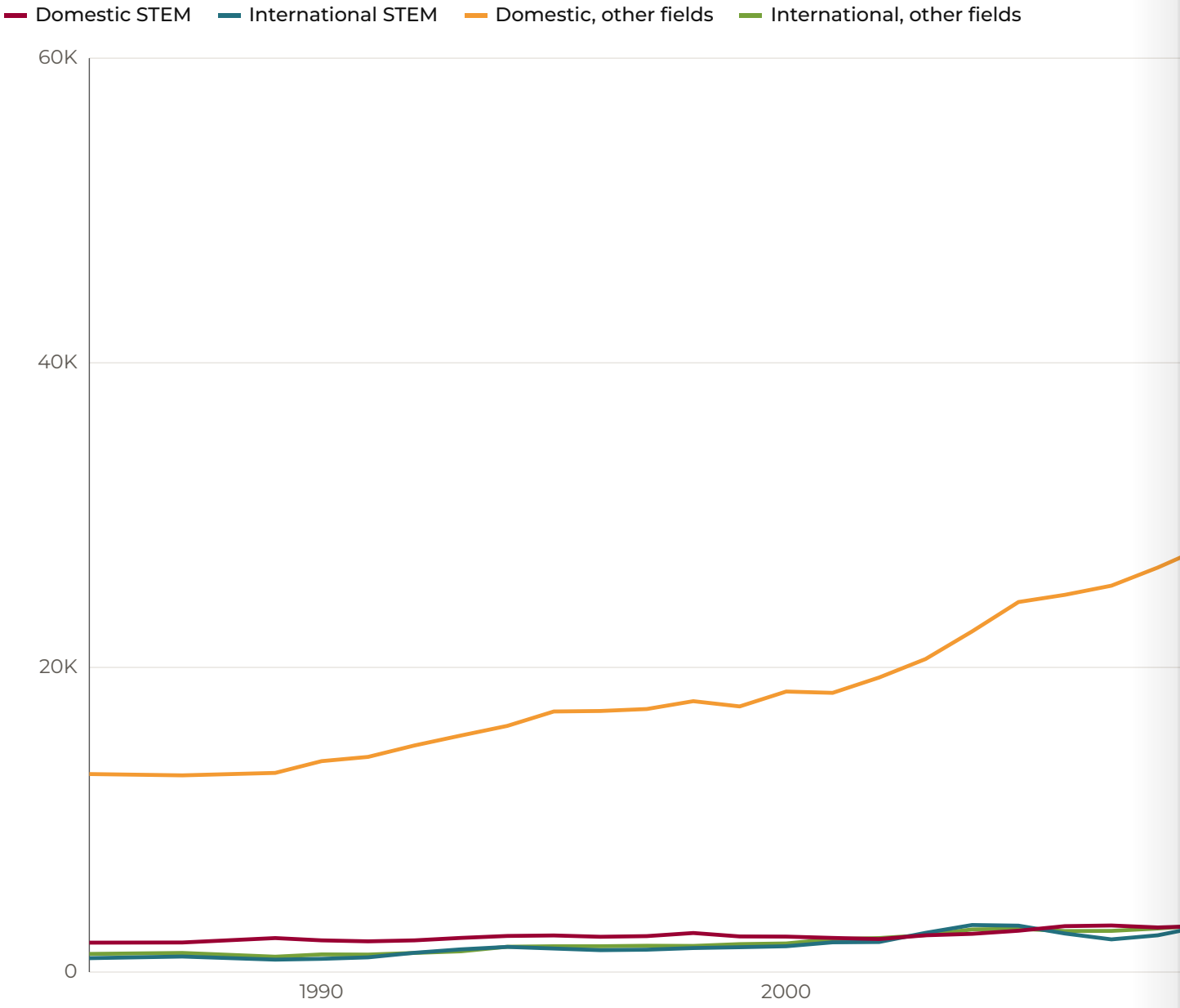
U.S. **100%** · **2nd** of 51 · −2.0 pp since 2015

79%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **13th** of 47 · +2.6 pp since 2015

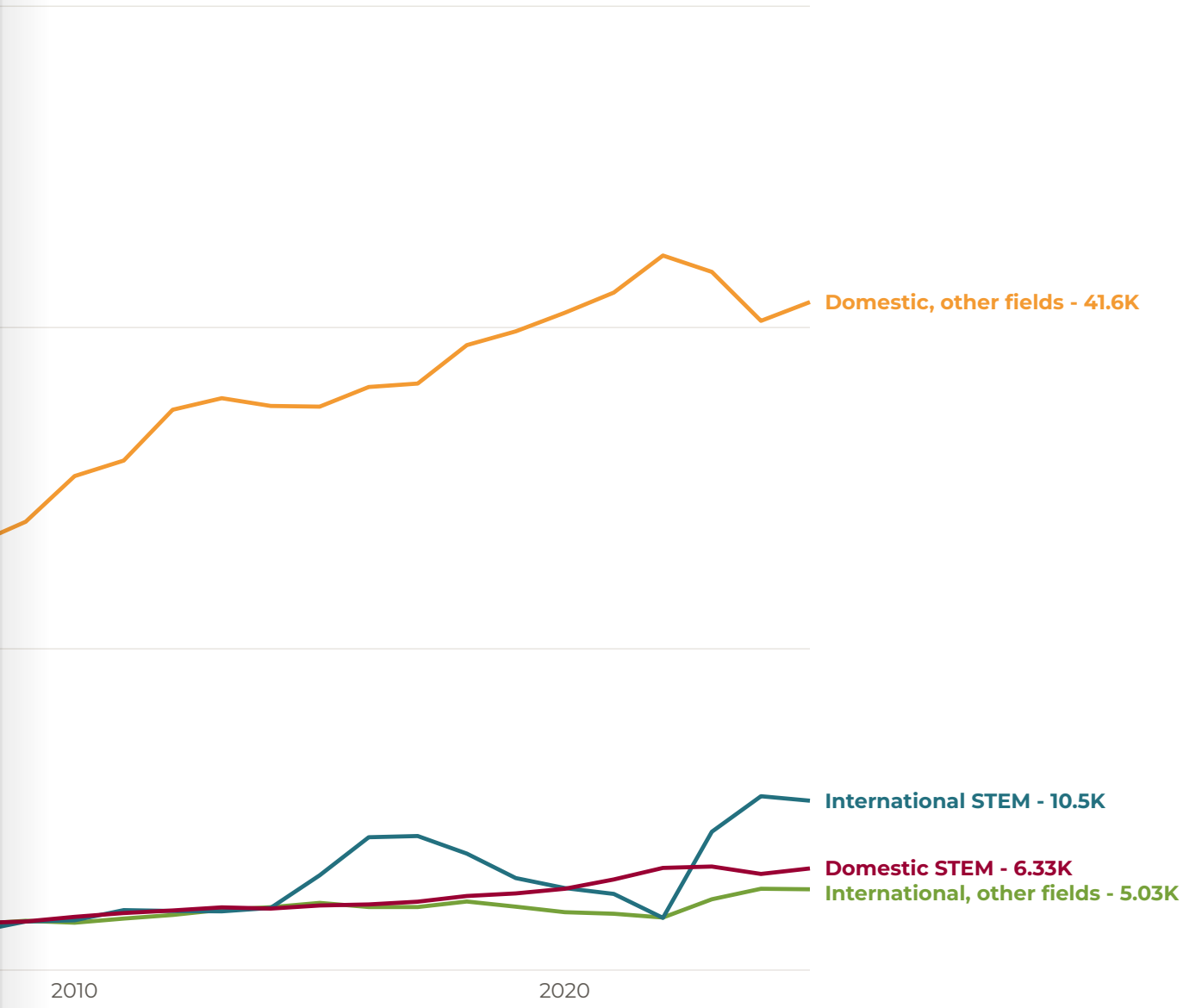
Figure 9 Who Earns Texas's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 4.64K more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 2.31K more to domestic students.

International students earn 62% of Texas's STEM master's but 11% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).



25%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **11th** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

62%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **9th** of 51 · +3.1 pp since 2015

6.4

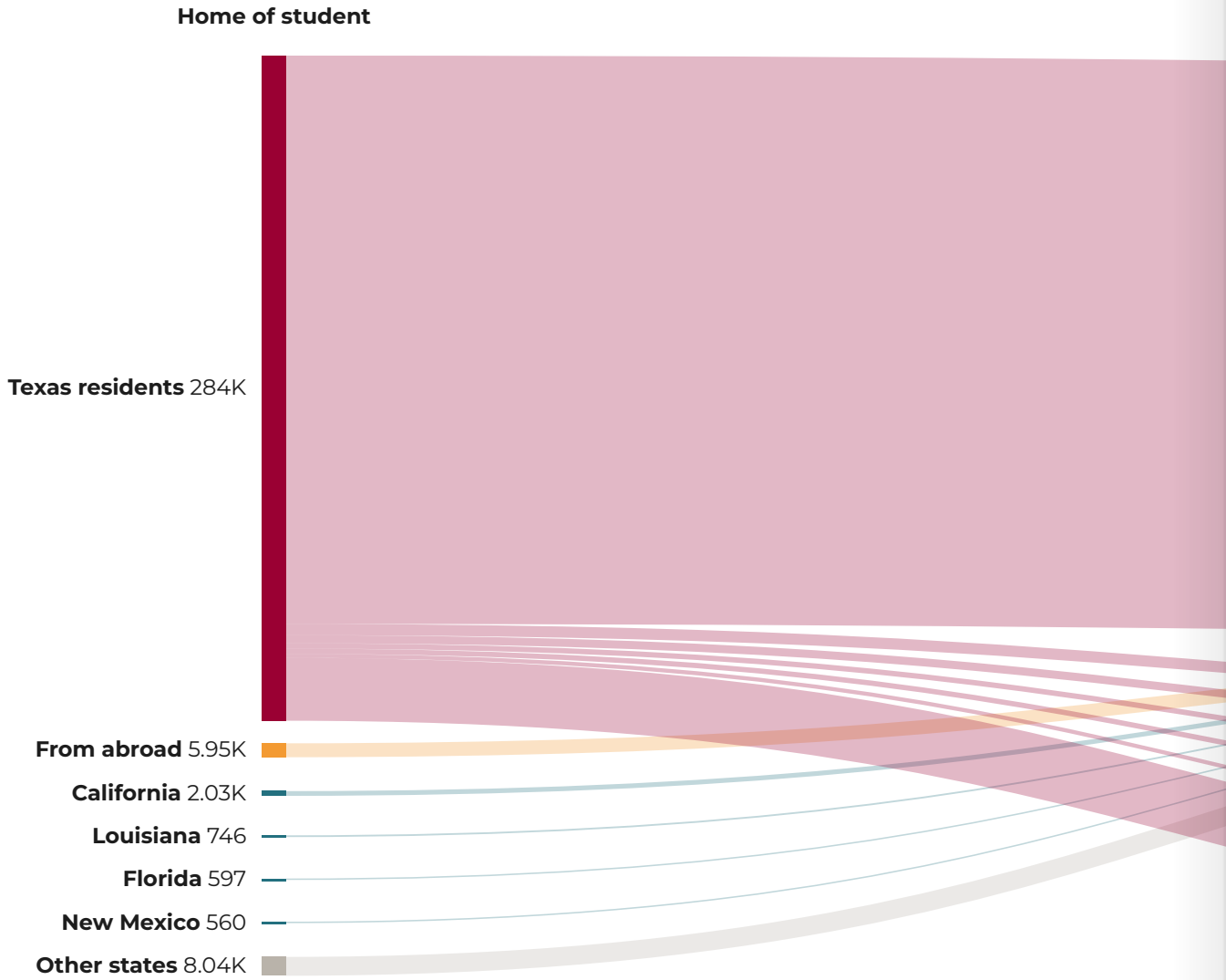
STEM master's per doctorate, 2025

U.S. **6.4** · **19th** of 51 · +2.0 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

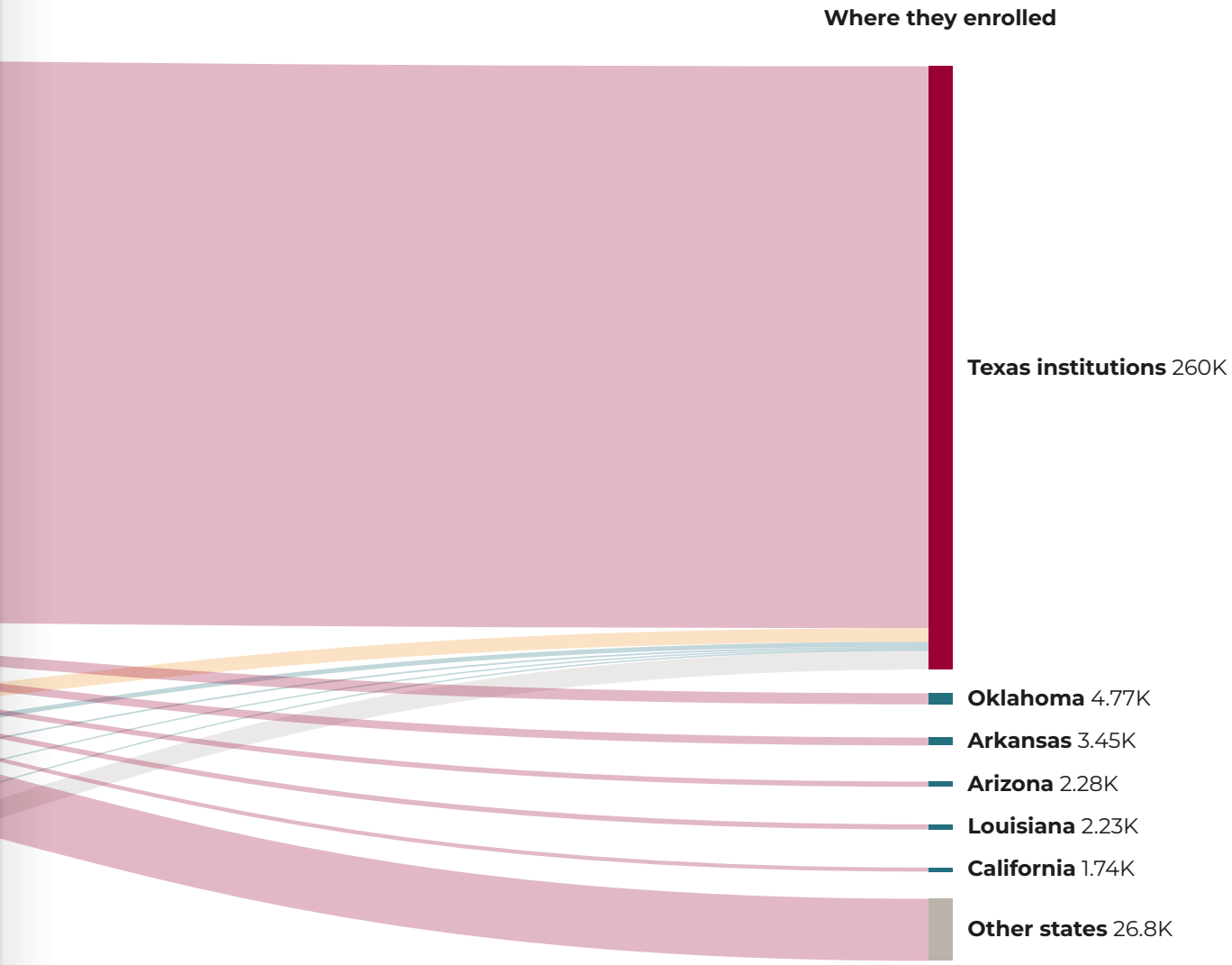
Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest s

242K residents stayed in Texas for college in fall 2024; 12K students arrived from other states and 5.95K from abroad, while 41.2K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 92% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).



ources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

92%

First-time students from in state, 2024

· **1st** of 51 · −0.6 pp since 2016

2.3%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

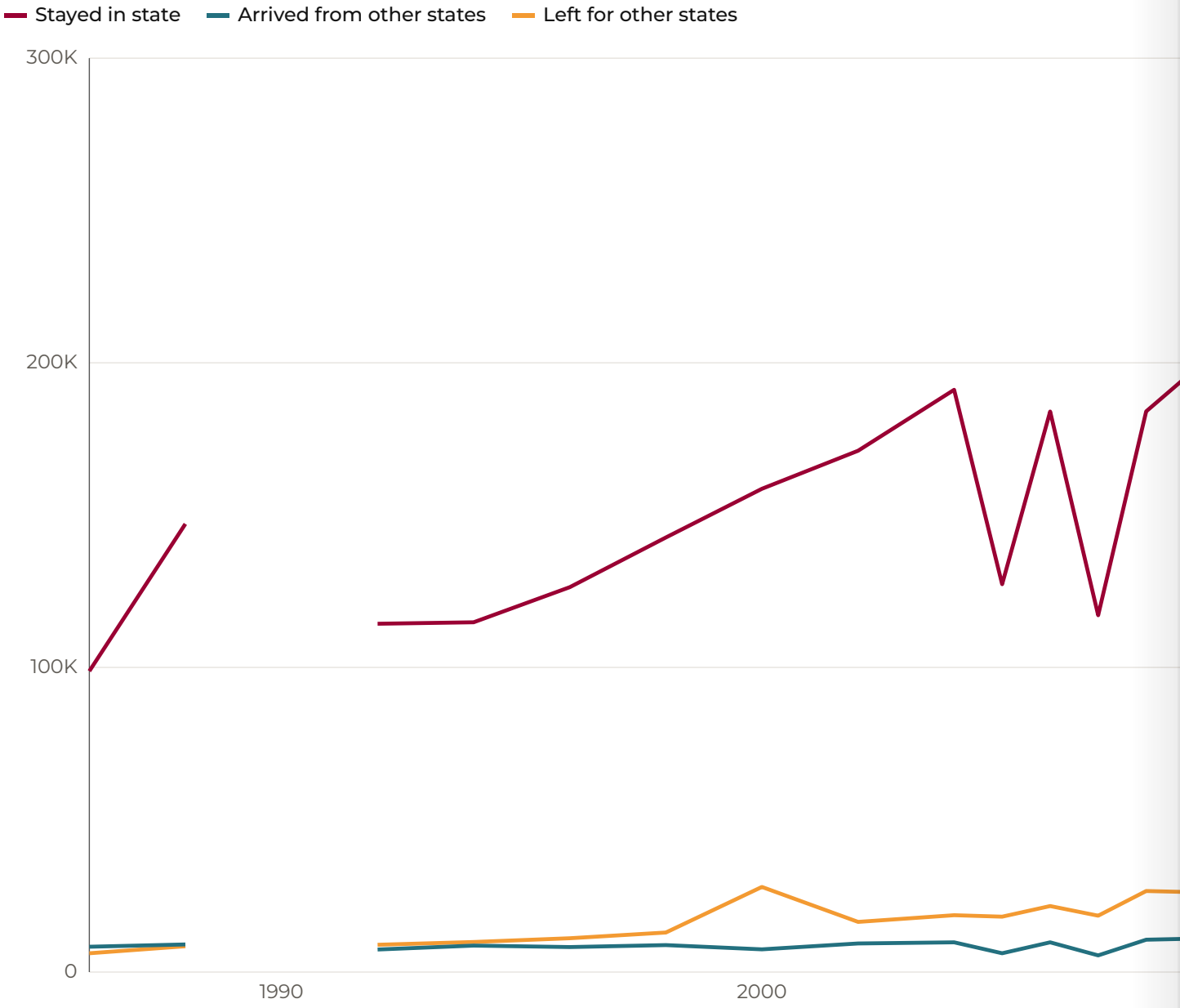
U.S. **3.1%** · **33rd** of 51 · +0.7 pp since 2016

−10

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

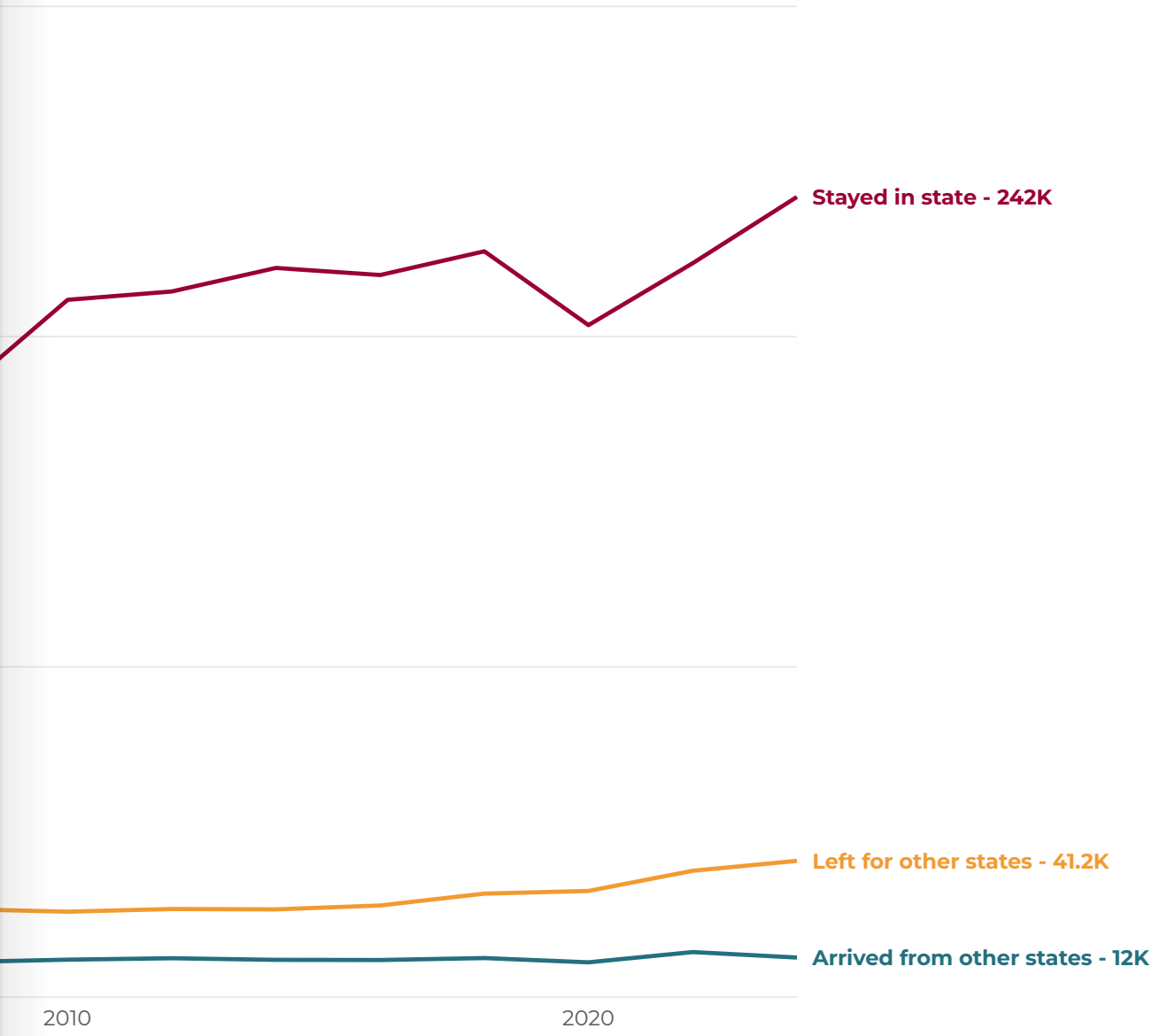
· **43rd** of 51 · −3.6 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



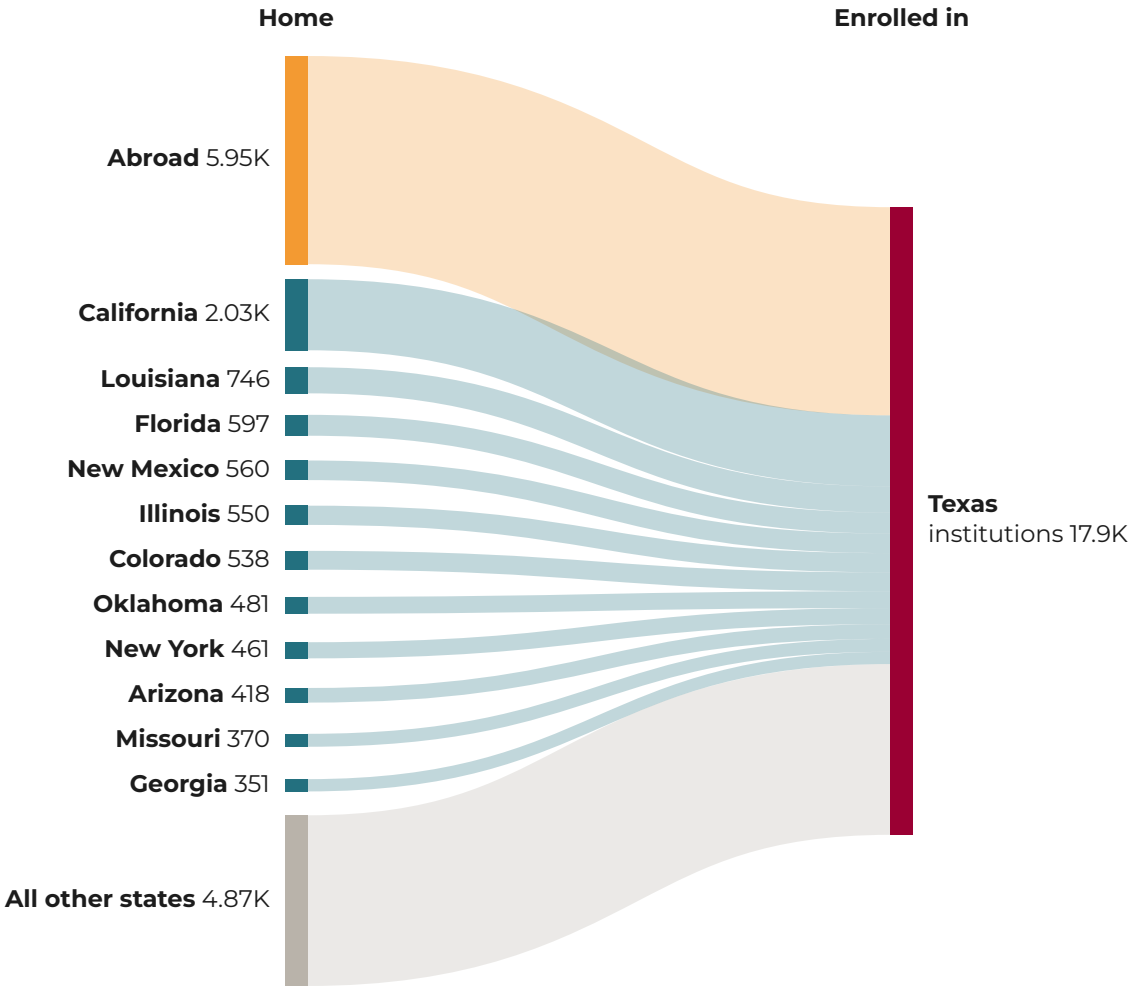
First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is up 11%, arrivals from other states are up 7%, and residents leaving are up 49%.



Net migration was −10 per 100 resident first-time students (43rd of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Oklahoma (4.77K).

Figure 12 Where Do Texas's Newcomers Come From?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

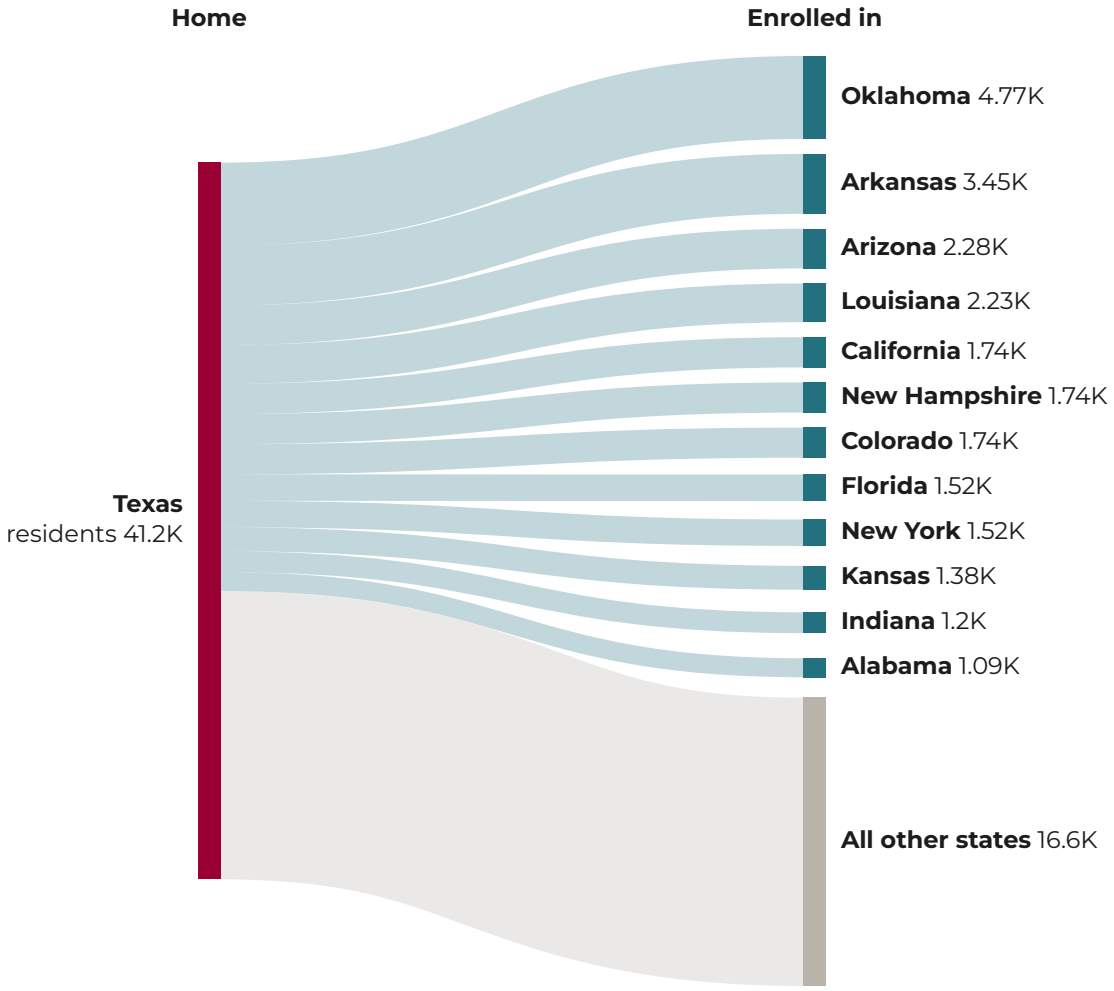
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Texas's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

THE NUMBERS

- **Students arriving from other states**: 12K in fall 2024, down 12% from 13.6K in fall 2022, and up 6.7% since fall 2016 (11.2K).
- **Students arriving from abroad**: 5.95K in fall 2024.
- **Largest home states**: California (2.03K), Louisiana (746), Florida (597).
- **Share of first-time students from outside the U.S.**: 2.3% in 2024 (U.S. 3.1%; 33rd of 51 states), up 0.4 points from 1.9% in 2022, and up 0.7 points since 2016 (1.6%).

Figure 13 Where Do Texas's Residents Go When They Leave?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where Texas residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

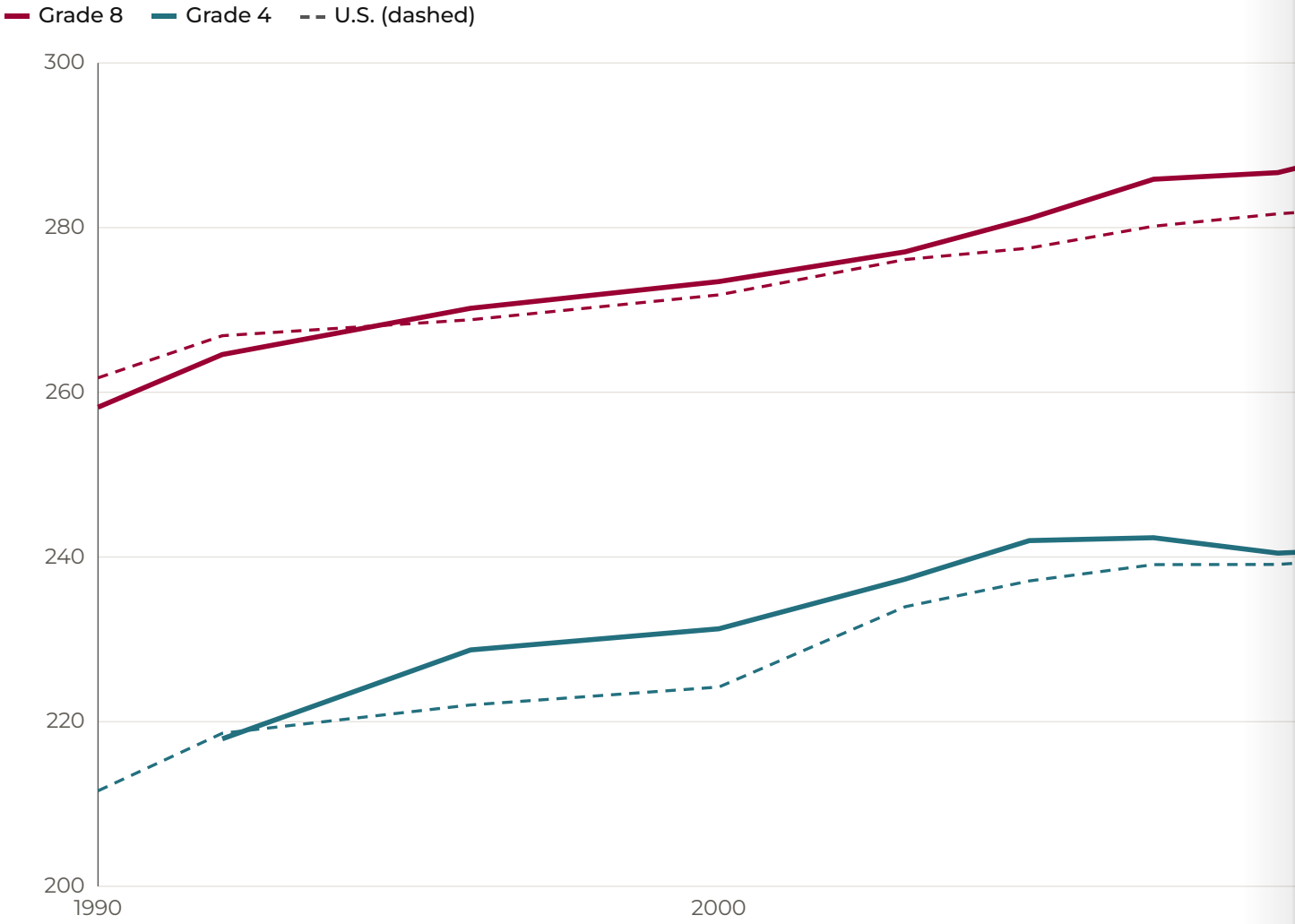
THE NUMBERS

- **Residents leaving for other states**: 41.2K in fall 2024, up 7.8% from 38.2K in fall 2022, and up 49% since fall 2016 (27.7K).
- **Residents staying in the state**: 242K in fall 2024, up 9.0% from 222K in fall 2022, and up 11% since fall 2016 (219K).
- **Largest destinations**: Oklahoma (4.77K), Arkansas (3.45K), Arizona (2.28K).
- **Net migration per 100 resident first-time students**: −10 in 2024 (43rd of 51 states), down 1 from −9 in 2022, and down 4 since 2016 (−7).
- **Share of first-time students who are residents**: 92% in 2024 (1st of 51 states), up 0.2 points from 92% in 2022, and down 0.6 points since 2016 (93%).

SECTION 4

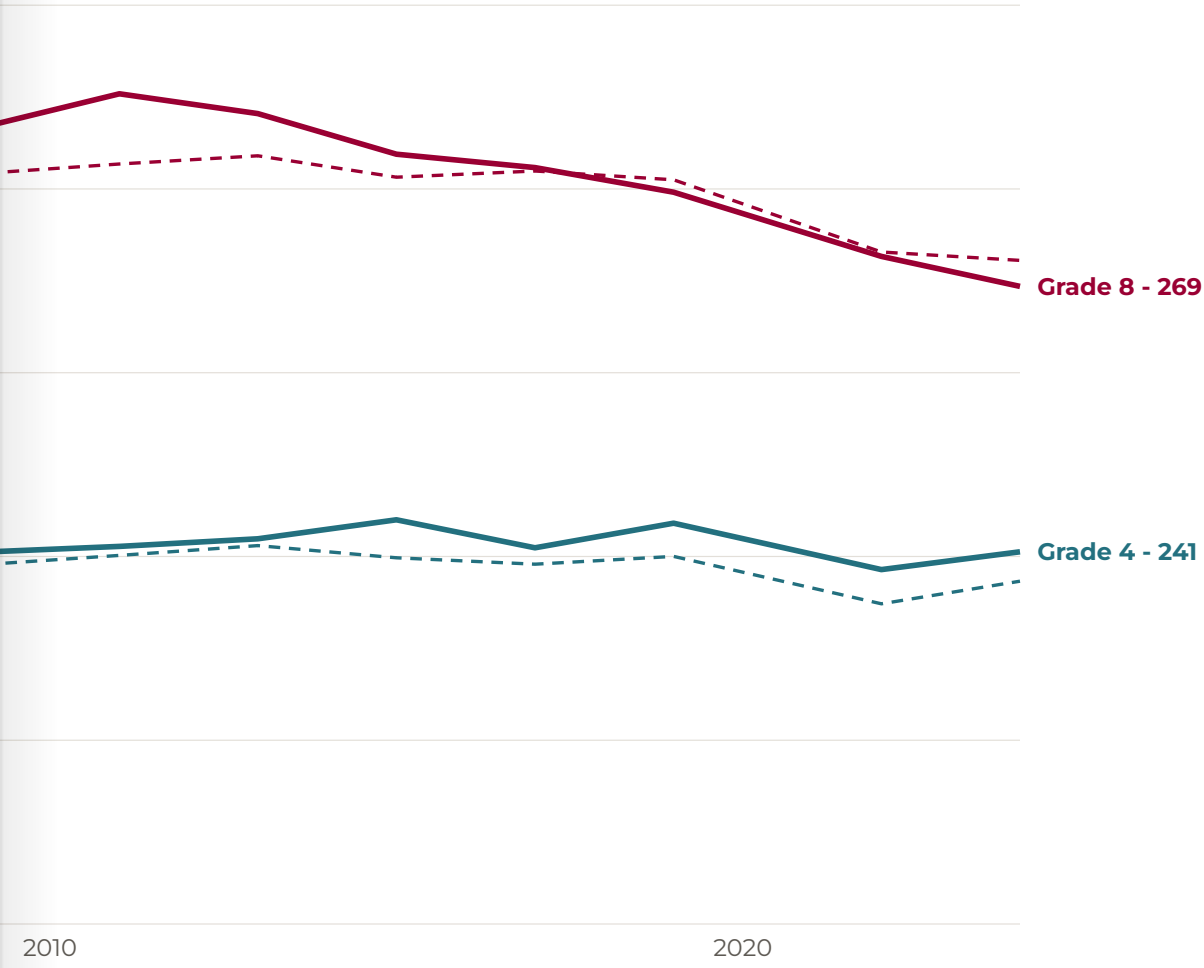
K-12 Preparation

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Texas's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, N

The talent pipeline starts in school. Texas's eighth graders averaged 269 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 34th of 51 among the states. 24% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.



lational Assessment of Educational Progress.

269

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **34th** of 51 · −14.4 since 2015

24%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **36th** of 51 · −8.6 pp since 2015

252

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **257** · **44th** of 51 · −8.4 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Figure 15 How Many of Texas's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temp



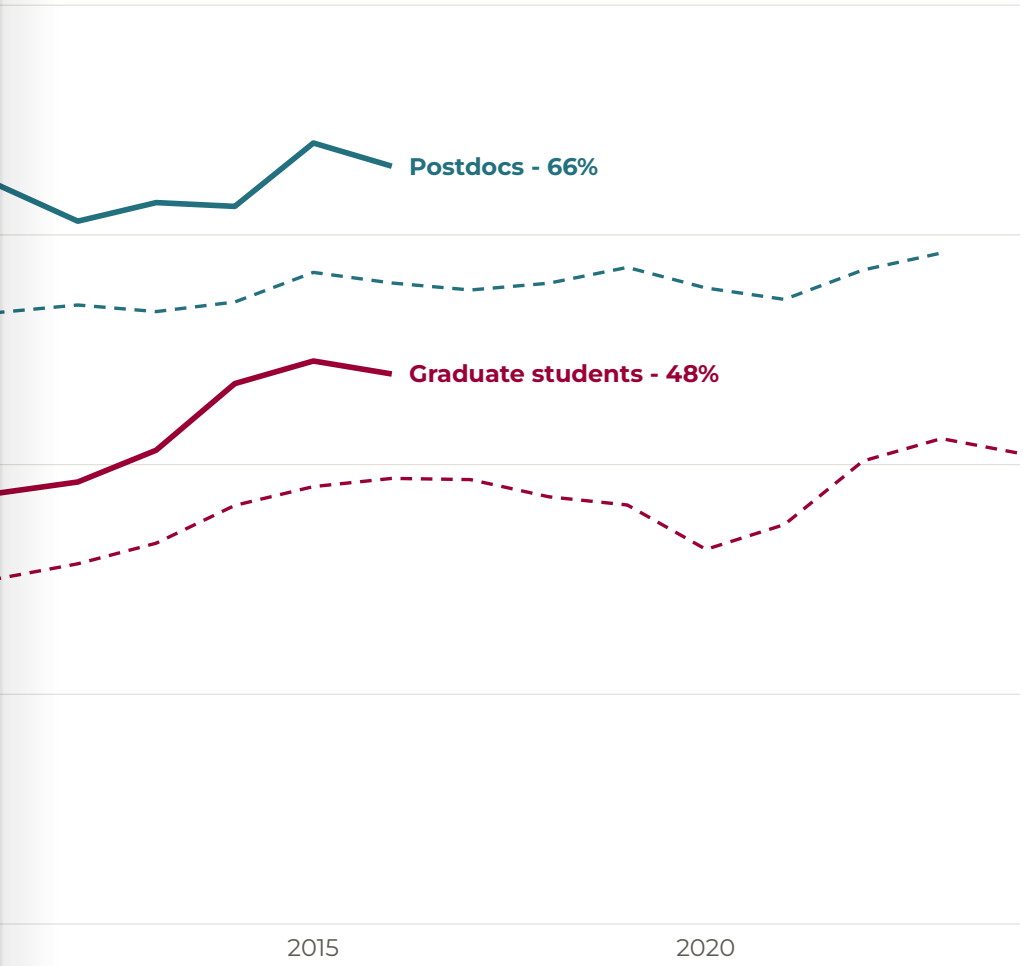
Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's sta
Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 48% of Texas's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 5th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 66% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 4.5K research doctorates in 2025, 7.6% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

porary Visas?



te; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate

48%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **5th** of 51 · −1.1 pp since 2015

66%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **3rd** of 51 · −2.0 pp since 2015

4.5K

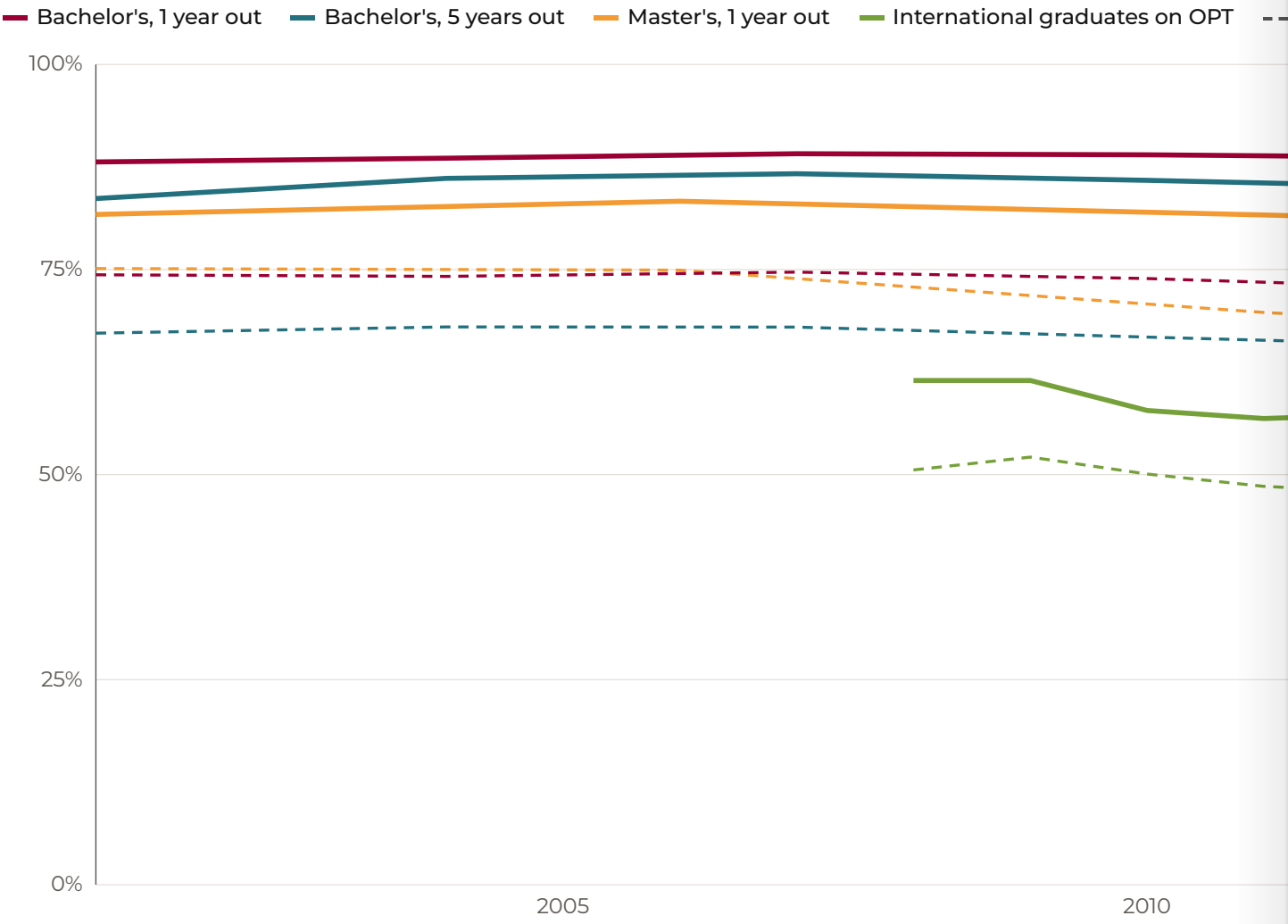
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

U.S. **59K** · **2nd** of 51 · +11% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Figure 16 How Many of Texas's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?

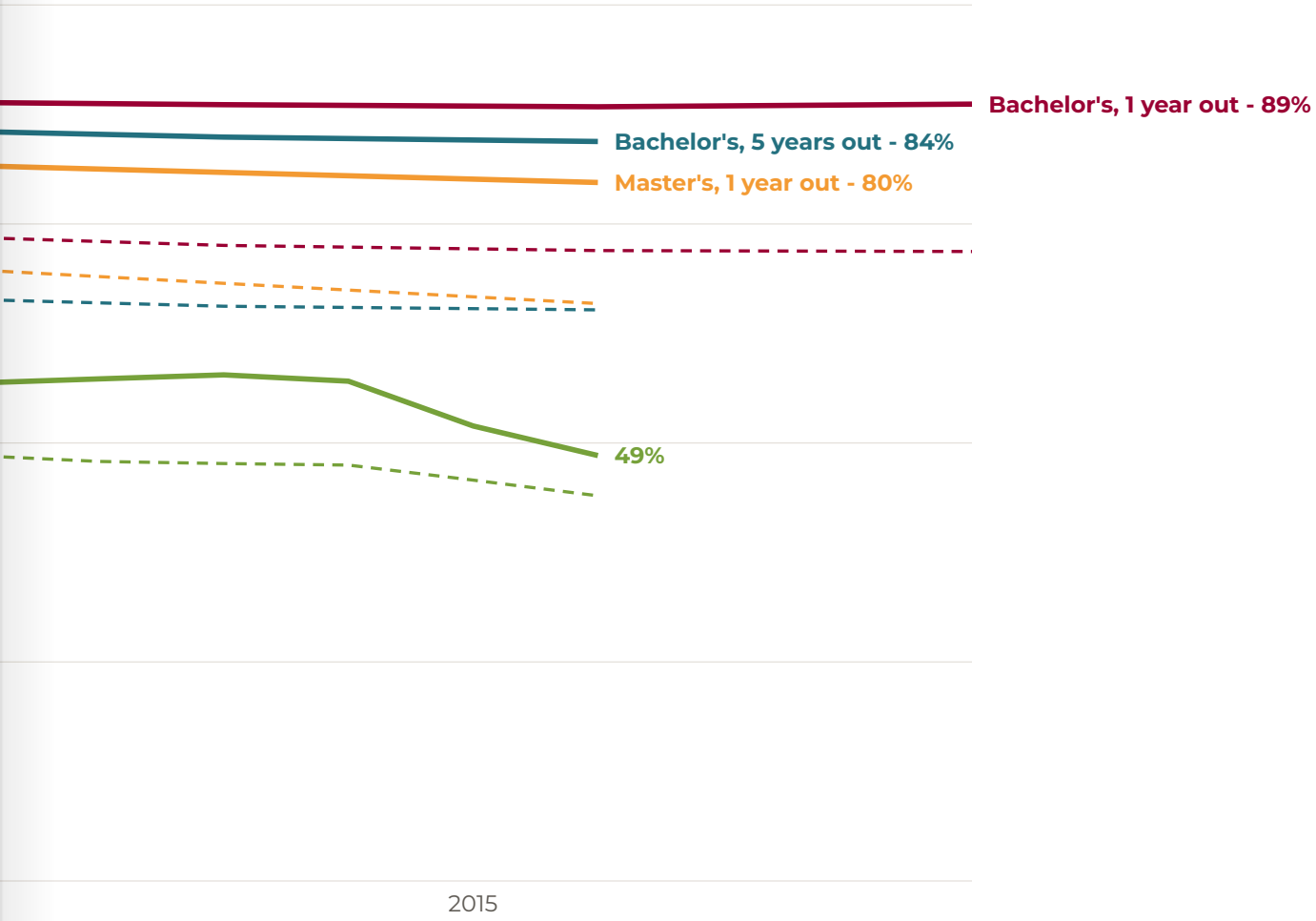


Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or particip

Of Texas's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 89% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 84%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 49% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). Through migration between states, the state gained 3.2 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

U.S. (dashed)



au, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the
pating states dashed.

89%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **1st** of 33 · +0.3 pp since 2016

49%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **13th** of 51 · −3.4 pp since 2015

+3.2

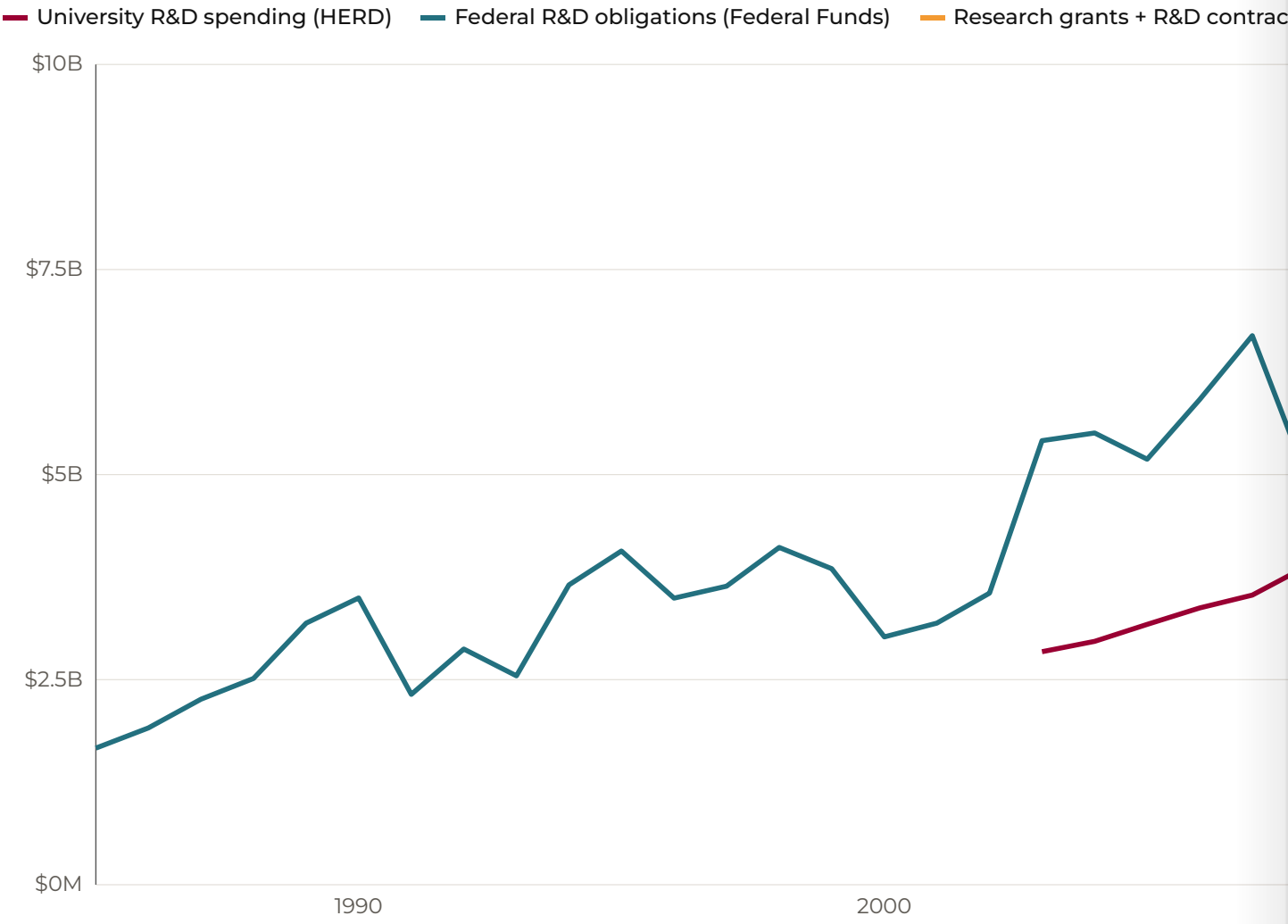
Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

· **18th** of 51 · −5.7 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Texas?

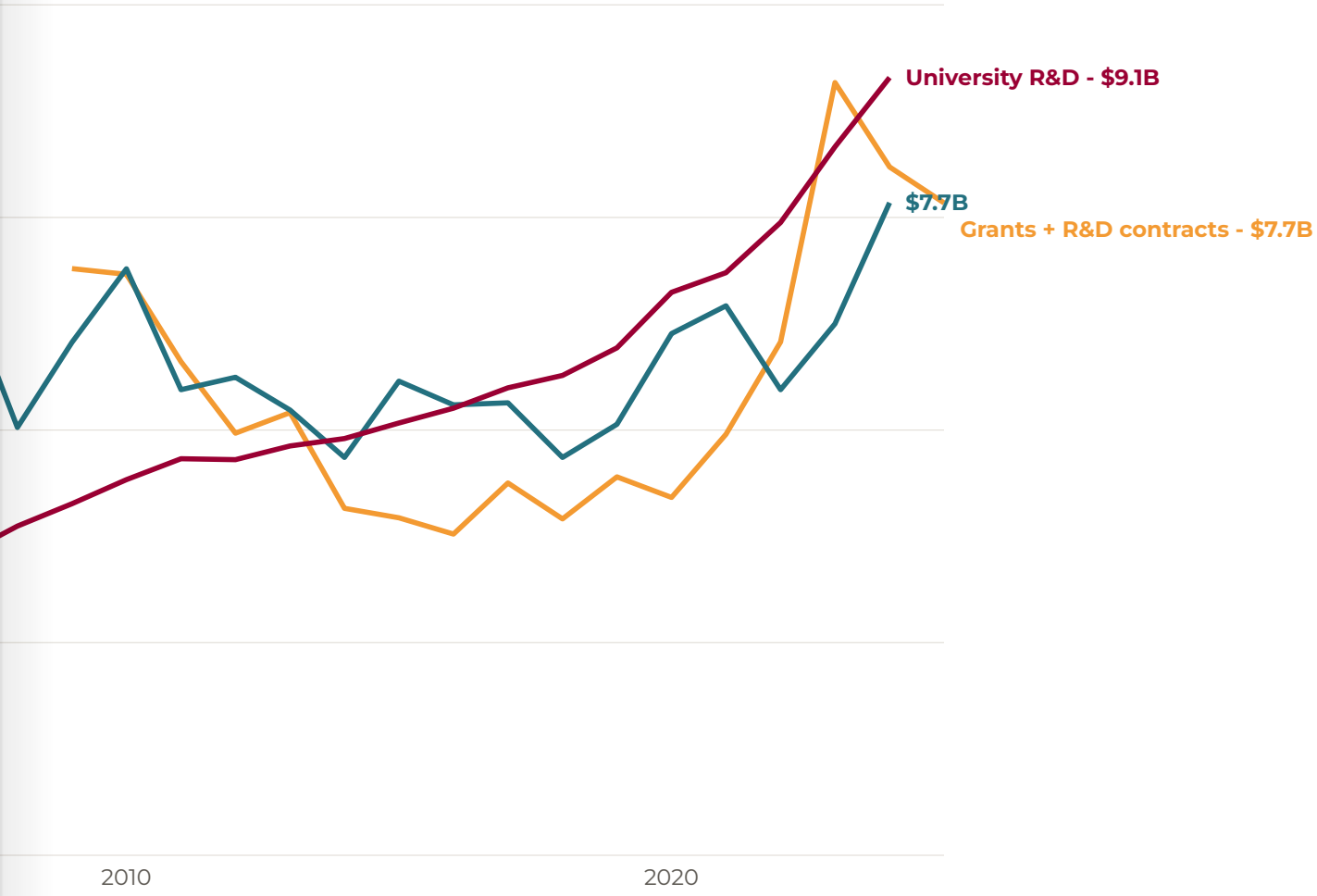


Millions of nominal dollars, fiscal years. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Developm
Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D co

Texas's universities spent $9.15B on research and development in FY2024, 3rd of 51 among the states; 43% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $7.67B for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

ts (USAspending)



ent Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, ntracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

$9.15B

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **3rd** of 51 · +80% since 2015

43%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **47th** of 51 · +3.1 pp since 2015

$7.67B

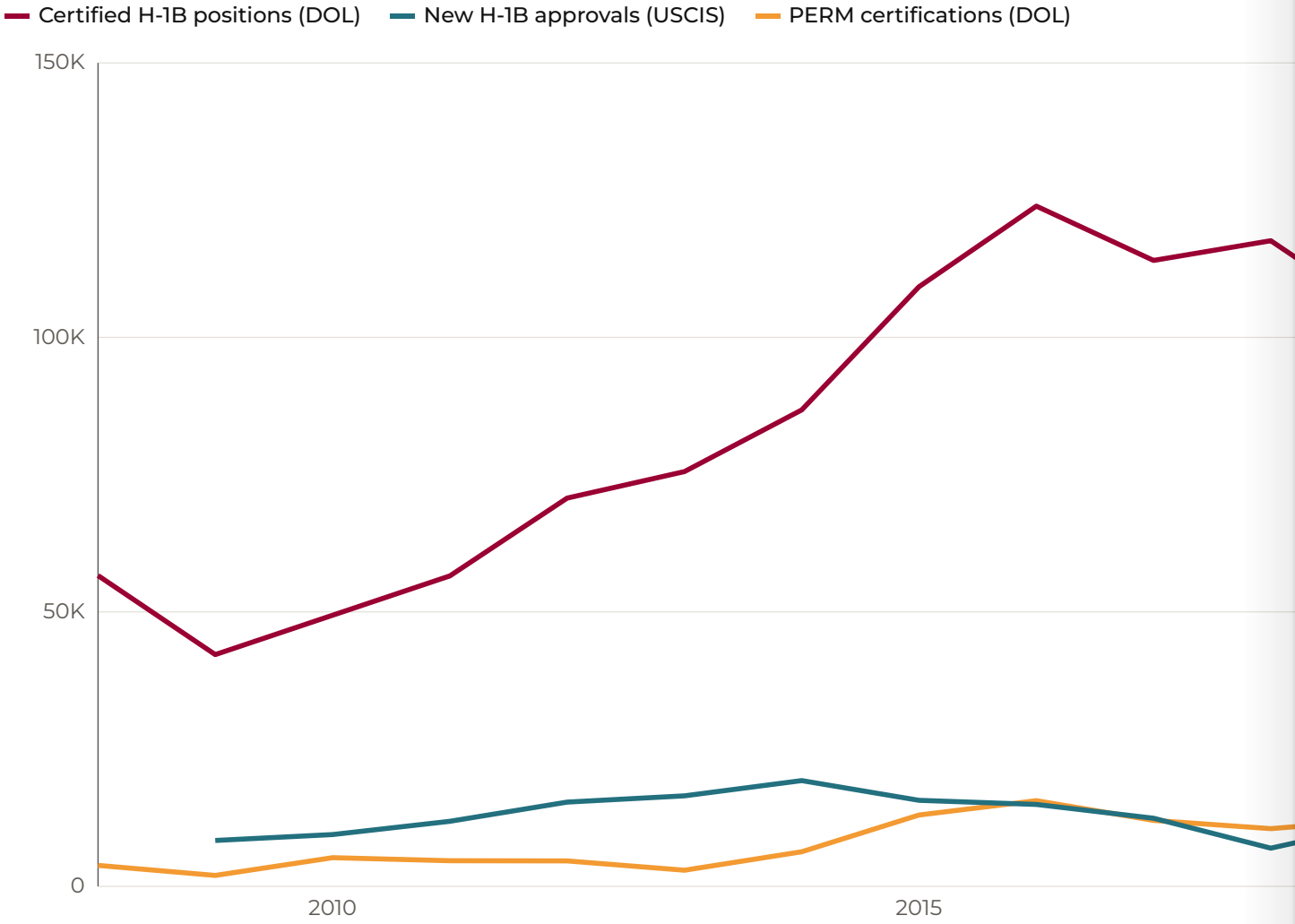
Federal R&D obligations, 2024

U.S. **$193B** · **9th** of 51 · +38% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Texas Gener

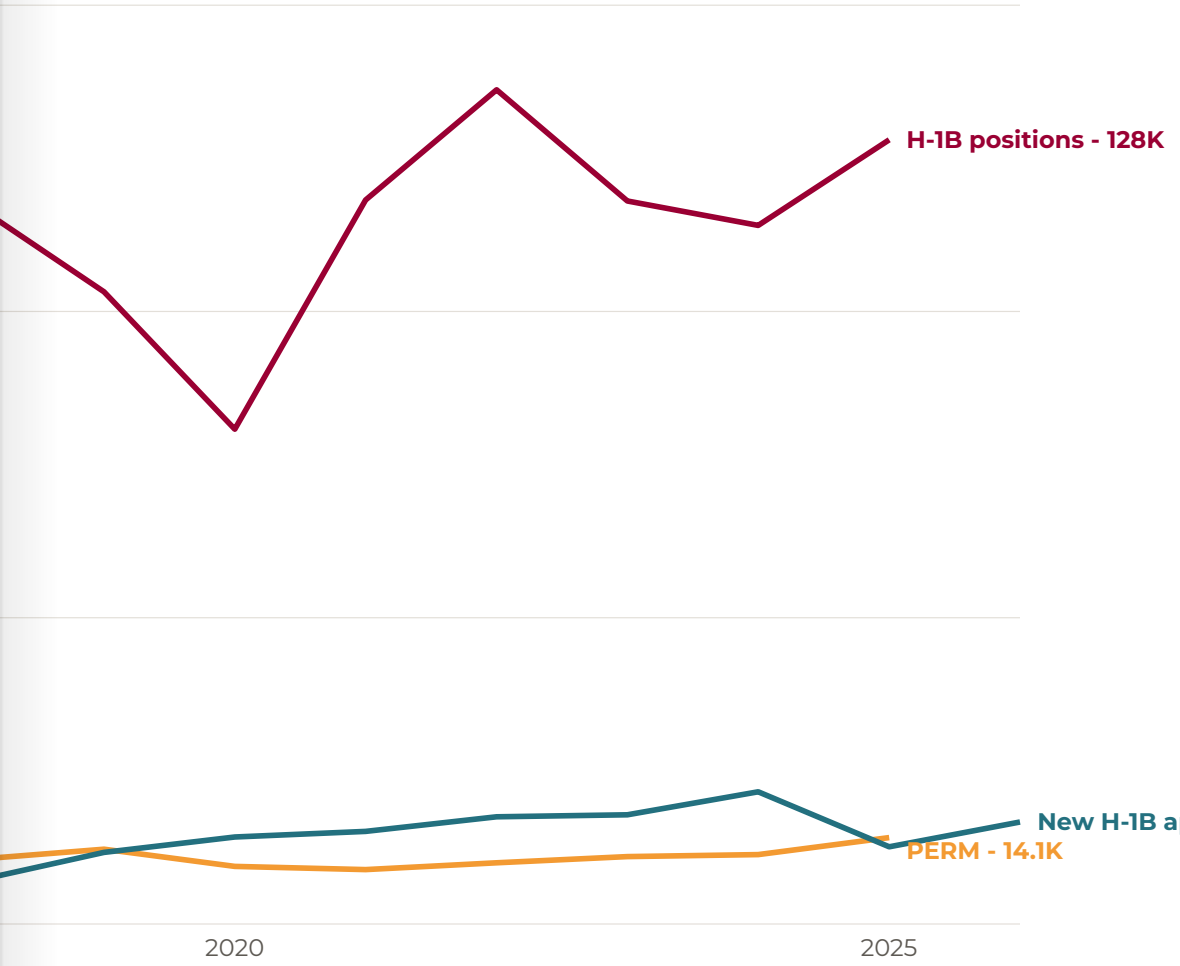


Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal
from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 128K H-1B positions at Texas worksites in FY2025, 2nd of 51 among the states. A labor certification comes before the petition, so this overstates hires; USCIS approved 16.7K new H-1B petitions from employers in the state in FY2026.

DOL certified 14.1K PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 5.6% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

ate?



year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data

128K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **2nd** of 51 · +17% since 2015

14.1K

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

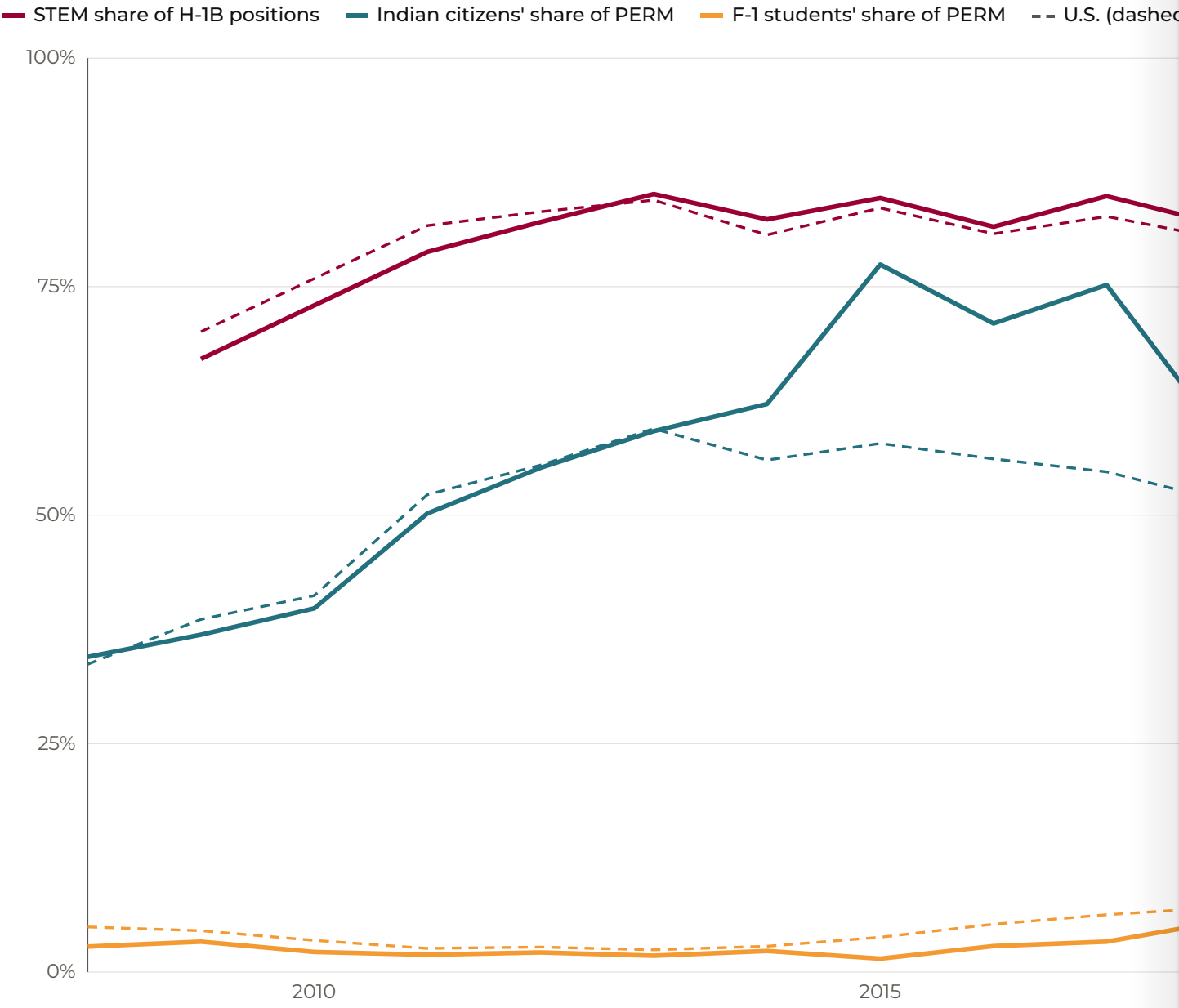
U.S. **138K** · **2nd** of 51 · +8.4% since 2015

5.6%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **42nd** of 51 · +4.2 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds Texas's Skilled-Visa Jobs?

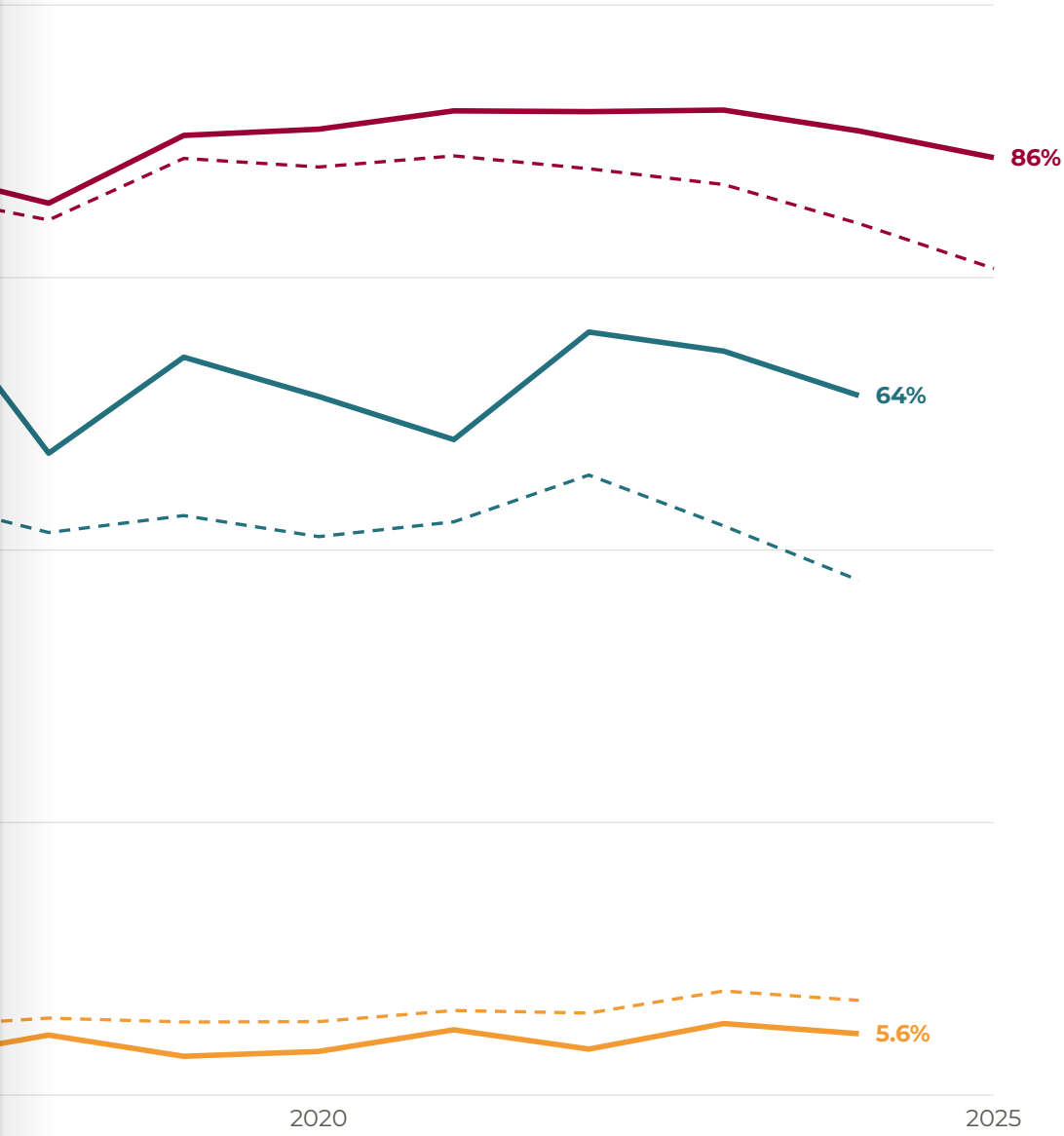


State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from D

86% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 64% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

d)



OL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

86%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **6th** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2015

64%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **4th** of 51 · −13.3 pp since 2015

$109K

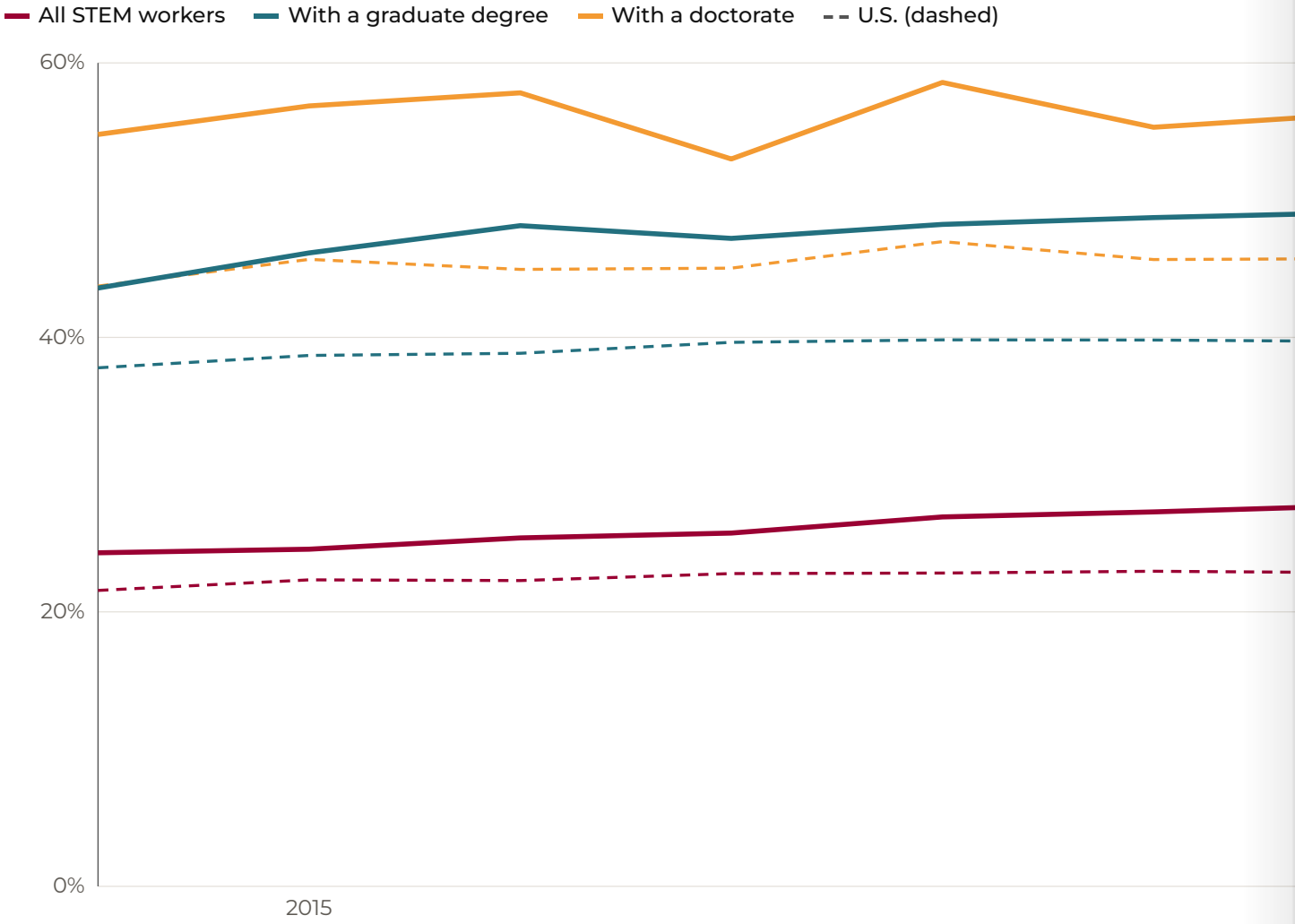
Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

U.S. **$119K** · **15th** of 51 · +58% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

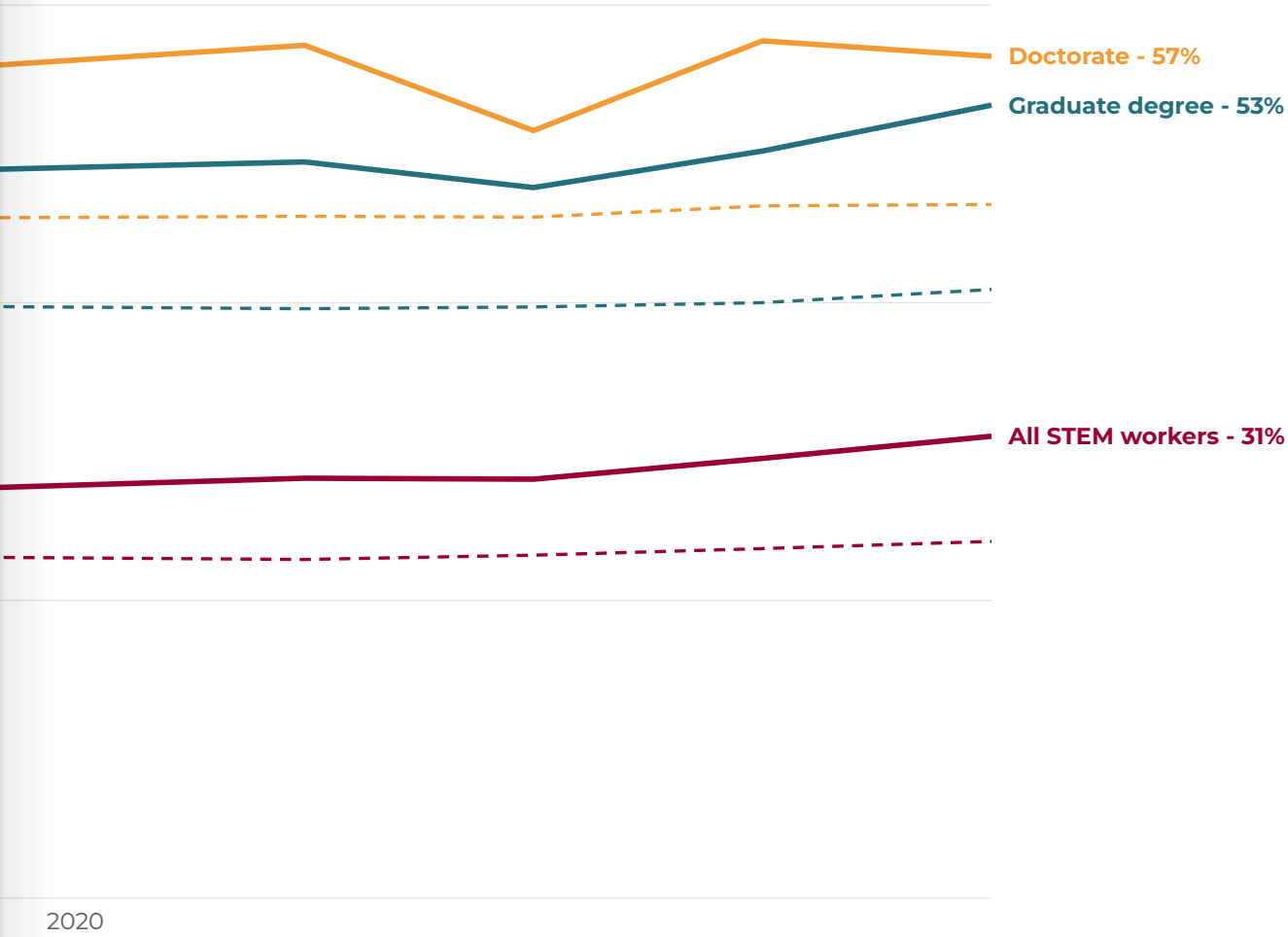
Figure 20 How Much of Texas's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resti
Community Survey.

In 2024, 31% of the people working in STEM occupations in Texas were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 4th of 51).

The share rises with education: 53% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 16% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.



ng on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American

31%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **4th** of 51 · +6.5 pp since 2015

53%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **4th** of 44 · +7.1 pp since 2015

16%

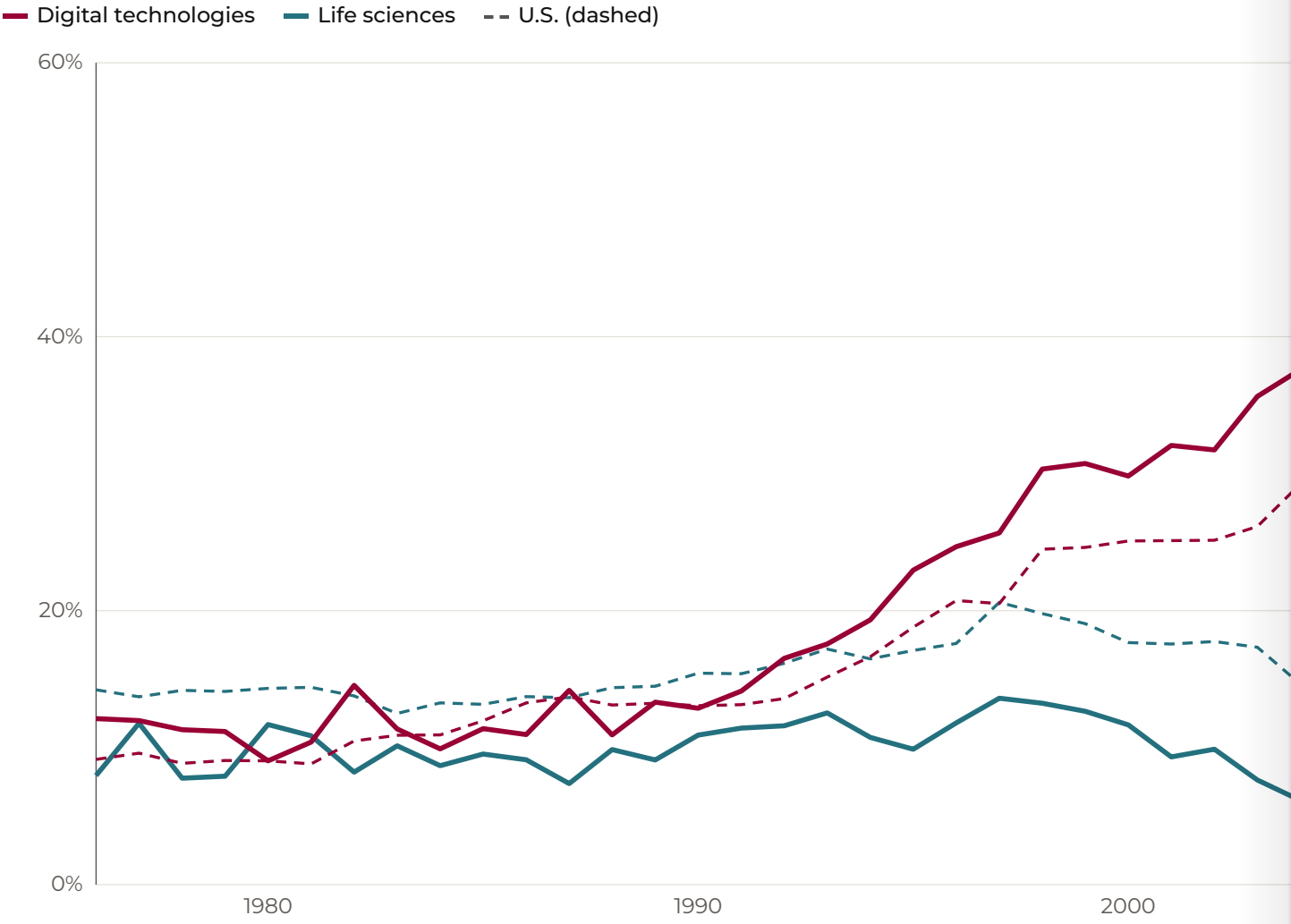
Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **11%** · **4th** of 51 · +3.8 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

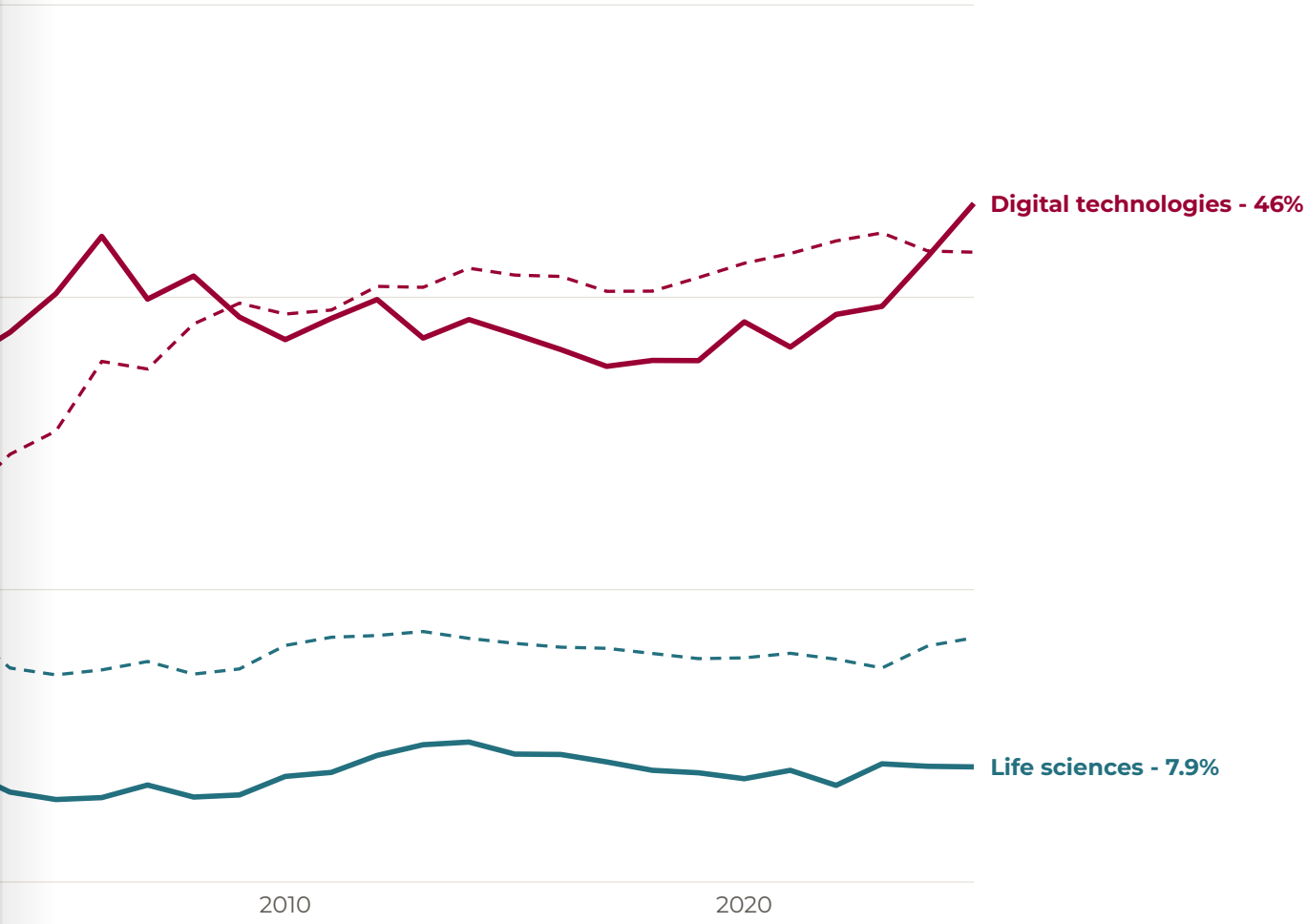
Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Texas Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed

Organizations and people in Texas were granted 11K U.S. patents in 2025, 8.2% of all patents with a U.S. owner (2nd of 51).

46% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 7.9% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).



d. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

11K

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **2nd** of 51 · +5.2% since 2015

46%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **9th** of 51 · +8.9 pp since 2015

7.9%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

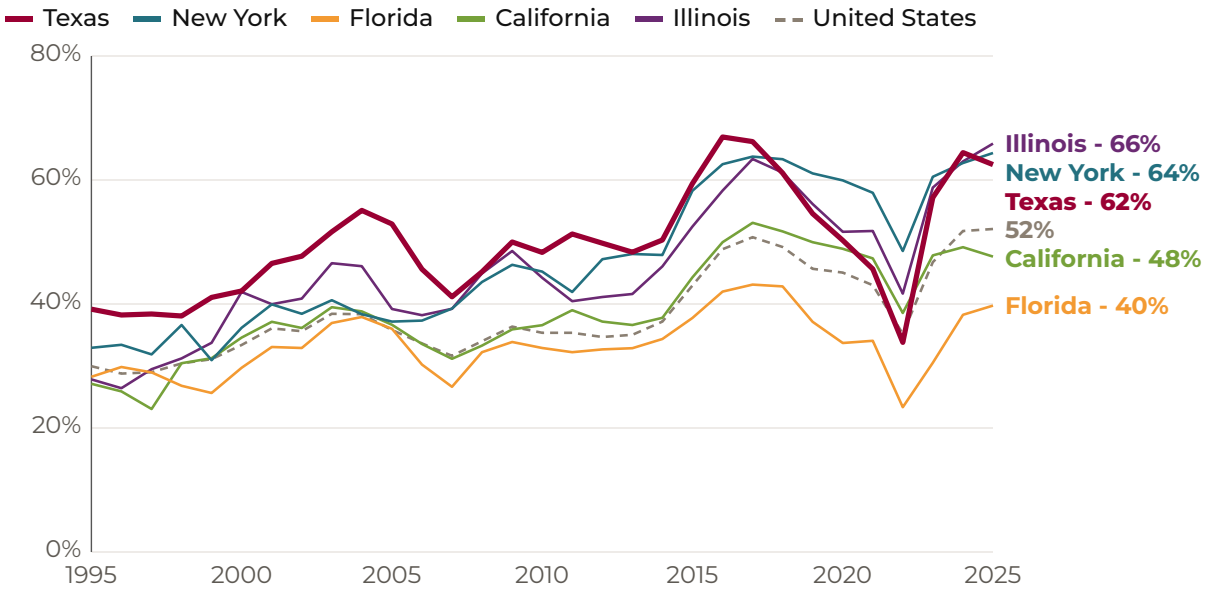
U.S. **17%** · **49th** of 51 · −0.9 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

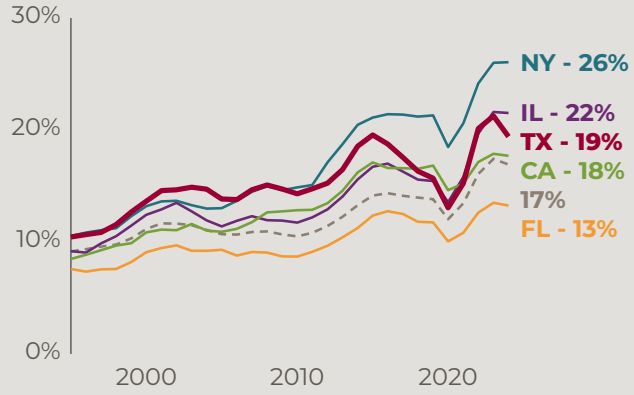
The four states closest in size are New York, Florida, California, Illinois. Texas ranks 3rd of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Illinois is the most dependent at 66%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Texas and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



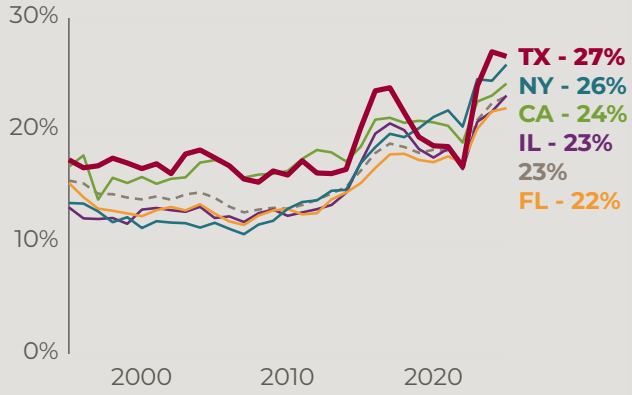
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



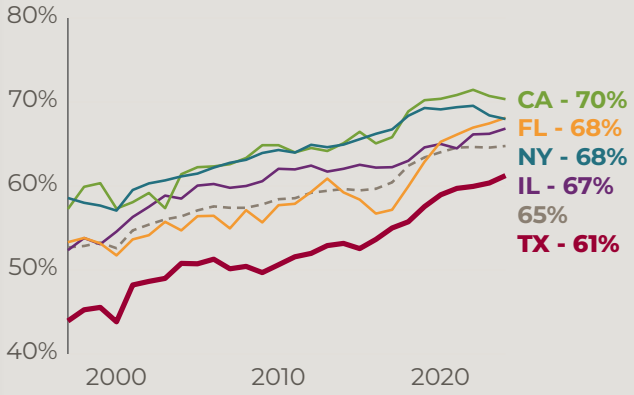
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Table 3 How Does Texas Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	TX	NY	FL	CA	IL	U.S.
Students enrolled	**1.67M**	1.15M	1.05M	2.68M	723K	19.7M
Graduate share of students	**13%**	22%	13%	12%	22%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's	**24%**	24%	22%	27%	23%	24%
STEM share of master's	**27%**	26%	22%	24%	23%	23%
International STEM master's	**10.5K**	13.7K	3.53K	10.1K	7.39K	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's	**9.0%**	12%	3.0%	8.7%	6.3%	100%
Int. share of STEM master's	**62%**	64%	40%	48%	66%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates	**50%**	46%	47%	38%	54%	43%
Int. share of grad students	**19%**	26%	13%	18%	22%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment	**2.5%**	5.6%	4.4%	2.4%	3.8%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate	**61%**	68%	68%	70%	67%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year	**$8.52K**	$8.67K	$4.39K	$8.14K	$15K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student	**$11.8K**	$15.9K	$12K	$12.7K	$10.3K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary	**$96.8K**	$117K	$97.4K	$137K	$112K	$106K
First-time students from in state	**92%**	73%	81%	90%	80%	–
Net migration per 100 residents	**−10**	−4	+1	−6	−19	–

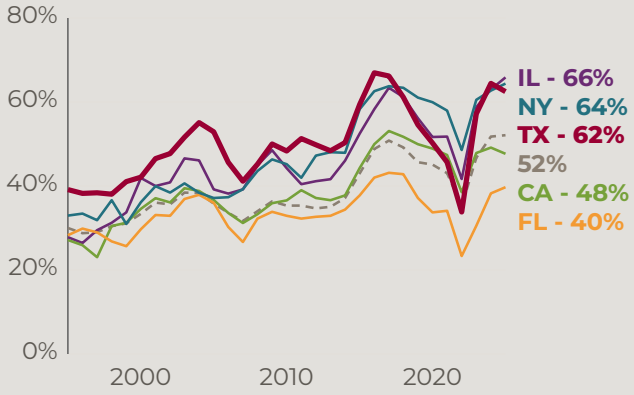
Latest year for each measure. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM master's

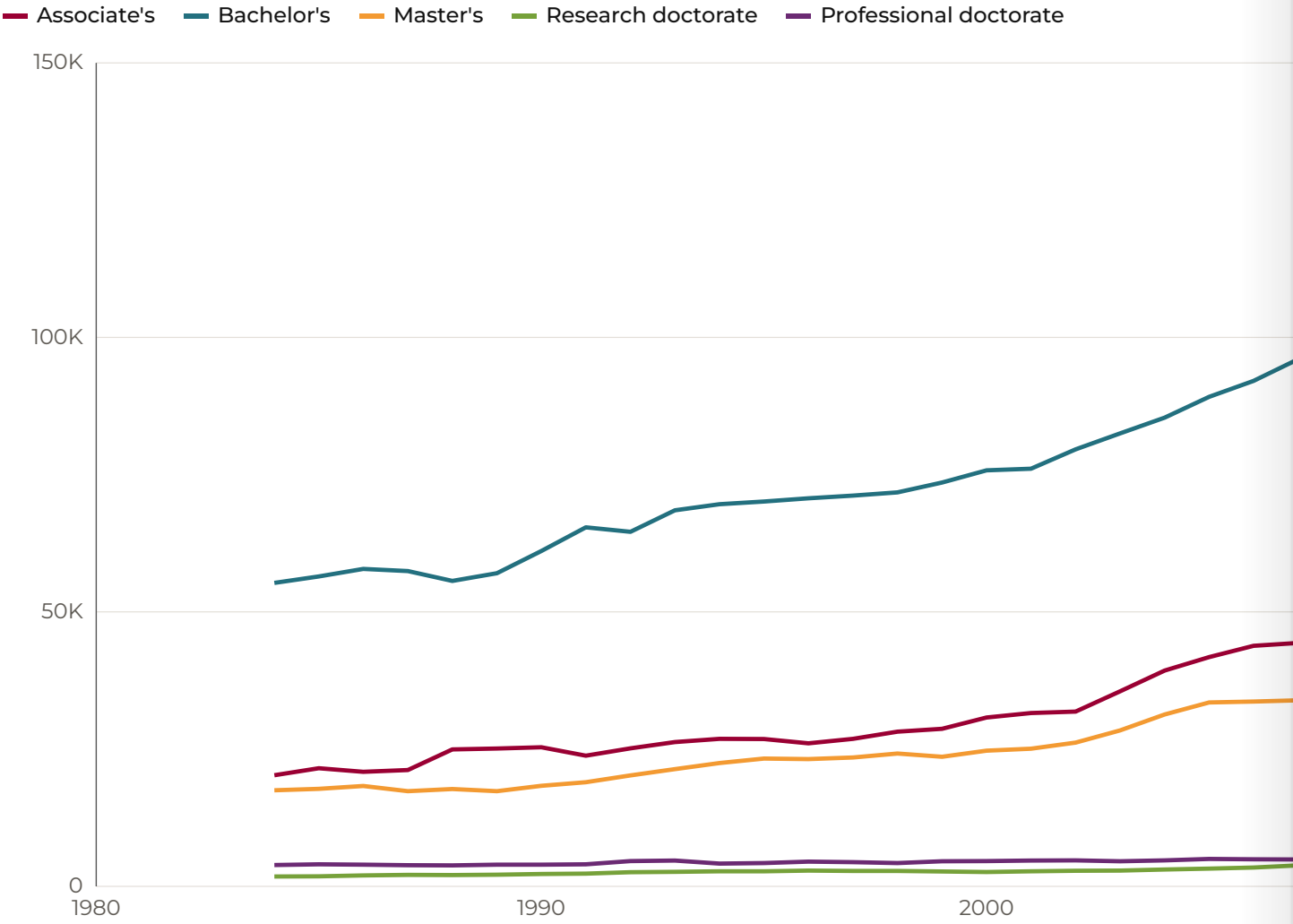


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

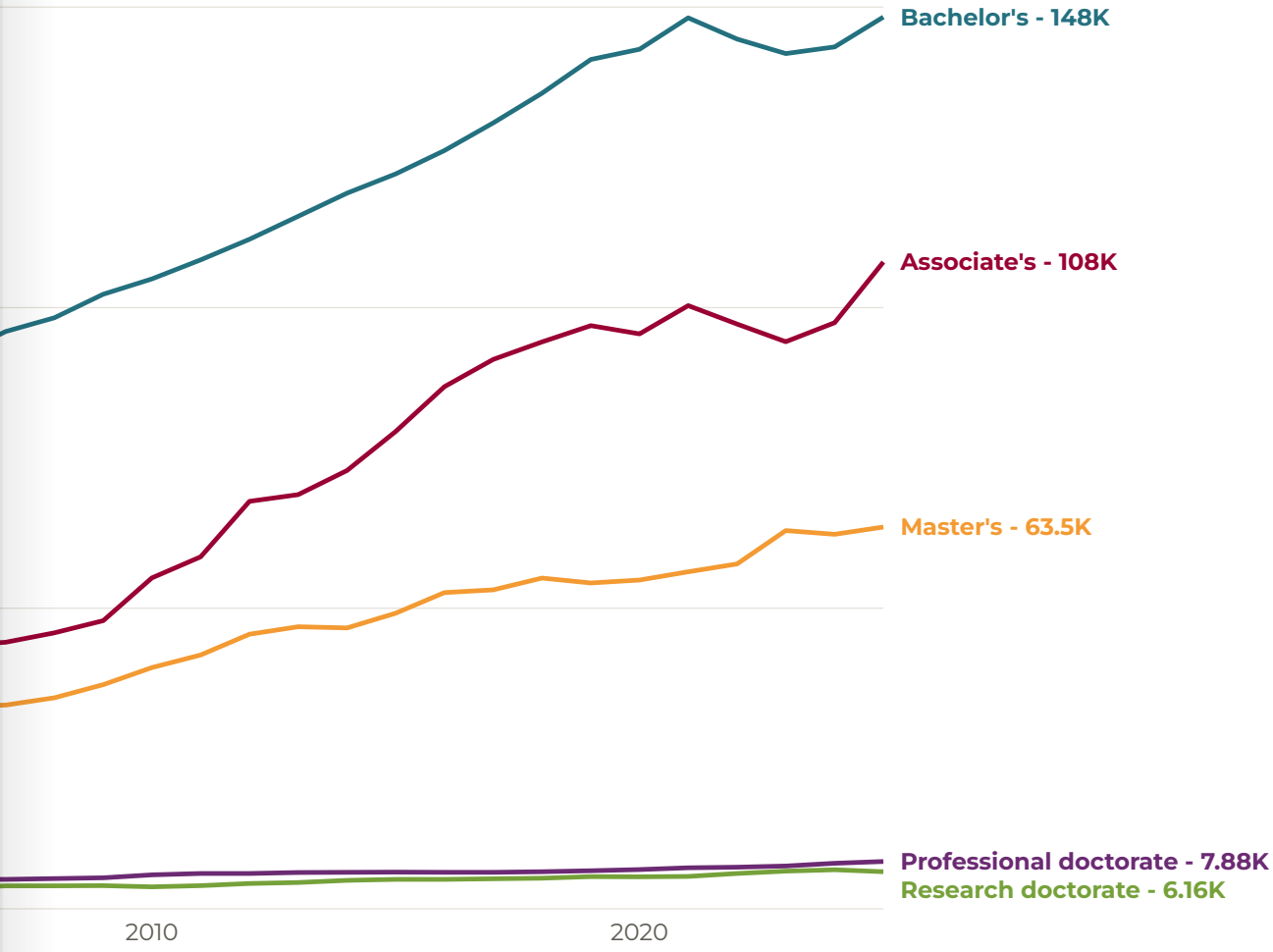
Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Texas Award?



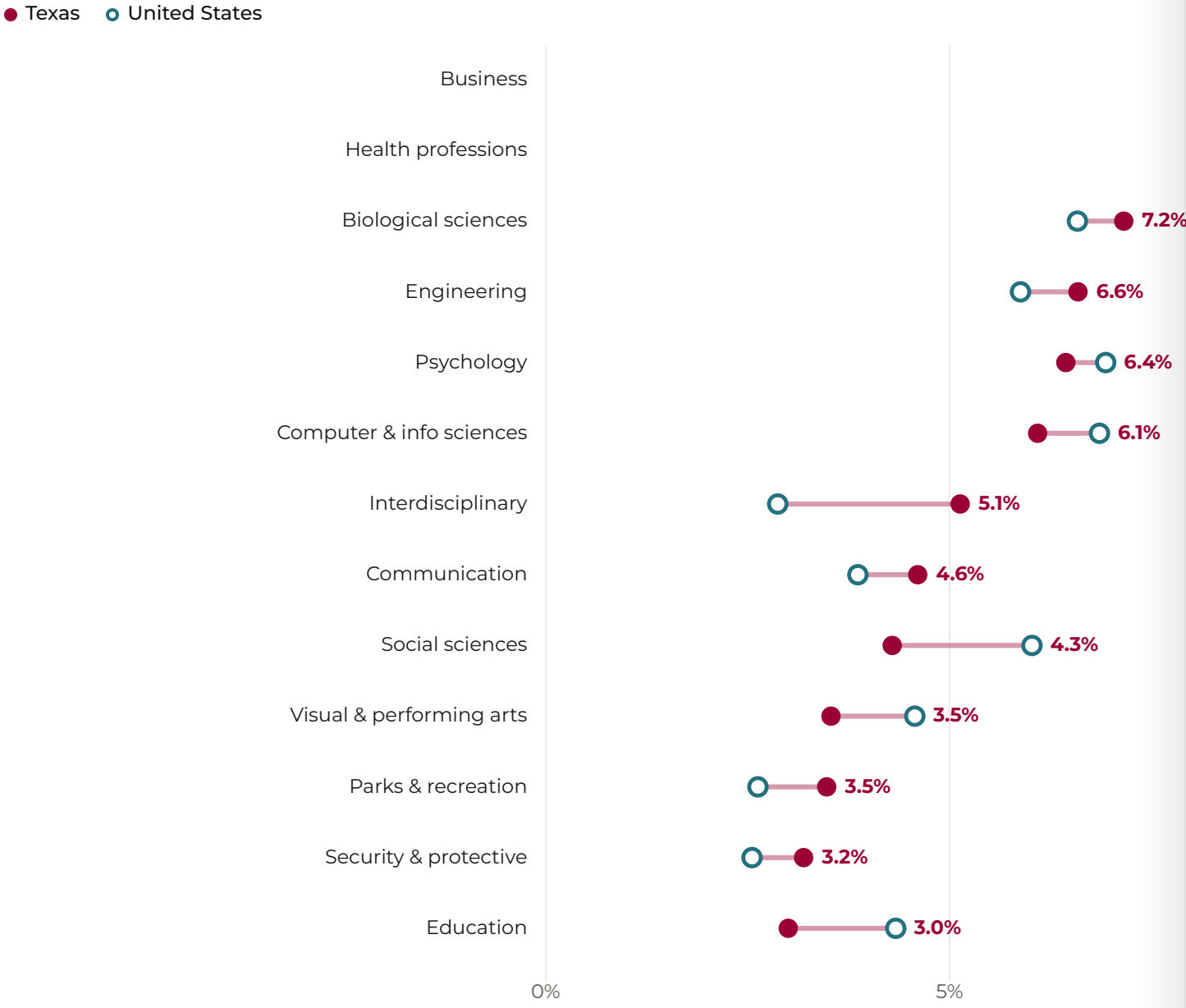
Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Texas's institutions awarded 108K associate's degrees, 148K bachelor's degrees, 63.5K master's degrees, 6.16K research doctorate degrees, 7.88K professional doctorate degrees.



Since 2015: associate's up 35%; bachelor's up 21%; master's up 29%; research doctorate up 26%; professional doctorate up 29%. The state awards 10.2 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

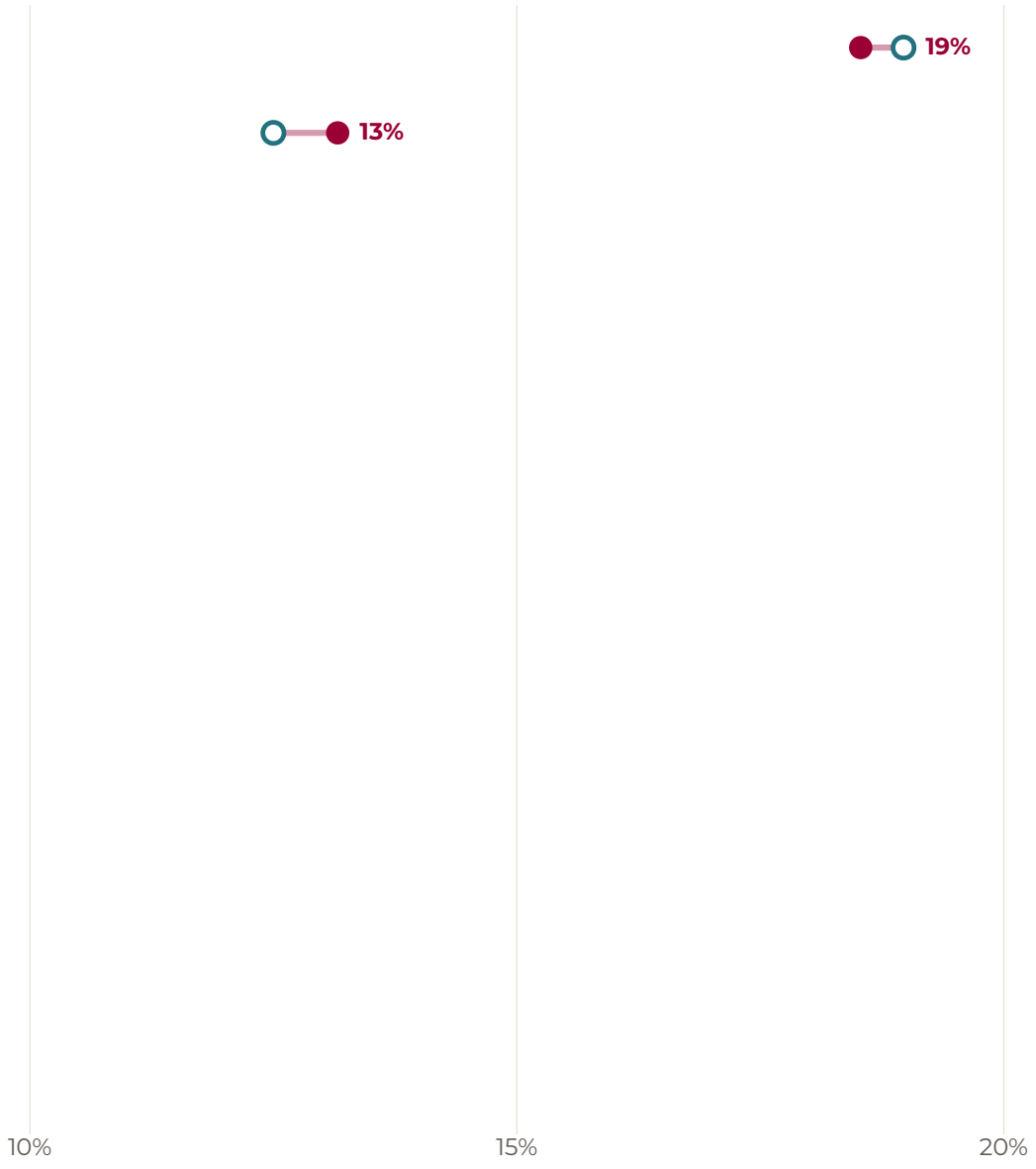
Figure 28 What Do Texas's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Texas's largest bachelor's fields are business (19%; U.S. 19%), health professions (13%; U.S. 13%), biological sciences (7.2%; U.S. 6.6%).

Relative to the nation, Texas's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in agriculture (2.11× the U.S. share), interdisciplinary (1.79× the U.S. share), engineering technology (1.43× the U.S. share).



6.1%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **23rd** of 51 · +3.6 pp since 2015

7.9%

Bachelor's in engineering, 2025

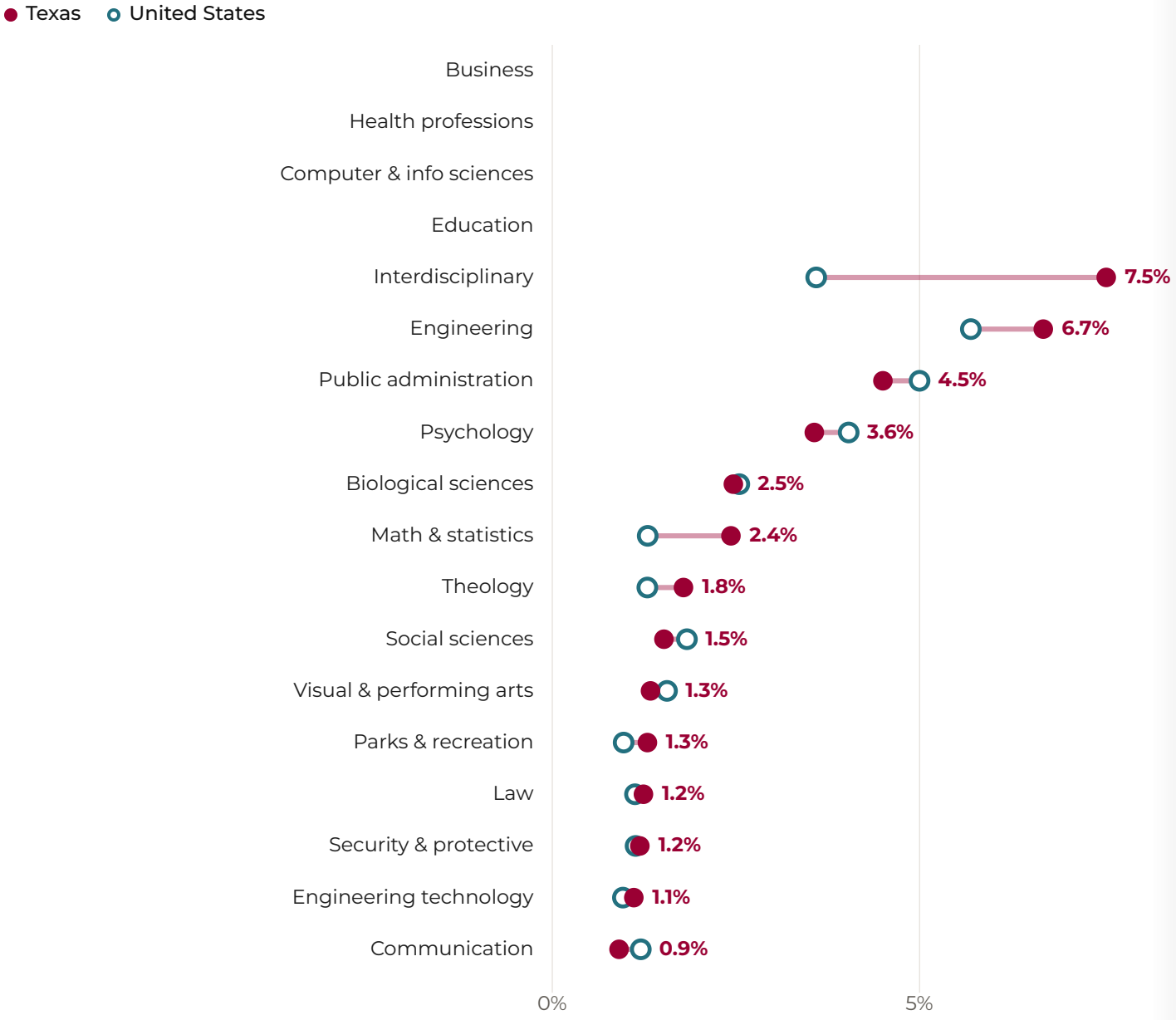
U.S. **6.8%** · **15th** of 51 · +1.4 pp since 2015

19%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **31st** of 51 · −1.2 pp since 2015

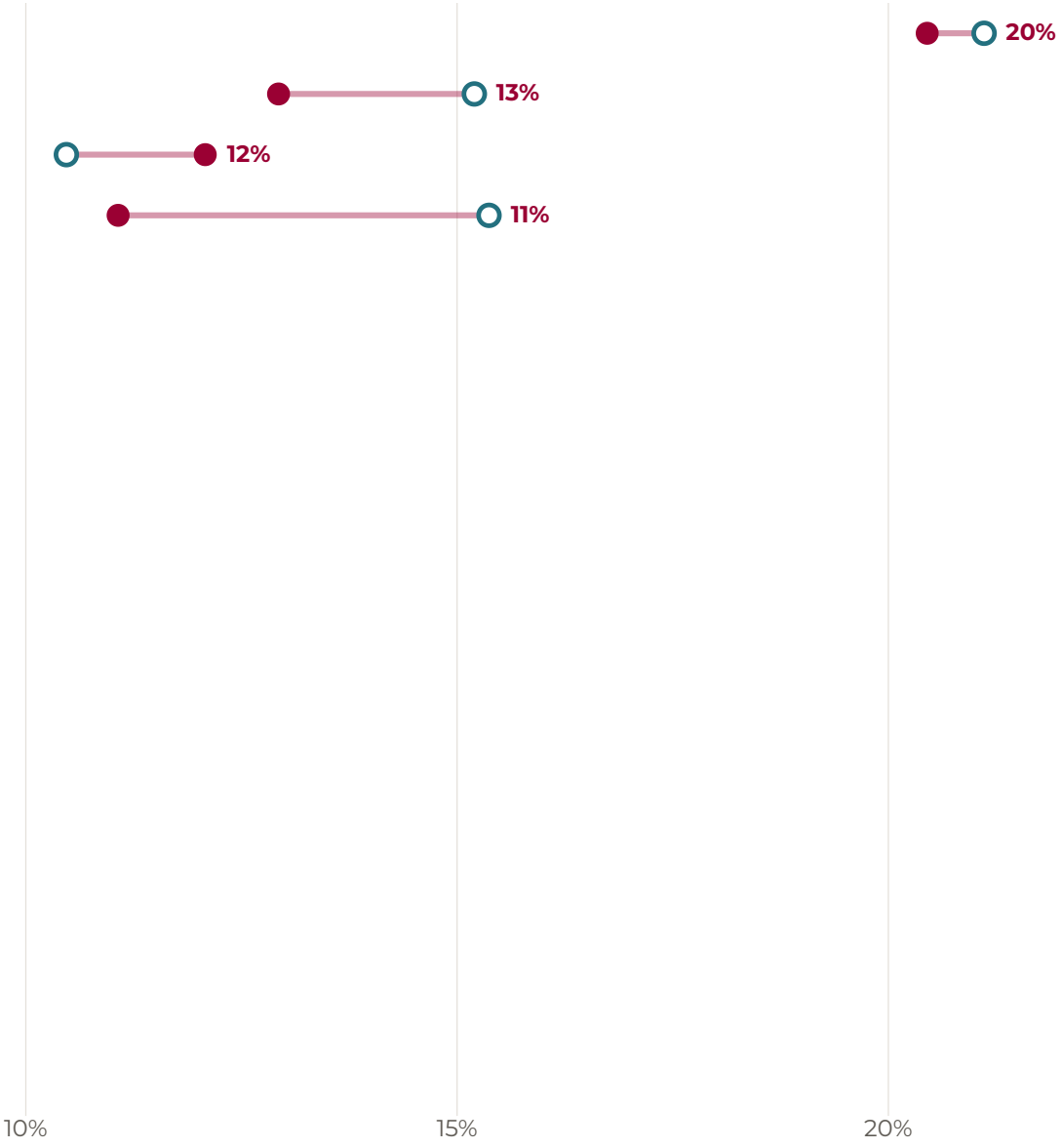
Figure 29 What Do Texas's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Texas's largest master's fields are business (20%; U.S. 21%), health professions (13%; U.S. 15%), computer & info sciences (12%; U.S. 10%).

International students earn 25% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 27% of them.



27%

STEM share of master's, 2025

U.S. **23%** · **12th** of 51 · +6.4 pp since 2015

25%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

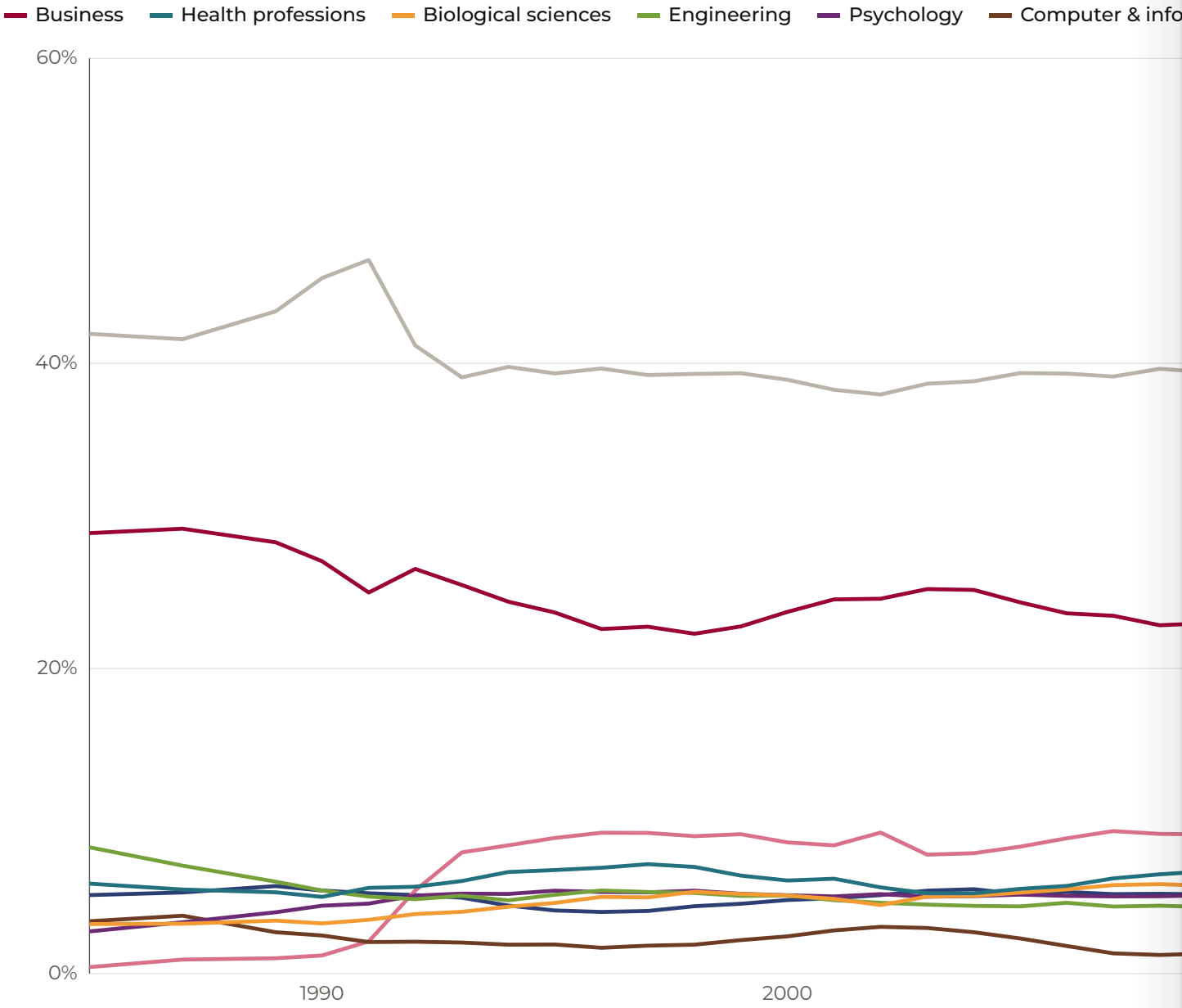
U.S. **22%** · **11th** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

79%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

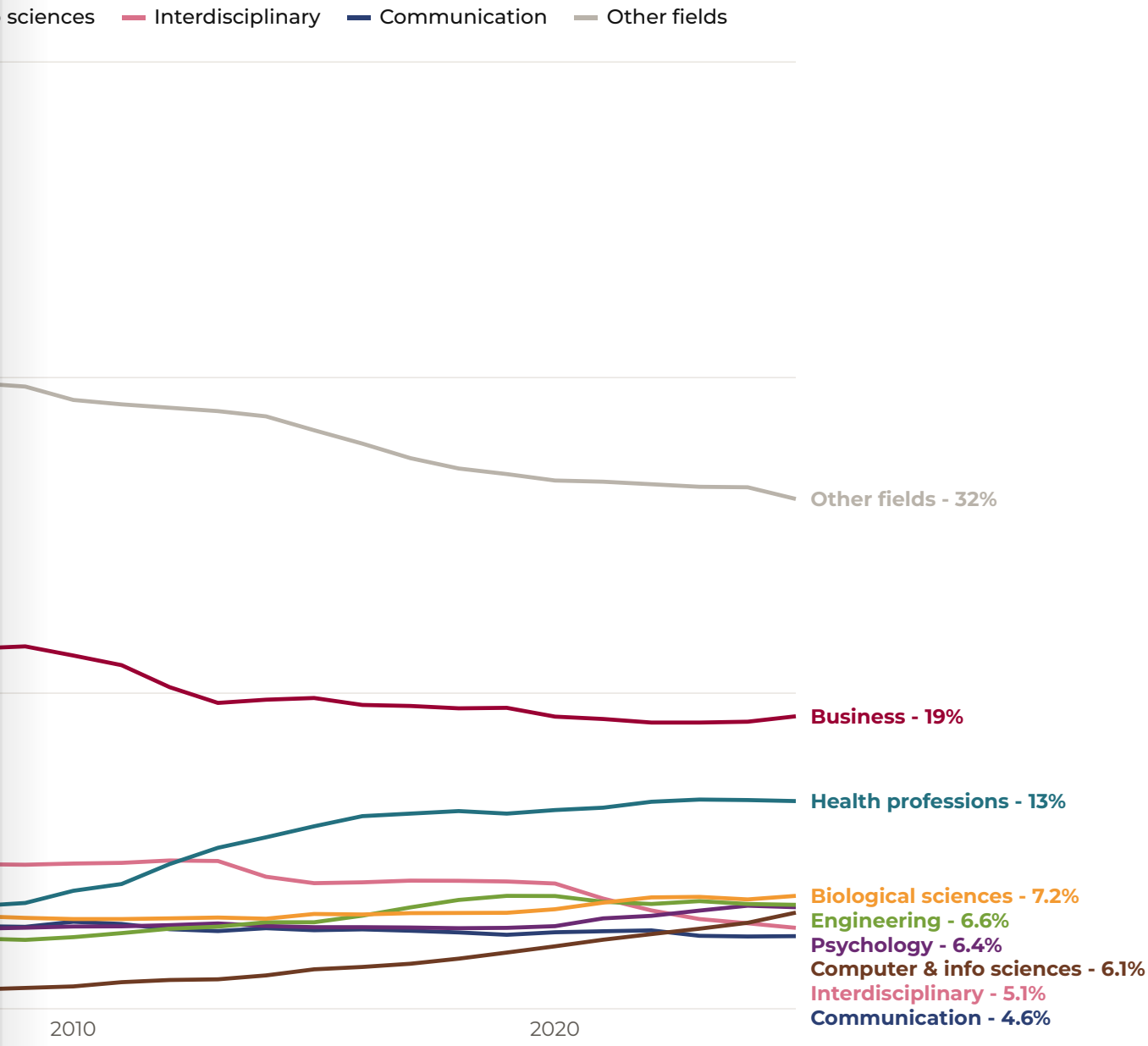
U.S. **65%** · **13th** of 47 · +2.6 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has Texas's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, computer & info sciences has gained the most ground, 3.6 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while interdisciplinary lost the most (2.8 points).



The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

Table 4 Where Is Texas Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Agriculture	**2.11**	2.2%	1.0%	3.21K
Interdisciplinary	**1.79**	5.1%	2.9%	7.61K
Engineering technology	**1.43**	1.3%	0.9%	1.9K
Family & consumer sci.	**1.39**	1.1%	0.8%	1.69K
Parks & recreation	**1.32**	3.5%	2.6%	5.16K
Security & protective	**1.25**	3.2%	2.6%	4.73K
Liberal arts	**1.19**	2.2%	1.8%	3.21K
Communication	**1.19**	4.6%	3.9%	6.83K
Architecture	**1.14**	0.6%	0.6%	961
Engineering	**1.12**	6.6%	5.9%	9.77K

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

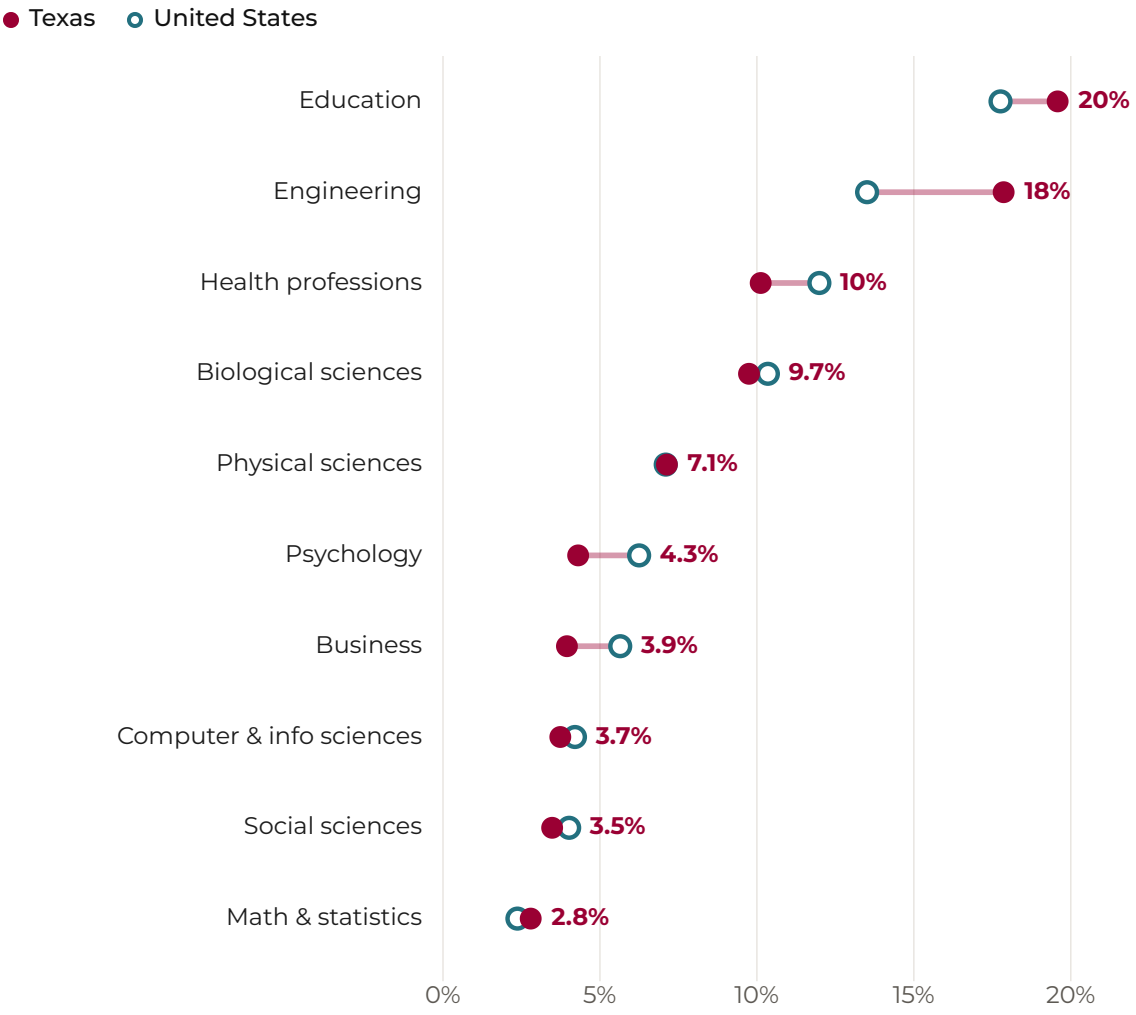
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The location quotient divides a field's share of Texas's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the ten fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest location quotients**: agriculture 2.11 (2.2% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 1.0%); interdisciplinary 1.79 (5.1% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 2.9%); engineering technology 1.43 (1.3% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 0.9%).
- **STEM share of bachelor's degrees**: 24% in 2025 (U.S. 24%; 18th of 51 states), up 0.9 points from 24% in 2024, and up 5.4 points since 2015 (19%).
- **Computer and information sciences**: 6.1% in 2025 (U.S. 6.9%; 23rd of 51 states), up 0.6 points from 5.4% in 2024, and up 3.6 points since 2015 (2.5%).
- **Engineering**: 7.9% in 2025 (U.S. 6.8%; 15th of 51 states), unchanged from 7.9% in 2024, and up 1.4 points since 2015 (6.5%).

Figure 31 What Do Texas's Doctoral Graduates Study?



Share of research doctorates by field, 2025; fields with 20+ doctorates. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is a field's share of the research doctorates awarded in Texas in 2025 (filled dot), against its share nationally (open dot), for the ten largest fields with at least 20 doctorates. Research doctorates exclude professional doctorates such as the M.D. and J.D.

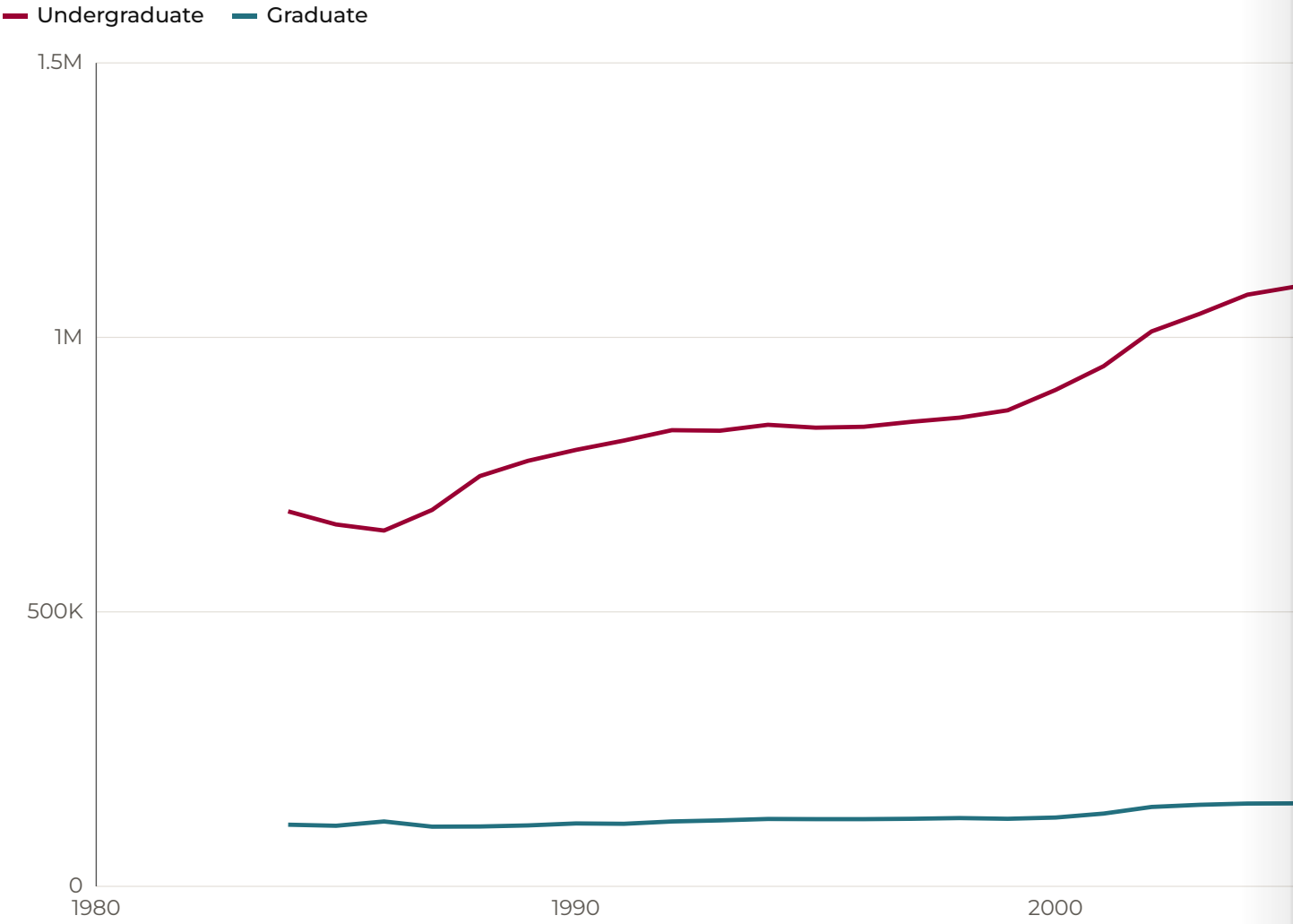
THE NUMBERS

- **Largest doctoral fields**: education 20% (U.S. 18%); engineering 18% (U.S. 14%); health professions 10% (U.S. 12%).
- **STEM share of research doctorates**: 43% in 2025 (U.S. 39%; 24th of 51 states), up 3.3 points from 40% in 2024, and down 3.4 points since 2015 (46%).
- **International share of research doctorates**: 30% in 2025 (U.S. 25%; 15th of 51 states), up 0.6 points from 30% in 2024, and down 3.4 points since 2015 (34%).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 50% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 9th of 51 states), down 4.3 points from 54% in 2024, and down 3.3 points since 2015 (53%).

SECTION 13

Students and Money

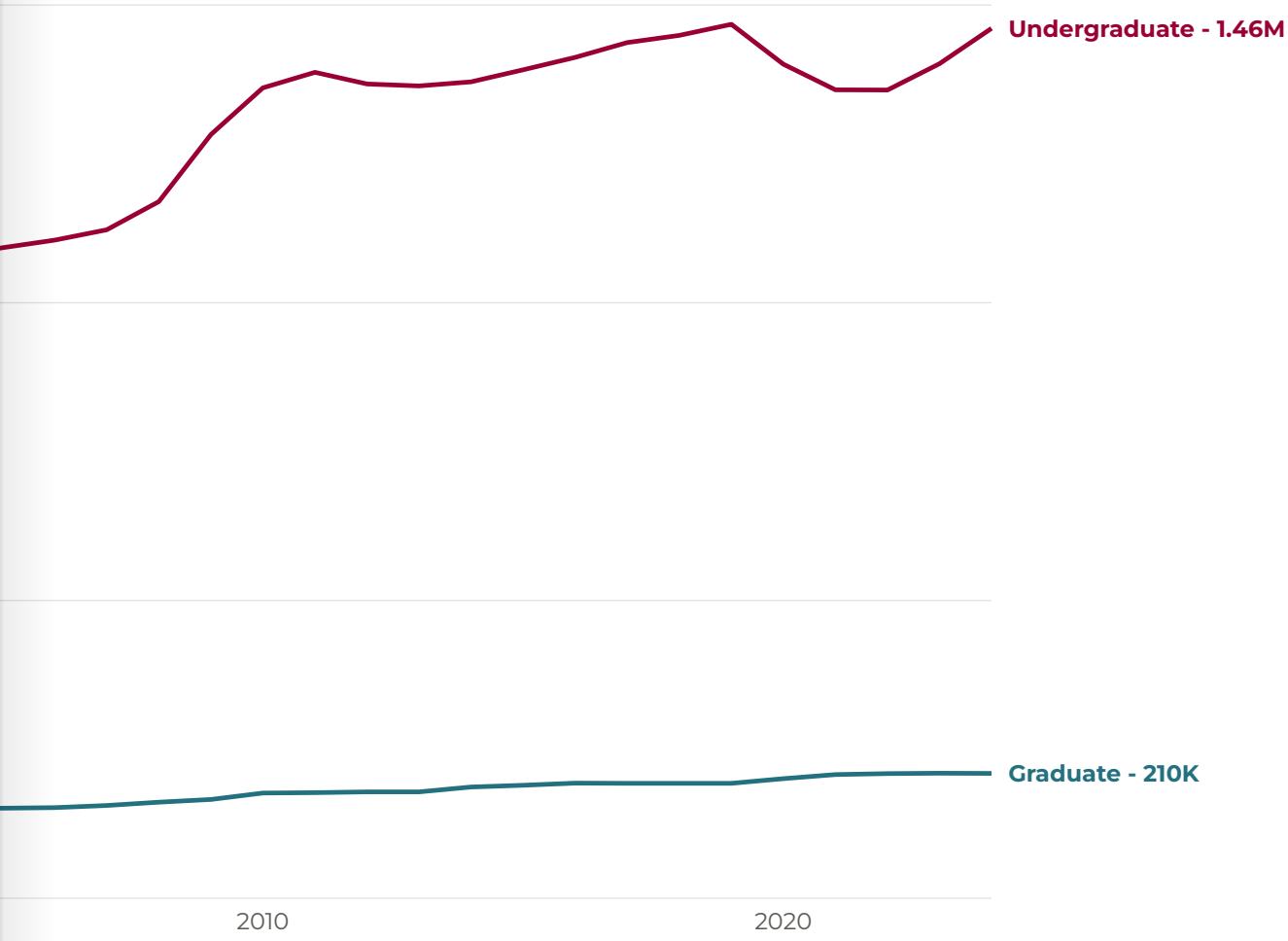
Figure 32 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Texas enrolled 1.46M undergraduates and 210K graduate students, 1.67M in all (2nd of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is up 5% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 10% since 2015. Graduate students are 13% of all students (U.S. 17%).



1.67M

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **2nd** of 51 · +5.7% since 2015

13%

Graduate share of students, 2024

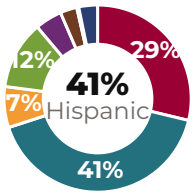
U.S. **17%** · **41st** of 51 · +0.5 pp since 2015

45%

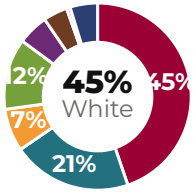
Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **12th** of 51 · −2.2 pp since 2015

Figure 33 Who Enrolls in Texas?



Texas



United States

	Texas	United States
White	**29%**	45%
Hispanic	**41%**	21%
Asian / Pacific Islander	**7.1%**	7.4%
Black	**12%**	12%
International	**4.7%**	5.3%
Two or more	**2.9%**	4.2%
American Indian	**0.3%**	0.6%
Unknown	**3.2%**	4.8%

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by race and ethnicity. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

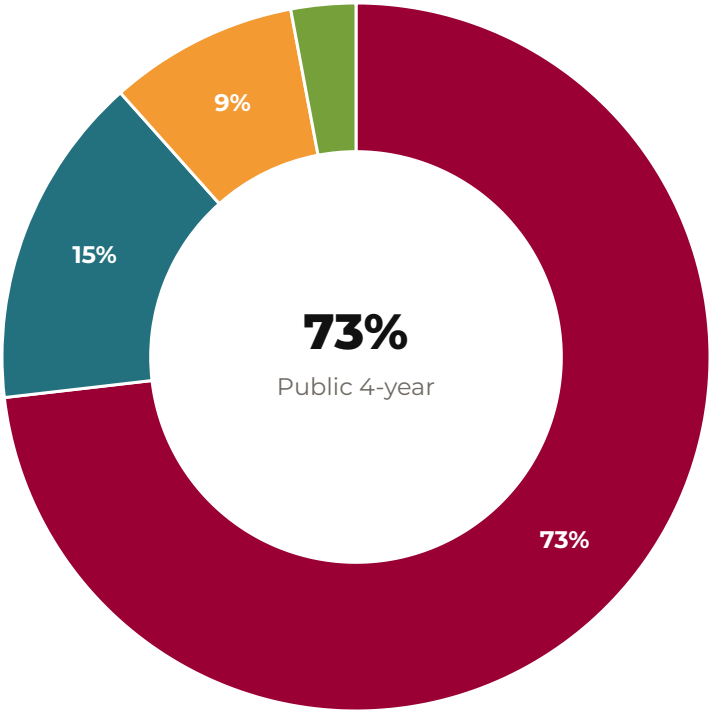
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide fall 2024 headcount enrollment at Texas's degree-granting institutions by race and ethnicity, with the nation for comparison. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race; "Unknown" is students whose race was not reported.

THE NUMBERS

- **Hispanic**: 41% in fall 2024 (U.S. 21%), up 0.4 points from 41% in fall 2023, and up 6.4 points since fall 2015 (35%).
- **White**: 29% in fall 2024 (U.S. 45%), down 1.2 points from 30% in fall 2023, and down 8.7 points since fall 2015 (37%).
- **Black**: 12% in fall 2024 (U.S. 12%), up 0.4 points from 11% in fall 2023, and down 0.7 points since fall 2015 (13%).
- **Asian / Pacific Islander**: 7.1% in fall 2024 (U.S. 7.4%), unchanged from 7.1% in fall 2023, and up 1.4 points since fall 2015 (5.7%).
- **International**: 4.7% in fall 2024 (U.S. 5.3%), unchanged from 4.7% in fall 2023, and unchanged since fall 2015 (4.6%).

Figure 34 Where Do Students Enroll?



	Share
Public 4-year	**73%**
Public 2-year	**15%**
Private nonprofit	**8.6%**
For-profit	**3.0%**

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

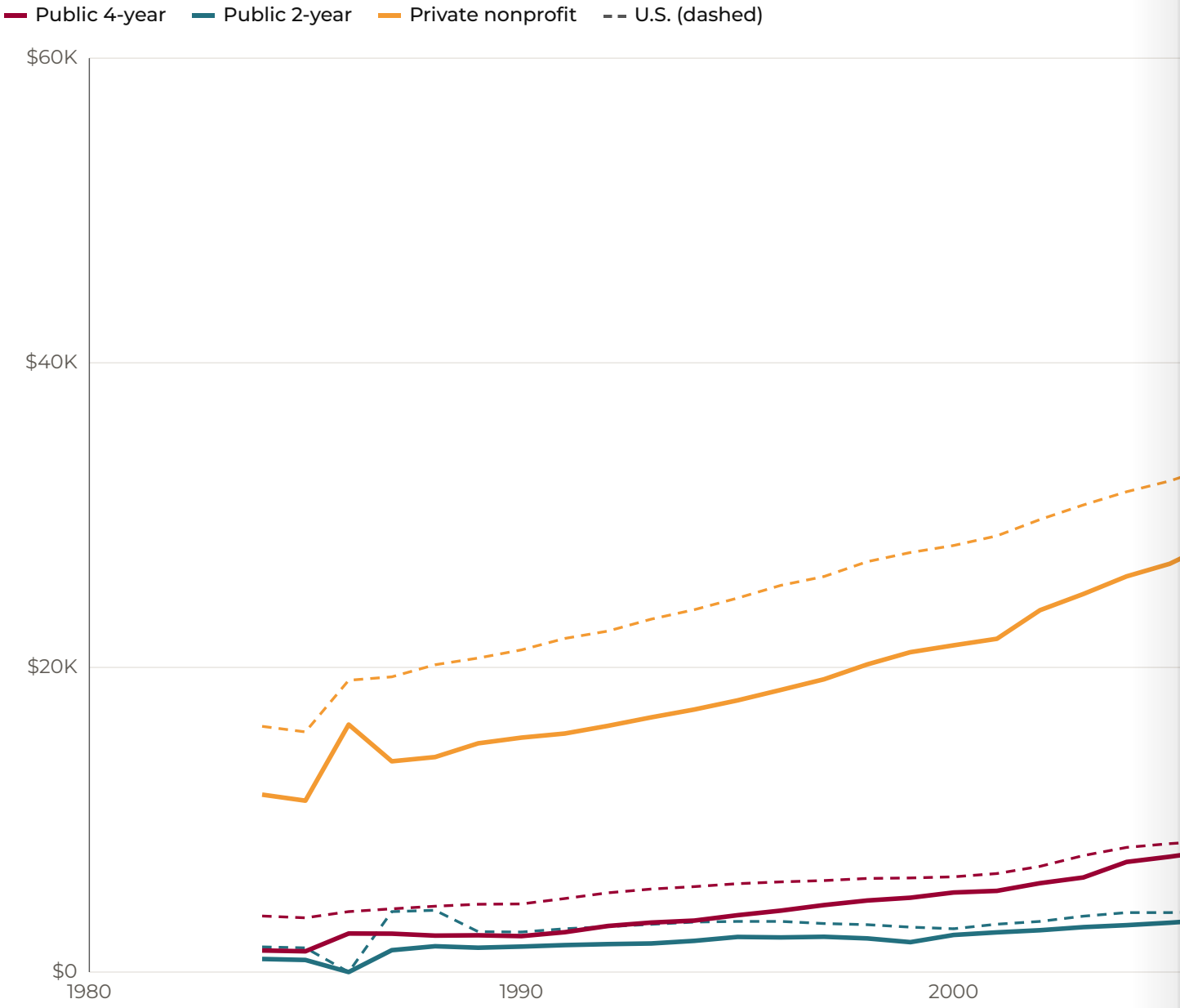
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The ring divides fall 2024 headcount enrollment in Texas among public four-year, public two-year, private nonprofit and for-profit institutions.

THE NUMBERS

- **Public 4-year share of enrollment**: 73% in fall 2024, up 3.0 points from 70% in fall 2023, and up 29.1 points since fall 2015 (44%).
- **Public 2-year share of enrollment**: 15% in fall 2024, down 2.9 points from 18% in fall 2023, and down 28.5 points since fall 2015 (44%).
- **Private nonprofit share of enrollment**: 8.6% in fall 2024, down 0.3 points from 8.9% in fall 2023, and down 0.3 points since fall 2015 (8.9%).
- **For-profit share of enrollment**: 3.0% in fall 2024, up 0.2 points from 2.7% in fall 2023, and down 0.3 points since fall 2015 (3.2%).

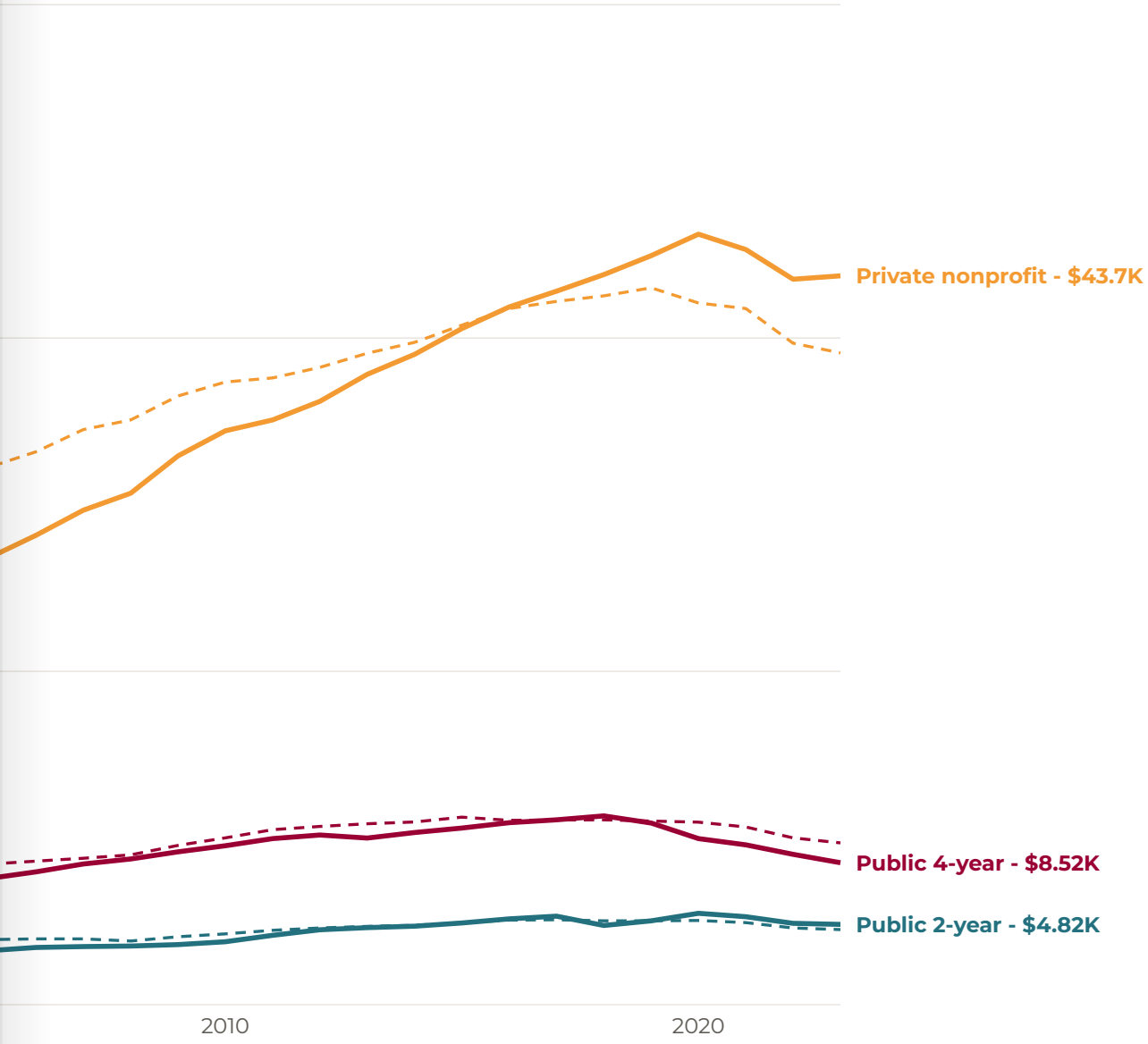
Figure 35 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Texas's public four-year institutions are $8.52K (2023, 2024 dollars), 12% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 38th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $11.8K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (18th of 51), and tuition makes up 37% of their core revenue (U.S. 43%).



$8.52K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **38th** of 51 · −20% since 2015

$11.8K

Appropriations per student, 2024

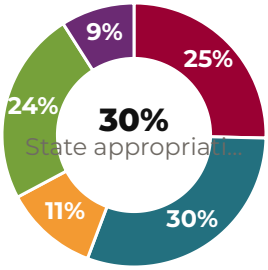
U.S. **$11.4K** · **18th** of 51 · +14% since 2015

37%

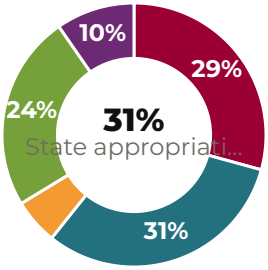
Tuition share of public revenue, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **38th** of 51 · −5.1 pp since 2015

Figure 36 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Texas



United States

	Texas	United States
Net tuition	**25%**	29%
State appropriations	**30%**	31%
Local appropriations	**11%**	5.6%
Federal grants & appropriations	**24%**	24%
Private gifts & grants	**9.0%**	9.6%

Core revenue per FTE student, public institutions. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide the core revenue of Texas's public institutions per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student by source, with the nation for comparison. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

THE NUMBERS

- **Net tuition per FTE student**: $7.13K in FY2024 (U.S. $8.96K), down 6.6% from $7.64K in FY2023, and down 8.2% since FY2015 ($7.77K).
- **State appropriations per FTE student**: $8.54K in FY2024 (U.S. $9.64K), up 4.0% from $8.21K in FY2023, and up 9.4% since FY2015 ($7.8K).
- **Local appropriations per FTE student**: $3.22K in FY2024 (U.S. $1.71K), down 1.2% from $3.26K in FY2023, and up 30% since FY2015 ($2.48K).
- **Federal grants & appropriations per FTE student**: $6.68K in FY2024 (U.S. $7.36K), down 6.7% from $7.17K in FY2023, and up 17% since FY2015 ($5.74K).

Table 5 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Texas	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$8.52K**	$9.71K	38th of 51	−20%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$11.8K**	$11.4K	18th of 51	+14%
Tuition share of public revenue	2024	**37%**	43%	38th of 51	−5.1 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**61%**	65%	26th of 51	+8.7 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$96.8K**	$106K	24th of 51	−6.8%

Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Texas: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

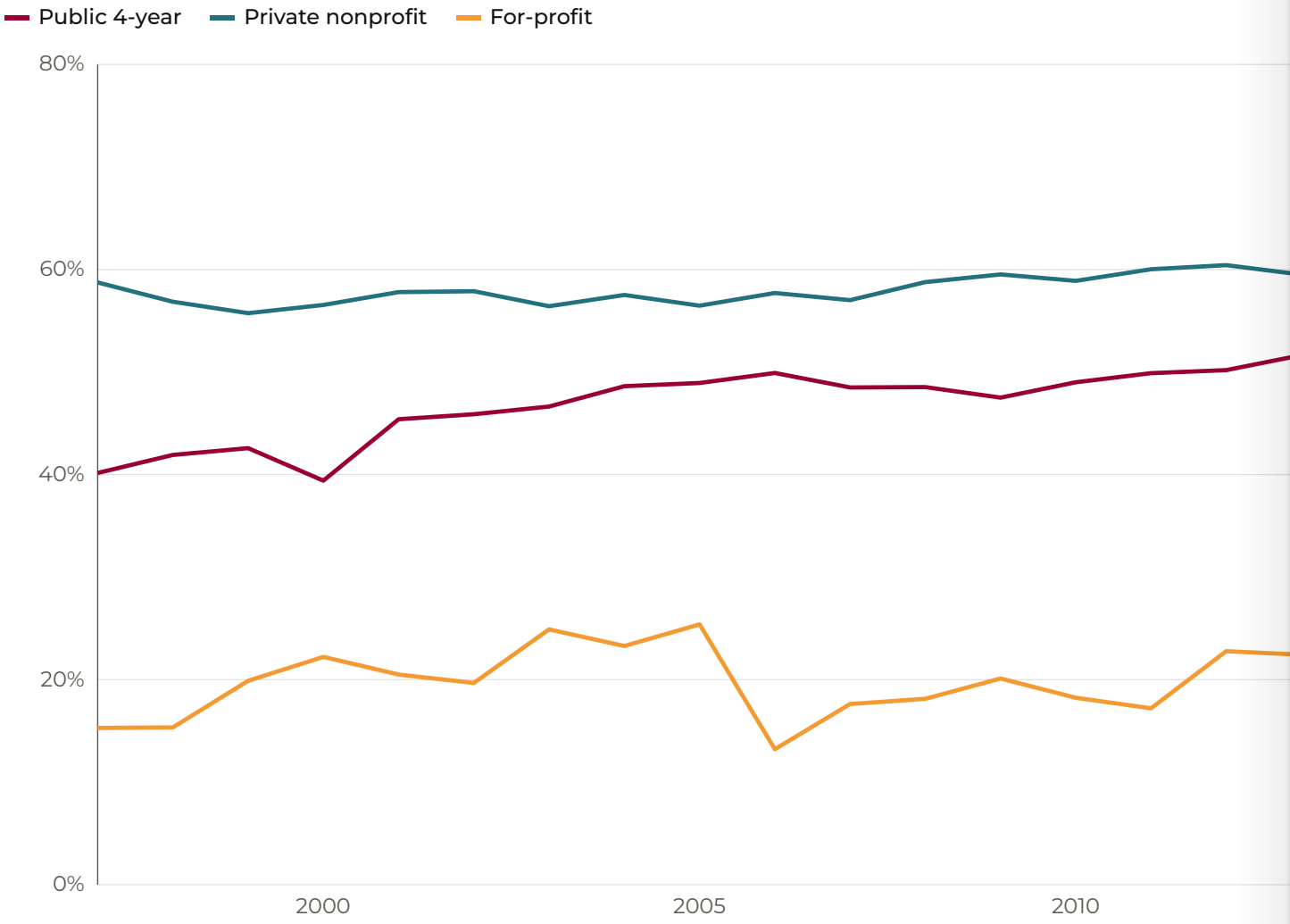
THE NUMBERS

- **In-state tuition, public 4-year**: $8.52K in 2023 (U.S. $9.71K; 38th of 51 states), down 5.6% from $9.02K in 2022, and down 20% since 2015 ($10.6K).
- **Appropriations per student**: $11.8K in 2024 (U.S. $11.4K; 18th of 51 states), up 2.5% from $11.5K in 2023, and up 14% since 2015 ($10.3K).
- **Tuition share of public revenue**: 37% in 2024 (U.S. 43%; 38th of 51 states), down 1.8 points from 39% in 2023, and down 5.1 points since 2015 (42%).
- **Six-year graduation rate**: 61% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 26th of 51 states), up 0.9 points from 60% in 2023, and up 8.7 points since 2015 (53%).

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

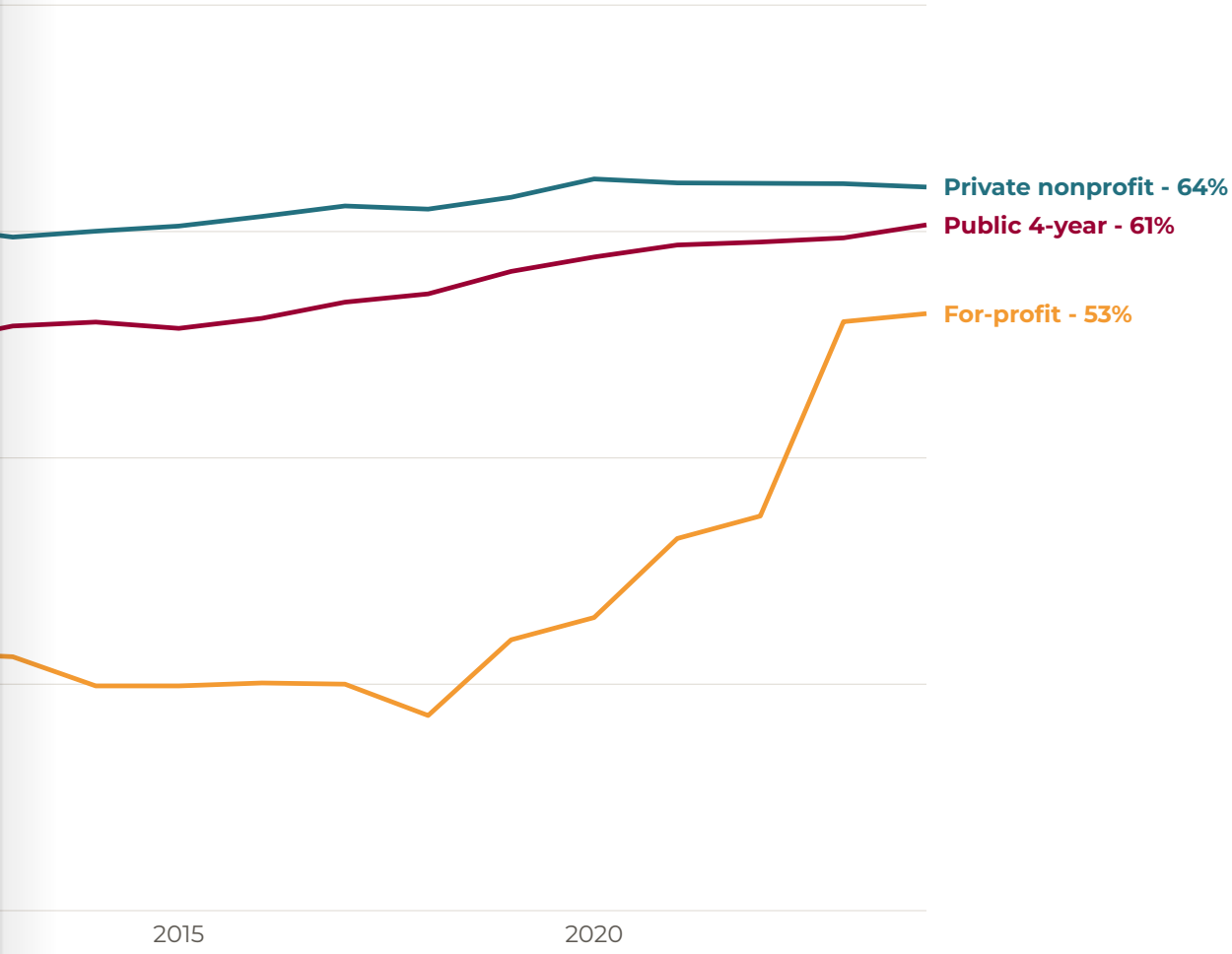
Figure 37 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

61% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Texas graduated within six years (2024), 3.5 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 26th of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 61%, private nonprofit 64%, for-profit 53%. At two-year institutions, 45% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).



61%

Six-year graduation rate, 2024

U.S. **65%** · **26th** of 51 · +8.7 pp since 2015

45%

Two-year completion rate, 2024

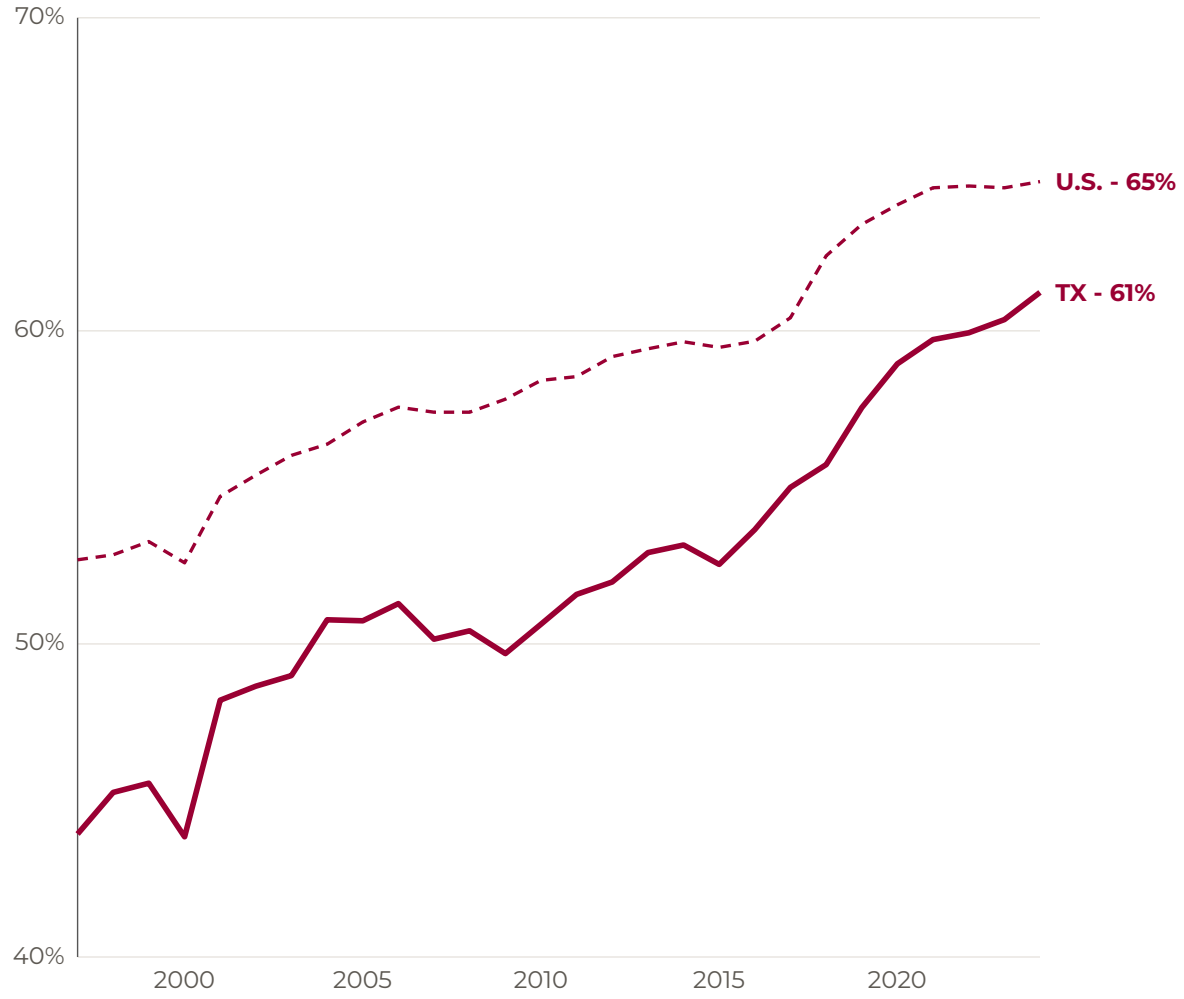
U.S. **41%** · **15th** of 50 · +19.2 pp since 2015

10.2

Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025

U.S. **12.3** · **46th** of 51 · +1.2 since 2015

Figure 38 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

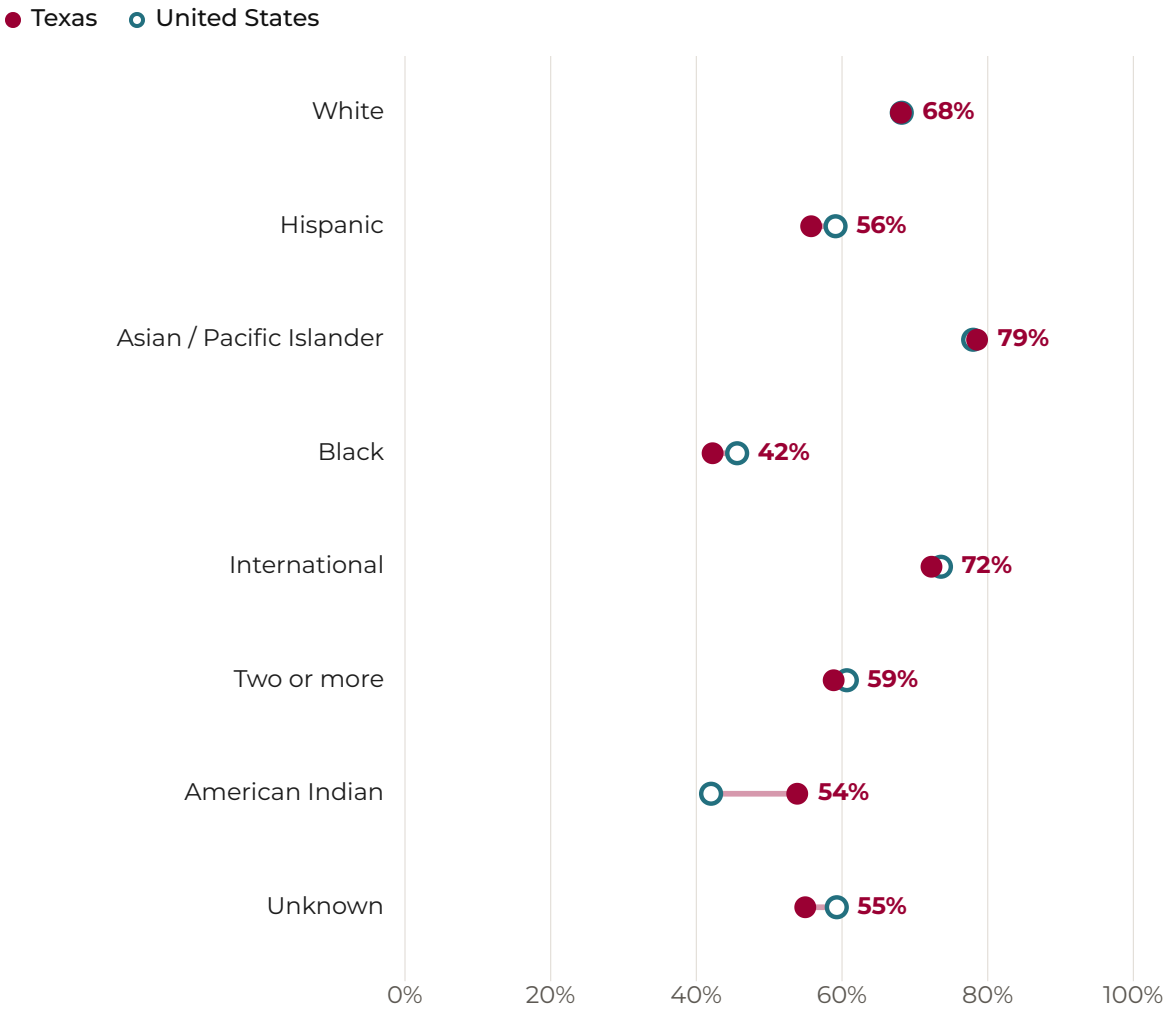
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Texas's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Six-year graduation rate**: 61% in 2024 (U.S. 65%), up 0.9 points from 60% in 2023, and up 8.7 points since 2015 (53%).
- **Public 4-year institutions**: 61% in 2024, up 1.2 points from 59% in 2023, and up 9.2 points since 2015 (51%).
- **Private nonprofit institutions**: 64% in 2024, down 0.3 points from 64% in 2023, and up 3.4 points since 2015 (60%).
- **For-profit institutions**: 53% in 2024, up 0.7 points from 52% in 2023, and up 32.9 points since 2015 (20%).
- **Two-year institutions, completion within 150% of normal time**: 45% in 2024 (U.S. 41%), up 4.4 points from 40% in 2023, and up 19.2 points since 2015 (25%).
- **State rank on the six-year rate**: 61% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 26th of 51 states), up 0.9 points from 60% in 2023, and up 8.7 points since 2015 (53%).

Figure 39 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Texas's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

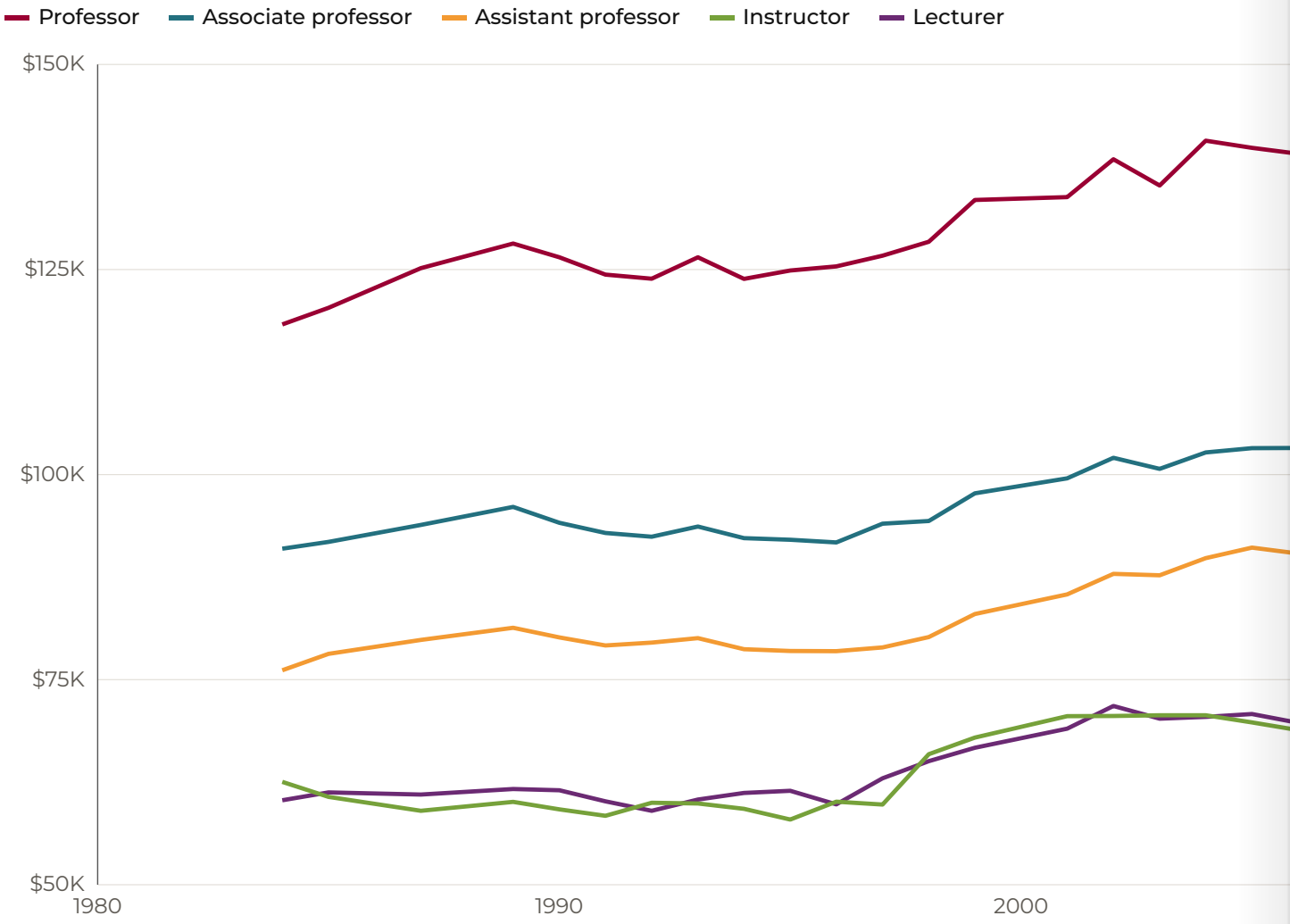
THE NUMBERS

- **White**: 68% in 2024 (U.S. 68%).
- **Hispanic**: 56% in 2024 (U.S. 59%).
- **Asian / Pacific Islander**: 79% in 2024 (U.S. 78%).
- **Black**: 42% in 2024 (U.S. 46%).
- **International**: 72% in 2024 (U.S. 74%).
- **Two or more**: 59% in 2024 (U.S. 61%).
- **American Indian**: 54% in 2024 (U.S. 42%).

SECTION 15

Faculty

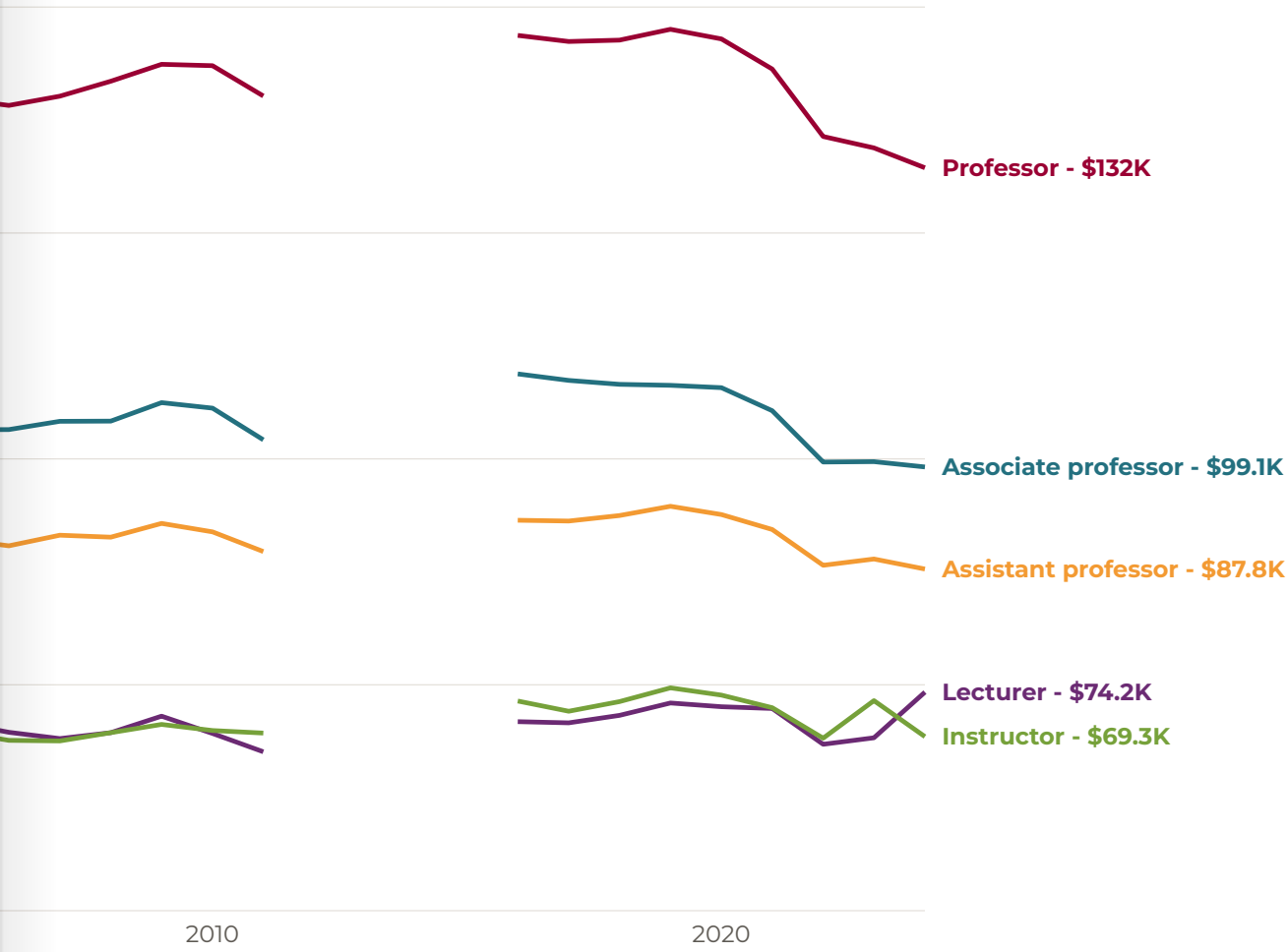
Figure 40 What Do Texas's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data fro

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Texas's institutions earned an average of $96.8K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 8% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 24th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $132K, associate professors $99.1K, assistant professors $87.8K, instructors $69.3K, lecturers $74.2K.

Texas's institutions had 59.1K full-time instructional staff in 2024, up 11% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 7% since 2016.



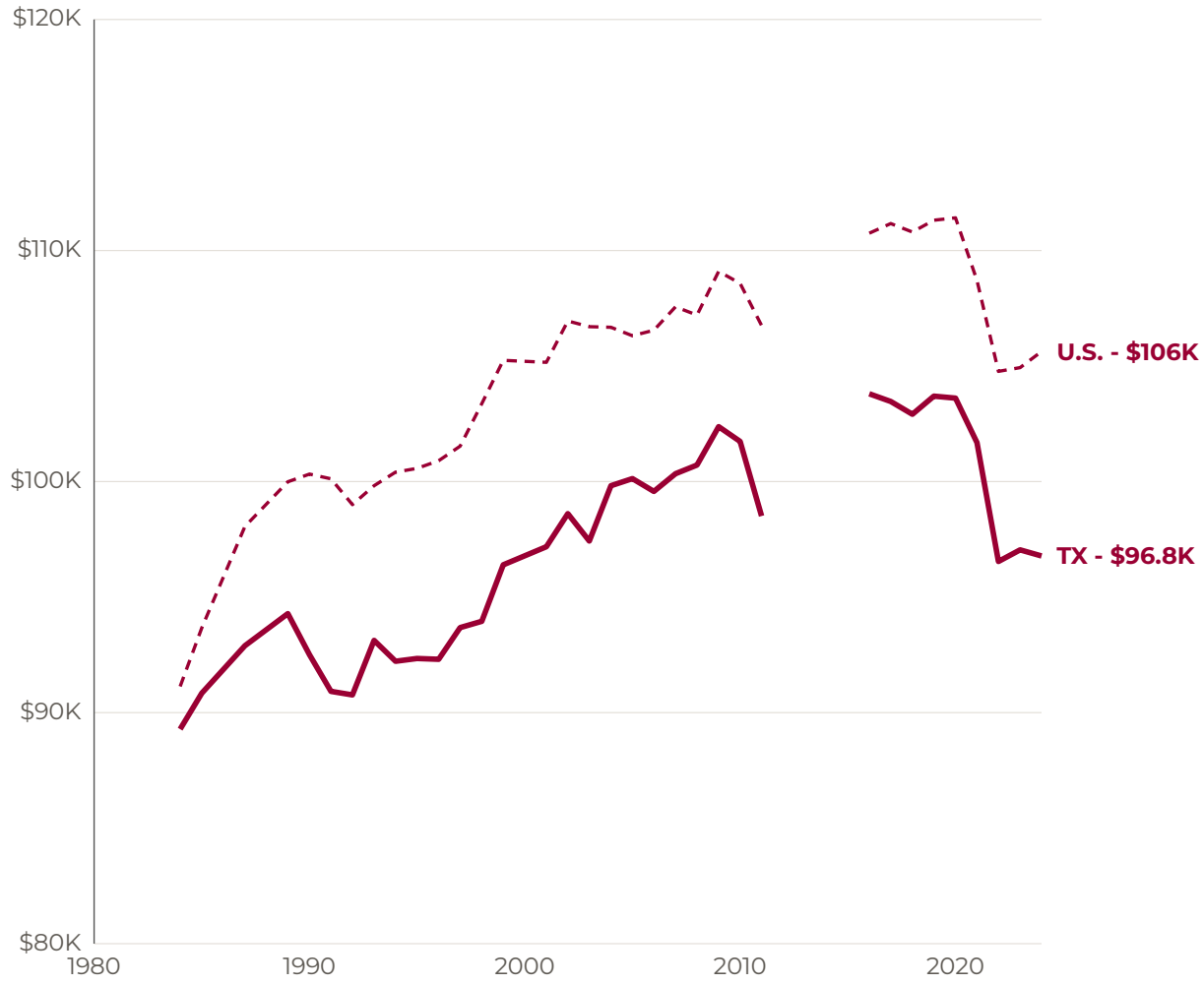
m NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

$96.8K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **24th** of 51 · −6.8% since 2016

Figure 41 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

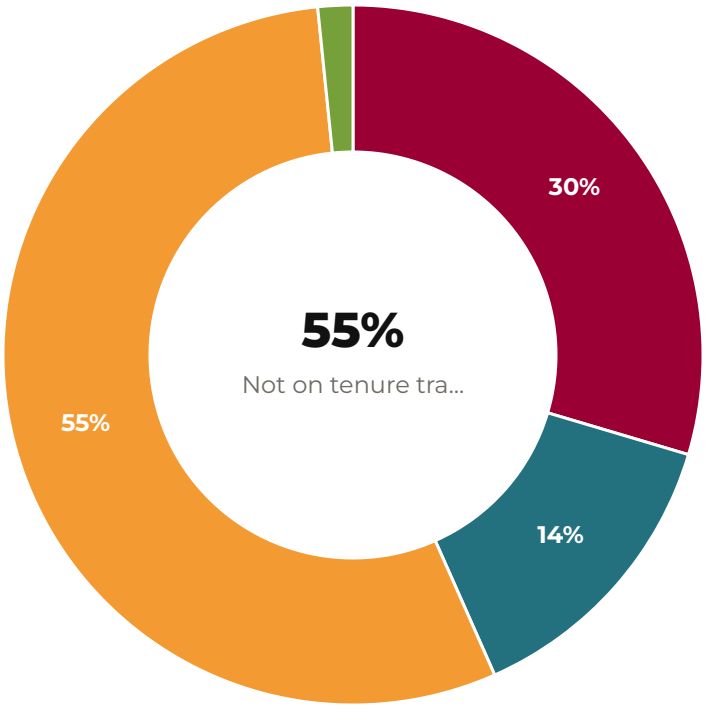
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Texas's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Average salary**: $96.8K in 2024 (U.S. $106K), down 0.3% from $97K in 2023, and down 6.8% since 2016 ($104K).
- **State rank on average salary**: $96.8K in 2024 (U.S. $106K; 24th of 51 states), down 0.3% from $97K in 2023, and down 6.8% since 2016 ($104K).
- **Full-time instructional staff**: 59.1K in 2024, up 4.4% from 56.6K in 2023, and up 11% since 2015 (53K).
- **Professors, average salary**: $132K in 2024, down 1.6% from $134K in 2023, and down 10.0% since 2016 ($147K).
- **Associate professors, average salary**: $99.1K in 2024, down 0.6% from $99.7K in 2023, and down 9.4% since 2016 ($109K).
- **Assistant professors, average salary**: $87.8K in 2024, down 1.2% from $88.9K in 2023, and down 5.8% since 2016 ($93.2K).

Figure 42 Tenure Status



	Share
Tenured	30%
On tenure track	14%
Not on tenure track	55%
No faculty status	1.6%

Full-time instructional staff, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The ring divides Texas's full-time instructional staff in 2024 by tenure status: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

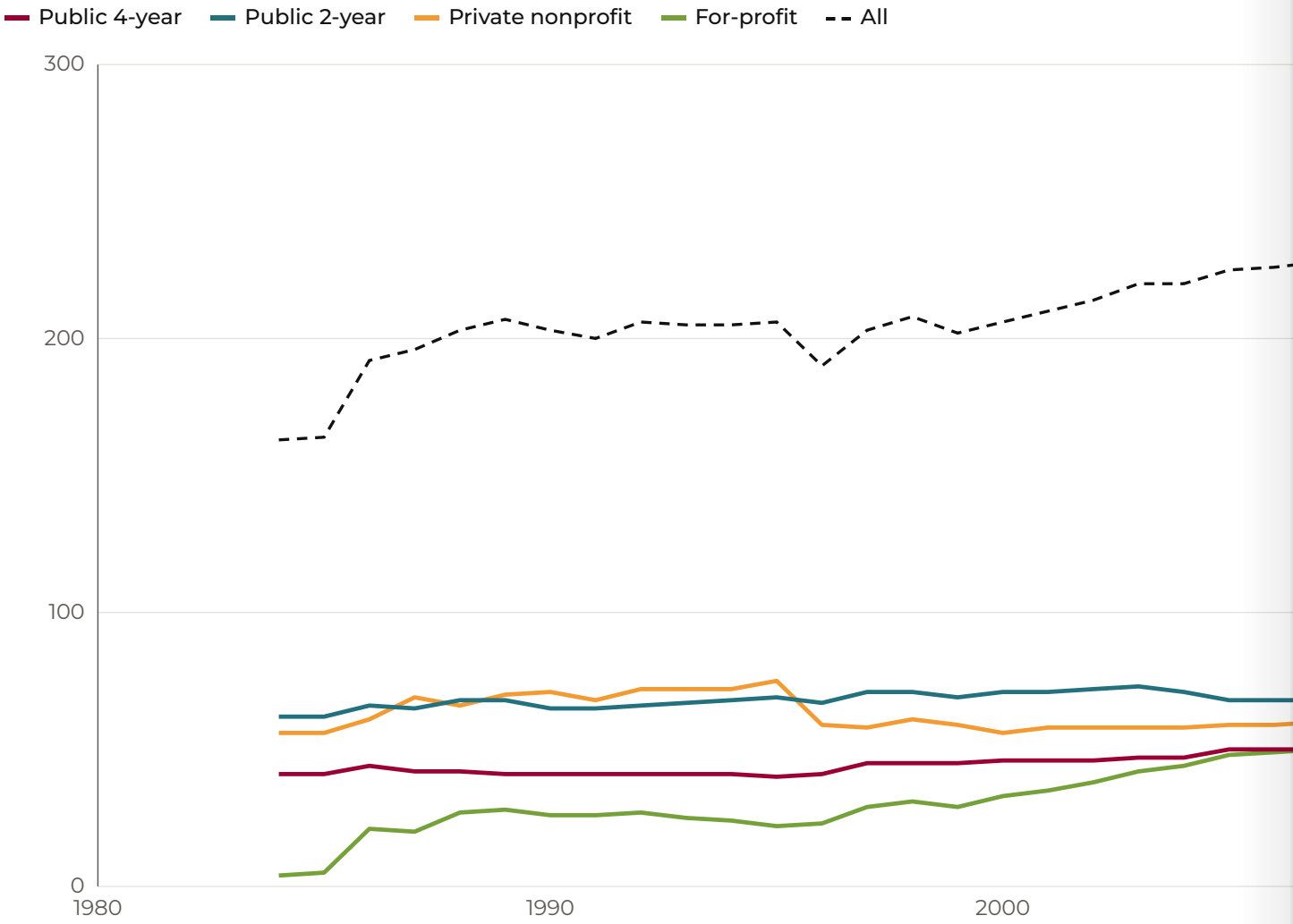
THE NUMBERS

- **Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff**: 30% in 2024, down 1.3 points from 31% in 2023, and down 4.6 points since 2015 (34%).
- **On tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 14% in 2024, up 0.1 points from 14% in 2023, and down 1.0 point since 2015 (15%).
- **Not on tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 55% in 2024, up 1.2 points from 54% in 2023, and up 6.2 points since 2015 (49%).
- **No faculty status, share of full-time instructional staff**: 1.6% in 2024, unchanged from 1.6% in 2023, and down 0.7 points since 2015 (2.3%).

SECTION 16

Institutions

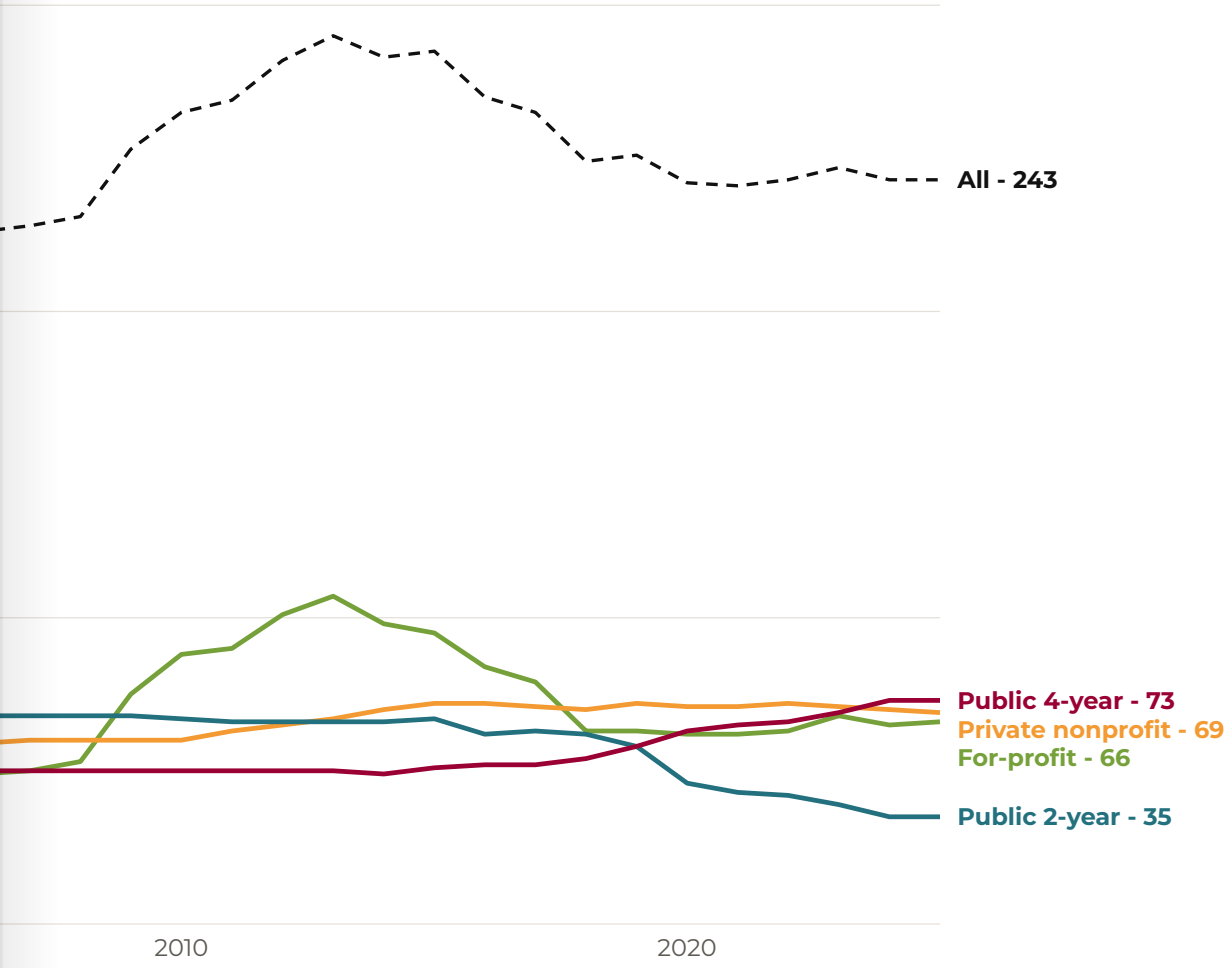
Figure 43 How Many Institutions Does Texas Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Texas has 233 degree-granting institutions: 73 public 4-year, 35 public 2-year, 69 private nonprofit, 66 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 15% since 2015. 88% of students attend public institutions and 3.0% attend for-profit ones.



88%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **7th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

3.0%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **20th** of 51 · −0.3 pp since 2015

22%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **33rd** of 51 · +10.0 pp since 2015

Table 6 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
University of North Texas Denton · Public 4-year	**2.71K**	93%	57	52%
The University of Texas at Arlington Arlington · Public 4-year	**1.37K**	84%	84	56%
The University of Texas at Dallas Richardson · Public 4-year	**1.2K**	72%	116	64%
Texas A&M University-College Station College Station · Public 4-year	**827**	44%	309	56%
University of Houston Houston · Public 4-year	**628**	64%	110	64%
Lamar University Beaumont · Public 4-year	**709**	82%	10	91%
The University of Texas at Austin Austin · Public 4-year	**489**	37%	223	46%
Texas Tech University Lubbock · Public 4-year	**536**	72%	65	45%
Rice University Houston · Private nonprofit	**292**	63%	113	59%
Texas A&M University-Kingsville Kingsville · Public 4-year	**268**	85%	2	67%

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Institutions in Texas ranked by the STEM master's and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: University of North Texas (2.71K international STEM master's, 57 doctorates); The University of Texas at Arlington (1.37K international STEM master's, 84 doctorates); The University of Texas at Dallas (1.2K international STEM master's, 116 doctorates).
- **International STEM master's degrees, all institutions**: 10.5K in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 2nd of 51 states), down 2.6% from 10.8K in 2024, and up 79% since 2015 (5.9K).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 50% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 9th of 51 states), down 4.3 points from 54% in 2024, and down 3.3 points since 2015 (53%).

Table 7 What Are Texas's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
Texas A&M University-College Station	**78.3K**	27%	5.93K	84%	57%
Lone Star College System	**73.1K**	–	114	–	–
Dallas College	**69.7K**	–	–	–	–
The University of Texas at Austin	**53.9K**	31%	3.92K	89%	27%
Houston City College	**53.3K**	–	2	–	–
University of Houston	**48K**	32%	2.62K	65%	74%
University of North Texas	**46.9K**	50%	1.38K	61%	72%
The University of Texas at Arlington	**45K**	27%	1.63K	54%	80%
Tarrant County College District	**43.9K**	–	–	–	–
Texas Tech University	**40.8K**	27%	2.02K	69%	73%
Texas State University	**40.7K**	17%	1.21K	55%	89%
Austin Community College District	**39.7K**	–	60	–	–
Collin County Community College District	**39.5K**	–	156	–	–
The University of Texas at San Antonio	**35.8K**	12%	2.06K	53%	87%
The University of Texas Rio Grande Valley	**33.9K**	6.4%	1.49K	51%	94%

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Texas's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: Texas A&M University-College Station (78.3K students); Lone Star College System (73.1K students); Dallas College (69.7K students).
- **Degree-granting institutions**: 233.
- **Share of students at public institutions**: 88% in 2024 (U.S. 73%; 7th of 51 states), up 0.1 points from 88% in 2023, and up 0.6 points since 2015 (88%).
- **Share at for-profit institutions**: 3.0% in 2024 (U.S. 5.5%; 20th of 51 states), up 0.2 points from 2.7% in 2023, and down 0.3 points since 2015 (3.2%).

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

All dollar values are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts.

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

Source

National Center for Education Statistics, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS): Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions components, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. Department of Homeland Security, SEVIS by the Numbers data mapping tool, 2014–2026. Generated November 2026.

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Texas – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	284	**269**[2024]	−14.4 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#34	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	32%	**24%**[2024]	−8.6 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#36	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	244	**241**[2024]	−3.5 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#8	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	44%	**43%**[2024]	−1.3 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#9	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	261	**252**[2024]	−8.4 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#44	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	28%	**25%**[2024]	−3.0 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#41	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	218	**212**[2024]	−6.0 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#37	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**156**[2015]	–	153	–	#22	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$11.9K	**$13K**[2021]	+9.4% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#41	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	89%	**90%**[2022]	+1.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#2	[3]
Public high school graduates	312K	**382K**[2024]	+22% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#2	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$66.3K	**$64.6K**[2022]	−2.6% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#26	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	15.3	**14.8**[2022]	−0.5 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#21	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	5.3M	**5.55M**[2024]	+4.6% ▲	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#2	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	59%	**63%**[2023]	+4.4 pp ▲	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#6	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	16%	**20%**[2022]	+3.8 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#1	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	5.0%	**8.5%**[2023]	+3.5 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#16	[3]
High schools offering calculus	53%[2016]	**54%**[2024]	+1.3 pp ▲	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#22	[14]
High schools offering physics	89%[2016]	**88%**[2024]	−0.8 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#3	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	91%[2016]	**94%**[2024]	+2.5 pp ▲	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#4	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	91%[2016]	**95%**[2024]	+3.7 pp ▲	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#12	[14]
High schools offering computer science	52%[2021]	**61%**[2024]	+8.2 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#27	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	57%[2016]	**55%**[2024]	−1.8 pp ▼	56%	0.0 pp	#29	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	23%[2021]	**25%**[2024]	+2.3 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#20	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	69%[2016]	**73%[2024]**	+4.1 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#32	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	21.8[2016]	**23.0[2024]**	+1.2 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#6	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	3.2[2016]	**2.7[2024]**	−0.5 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#27	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	22.3[2016]	**18.0[2024]**	−4.3 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#3	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	16.2[2016]	**19.3[2024]**	+3.1 ▲	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#26	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	7.8[2016]	**8.8[2024]**	+1.0 ▲	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#14	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	37%	**39%[2025]**	+2.0 pp ▲	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#9	[15]
Fall enrollment	1.58M	**1.67M[2024]**	+5.7% ▲	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#2	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	88%	**88%[2024]**	+0.6 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#7	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	3.2%	**3.0%[2024]**	−0.3 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#20	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	47%	**45%[2024]**	−2.2 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	12%	**13%[2024]**	+0.5 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#41	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	12%	**22%[2024]**	+10.0 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#33	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	4.07K	**4.5K[2025]**	+11% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#2	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	2.86K	**3.2K[2025]**	+12% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#3	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	7.4%	**7.6%[2025]**	+0.2 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#2	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	825	**1.01K[2025]**	+23% ▲	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#2	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	270	**353[2025]**	+31% ▲	5.07K	+33% ▲	#4	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	4.4	**6.4[2025]**	+2.0 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#19	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	19%	**24%[2025]**	+5.4 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#18	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	2.5%	**6.1%[2025]**	+3.6 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#23	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	6.5%	**7.9%[2025]**	+1.4 pp ▲	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#15	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	1.2%	**1.0%[2025]**	−0.2 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#25	[4]

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TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	6.0%	**7.2%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#18	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	1.5%	**1.0%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#39	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	12%	**13%**[2025]	+1.6 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#20	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	20%	**19%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#31	[4]
STEM share of master's	20%	**27%**[2025]	+6.4 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	5.8%	**12%**[2025]	+6.3 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	8.9%	**7.8%**[2025]	−1.1 pp ▼	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#13	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.9%	**2.4%**[2025]	+1.6 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#2	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	1.9%	**2.5%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#24	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	1.4%	**0.8%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#26	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	10%	**13%**[2025]	+2.9 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#30	[4]
Share of master's in business	26%	**20%**[2025]	−5.9 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#27	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	46%	**43%**[2025]	−3.4 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#24	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	2.7%	**3.7%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#22	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	18%	**18%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#8	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	2.8%	**2.8%**[2025]	0.0 pp	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#19	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	13%	**9.7%**[2025]	−3.5 pp ▼	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#31	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	8.3%	**7.1%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#31	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	6.9%	**10%**[2025]	+3.2 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#25	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	3.5%	**3.9%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#20	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	8.9	**10.2**[2025]	+1.2 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#46	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	1.6%[2016]	**2.3%**[2024]	+0.7 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#33	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	5.9K	**10.5K**[2025]	+79% ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#2	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	11%	**9.0%**[2025]	−2.0 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#2	[4]

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TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	2.6%	**2.5%**[2024]	0.0 pp	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#28	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	20%	**19%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#12	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	3.3%	**2.5%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#37	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	5.8%	**4.7%**[2025]	−1.0 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#30	[4]
International share of all master's	20%	**25%**[2025]	+4.0 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#11	[4]
International share of STEM master's	59%	**62%**[2025]	+3.1 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#9	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	76%	**79%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#13	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	68%	**61%**[2025]	−6.7 pp ▼	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#6	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	33%	**56%**[2025]	+22.4 pp ▲	55%	+6.1 pp ▲	#14	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	20%	**21%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#17	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	43%	**38%**[2025]	−5.6 pp ▼	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#15	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	34%	**30%**[2025]	−3.4 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#15	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	53%	**50%**[2025]	−3.3 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#9	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences research doctorates	64%	**70%**[2025]	+5.7 pp ▲	56%	+2.0 pp ▲	#3	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	64%	**59%**[2025]	−5.1 pp ▼	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#17	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics research doctorates	54%	**52%**[2025]	−1.9 pp ▼	53%	+2.9 pp ▲	#13	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	37%	**31%**[2025]	−6.5 pp ▼	23%	−4.3 pp ▼	#7	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	52%	**43%**[2025]	−9.6 pp ▼	38%	−1.1 pp ▼	#15	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	84.7K	**91.9K**[2026]	+8.5% ▲	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#3	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	7.1%	**7.7%**[2026]	+0.6 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#3	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	25%	**35%**[2026]	+9.6 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#9	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	17%	**8.0%**[2026]	−9.2 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#34	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	43%	**44%**[2026]	+1.5 pp ▲	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#20	[20]

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TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Countries of citizenship represented	195	**188**[2026]	−3.6% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#4	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	42.7K	**81.7K**[2026]	+91% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#2	[20]
Active STEM master's students	23K	**49.8K**[2026]	2.16× ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#2	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	9.41K	**17.1K**[2026]	+82% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#2	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	75%	**76%**[2026]	+1.3 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#2	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	19.8K[2017]	**18K**[2024]	−9.4% ▼	–	–	#3	[1]
Economic contribution of international students	$2.2B[2018]	**$2.5B**[2024]	+14% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#4	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	25K[2018]	**21.4K**[2024]	−15% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#5	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	4.8%	**10%**[2024]	+5.4 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#3	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	4.8%	**12%**[2024]	+7.0 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#3	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	3.9%	**4.5%**[2024]	+0.6 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#5	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	13.8K	**10.9K**[2025]	−21% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#6	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	51.2K	**50.2K**[2016]	−2.0% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#3	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	25.1K	**24K**[2016]	−4.3% ▼	241K	+2.3% ▲	#3	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	49%	**48%**[2016]	−1.1 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#5	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	71%	**69%**[2016]	−1.4 pp ▼	57%	0.0 pp	#2	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	3.14K	**3.01K**[2016]	−4.0% ▼	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#4	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	68%	**66%**[2016]	−2.0 pp ▼	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#3	[9]
University R&D spending	$5.08B	**$9.15B**[2024]	+80% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#3	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	7.4%	**7.8%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#3	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	40%	**43%**[2024]	+3.1 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#47	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	6.9%	**6.7%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#6	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	16%	**13%**[2024]	−3.0 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#5	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science	$193M	**$406M**[2024]	2.10× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#3	[6]

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TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
University R&D in engineering	$817M	**$1.56B[2024]**	+91% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#2	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	60.7K	**93K[2024]**	+53% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#2	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state	$5.57B	**$7.67B[2024]**	+38% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#9	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state	$1.41B	**$2.83B[2024]**	2.01× ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#4	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state	$2.37B	**$4.43B[2024]**	+87% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#8	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state	$961M	**$1.86B[2024]**	+94% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#7	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state	$1.43B	**$2.55B[2025]**	+78% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#5	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state	$2.54B	**$6.13B[2026]**	2.41× ▲	$59.3B	+59% ▲	#3	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$43K[2020]	**$44.6K[2022]**	+3.7% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#37	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$46.2K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#35	[15]
Median debt of completers	$12.5K	**$16K[2024]**	+28% ▲	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#44	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$65K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#35	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$52.6K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#21	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$65.7K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#30	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$85.2K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#36	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	53%	**61%[2024]**	+8.7 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#26	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	25%	**45%[2024]**	+19.2 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#15	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$10.6K	**$8.52K[2023]**	−20% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#38	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$10.3K	**$11.8K[2024]**	+14% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#18	[4]
Tuition share of core revenue, public institutions	42%	**37%[2024]**	−5.1 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#38	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$104K[2016]	**$96.8K[2024]**	−6.8% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#24	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	52%	**49%[2016]**	−3.4 pp ▼	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#13	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	78%	**77%[2016]**	−1.2 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#4	[21]

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TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
OPT retention, master's graduates	47%	**44%**[2016]	−2.9 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#13	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	45%	**43%**[2016]	−1.9 pp ▼	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#11	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	1.05	**1.07**[2016]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#12	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	2.72K	**4.67K**[2016]	+71% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#2	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	88%[2016]	**89%**[2019]	+0.3 pp ▲	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#1	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**84%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#1	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**84%**[2010]	–	64%	–	#1	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	83%[2016]	**84%**[2019]	+0.6 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#1	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**80%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#2	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**65%**[2016]	–	49%	–	#1	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$49.3K[2016]	**$49.7K**[2019]	+0.9% ▲	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#10	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$68.5K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#10	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$60.8K[2016]	**$60.5K**[2019]	−0.5% ▼	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#11	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	+8.9	**+3.2**[2025]	−5.7 ▼	–	–	#18	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	+14.5K	**+25.1K**[2025]	+73% ▲	–	–	#1	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	2.9%	**2.2%**[2025]	−0.8 pp ▼	–	–	#39	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	2.1%	**1.9%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#48	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	61K	**74.6K**[2025]	+22% ▲	–	–	#2	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	93%[2016]	**92%**[2024]	−0.6 pp ▼	–	–	#1	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	−7[2016]	**−10**[2024]	−3.6 ▼	–	–	#43	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	12%[2016]	**14%**[2022]	+2.4 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#46	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	109K	**128K**[2025]	+17% ▲	914K	−24% ▼	#2	[17]

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TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	9.1%	**14%**^{2025}	+4.9 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#2	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	85%	**86%**^{2025}	+1.3 pp ▲	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#6	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars	$69K	**$109K**^{2025}	+58% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#15	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	48%	**30%**^{2025}	−17.7 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#3	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	13K	**14.1K**^{2025}	+8.4% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#2	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	77%	**64%**^{2024}	−13.3 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#4	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	1.5%	**5.6%**^{2024}	+4.2 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#42	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	39%	**46%**^{2024}	+7.1 pp ▲	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#18	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	88%	**65%**^{2025}	−23.2 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#6	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars	$72.5K	**$109K**^{2025}	+50% ▲	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#9	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	99.7K	**160K**^{2024}	+61% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#3	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	9.5%	**12%**^{2024}	+2.3 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#3	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	65.5K	**80.1K**^{2024}	+22% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#4	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	9.0%	**9.8%**^{2024}	+0.8 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#4	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	8.3%	**14%**^{2024}	+5.4 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#2	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	8.1%	**9.1%**^{2024}	+1.0 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#5	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	11%	**16%**^{2024}	+4.5 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#1	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	2.2%	**3.9%**^{2024}	+1.7 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#4	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	15.7K	**16.7K**^{2026}	+6.4% ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#2	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	32.6K	**29K**^{2026}	−11% ▼	268K	+52% ▲	#2	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	14%	**13%**^{2026}	−0.9 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#2	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	6.0%	**4.2%**^{2026}	−1.8 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#15	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	7.7%	**5.0%**^{2026}	−2.7 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#47	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	76%	**64%**^{2026}	−12.6 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#4	[13]

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TEXAS – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	49%	**27%**[2026]	−21.9 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#32	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	755K	**1.25M**[2024]	+65% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#2	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	5.9%	**8.1%**[2024]	+2.2 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#18	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	25%	**31%**[2024]	+6.5 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#4	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	46%	**53%**[2024]	+7.1 pp ▲	41%	+2.2 pp ▲	#4	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a doctorate	57%	**57%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	47%	+0.9 pp ▲	#3	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	13%	**16%**[2024]	+3.8 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#4	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	8.8%	**12%**[2024]	+2.9 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#3	[12]
Share of foreign-born STEM workers born in India	31%	**38%**[2024]	+6.8 pp ▲	28%	+0.7 pp ▲	#5	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	17%	**18%**[2025]	+1.4 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#7	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	23%	**29%**[2025]	+6.2 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#3	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	712K	**969K**[2025]	+36% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#2	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	1.03	**1.03**[2025]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#14	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal	$88.5K	**$116K**[2025]	+31% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#15	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal	$107K[2019]	**$132K**[2025]	+24% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#15	[10]
Software developer jobs	89K	**164K**[2025]	+84% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#2	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal	$46.6K	**$65.8K**[2025]	+41% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#24	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	10.5K	**11K**[2025]	+5.2% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#2	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	7.7%	**8.2%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#2	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	37%	**46%**[2025]	+8.9 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#9	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	8.7%	**7.9%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#49	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	6.4%	**2.9%**[2025]	−3.5 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#8	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	9.0%	**12%**[2025]	+3.1 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#23	[22]

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